VENVLEARNING

STUDENT TEXTBOOK



English Language Arts

GRADE 4

Lessons, examples, and practice for the whole year

2026–2027 School Year · 9 units

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
English Language Arts

STUDENT TEXTBOOK

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 Word Power
Unit 2 Reading Closely
Unit 3 Reading Longer Texts
Unit 4 The Writer's Craft
Unit 5 Reading Deeply
Unit 6 Sources and Evidence
Unit 7 Reading Across Texts
Unit 8 Grammar and Conventions
Unit 9 Capstone

This book belongs to _____

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this book

Each lesson starts with an I can goal and a Get Ready question. Read the lesson with your teacher. Read the Model boxes to see how a strong reader thinks, then answer the Your Turn questions. Your practice pages are in your Student Workbook, labeled with the same lesson number. When a lesson says Read in Your Reader, read that chapter in your Core Knowledge Reader first.

- Key Idea boxes hold the most important rule or fact. Learn these.
- Watch Out boxes warn you about common mistakes.
- Every Friday there is a short Weekly Check in your workbook. The last Friday of a unit is the Unit Test.

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UNIT 1

Word Power

Word parts, context clues, figurative language, and precise words, with King Arthur and the Round Table, Chapters 1–4.

Strong readers figure out new words on their own, and strong writers choose words carefully. In this unit you will use prefixes, suffixes, roots, and context clues to unlock word meanings, explore similes, metaphors, and idioms, and write your own legend-style story while you read the first chapters of King Arthur and the Round Table.

In this unit you will…

- Use prefixes, suffixes, and Greek and Latin roots to figure out word meanings.
- Use context clues: definitions, synonyms, antonyms, examples, and inference.
- Explain similes, metaphors, idioms, and proverbs.
- Choose precise words and write a narrative with dialogue and transitions.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every time you meet a new word in a book, a game, or a science lesson, you can use word parts and context to figure it out without stopping to ask.

UNIT VOCABULARY

prefix	A word part at the beginning of a word.
suffix	A word part at the end of a word.
root	The main part of a word.
context clue	A hint in the text about a word's meaning.
simile	A comparison using like or as.
metaphor	A comparison saying one thing is another.
idiom	A phrase with a meaning different from its words.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
1.1	Meet King Arthur: Reading a Legend
1.2	Prefixes
1.3	Suffixes
1.4	Greek and Latin Roots
1.5	Context Clues: Definitions and Restatements
1.6	Context Clues: Synonyms and Antonyms
1.7	Context Clues: Examples and Inference
1.8	Multiple-Meaning Words and the Dictionary
1.9	Similes and Metaphors
1.10	Idioms, Adages, and Proverbs
1.11	Shades of Meaning
1.12	Academic and Content Words
1.13	Strong Verbs and Vivid Adjectives
1.14	Planning a Narrative: Sequence and Transitions
1.15	Drafting a Narrative Scene
1.16	Revising, Editing, and Publishing

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · RL.4.1, RL.4.3

Lesson 1.1: Meet King Arthur: Reading a Legend

I can describe the characters and setting of a legend and use details from the text.

WORDS TO KNOW

legend	A story from long ago about a hero; parts may be true, but much is made up.
character	A person or animal in a story.
setting	When and where a story takes place.
detail	A small piece of information in a text.

GET READY

Have you ever heard a story about a hero who did something no one else could do? What made that person a hero?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 1: The Birth of Arthur

As you read: Who are the important characters? Where and when does the story take place?

The stories of King Arthur are legends. People told them for hundreds of years, and each storyteller added new details. A legend usually has a hero, a time long ago, and events that are hard to believe, such as magic.

When you describe a character or setting, use details from the text, not just your opinion. Strong readers say what the text says and then explain what it shows.

MODEL · DESCRIBE A CHARACTER

What kind of person is Merlin?

1. Find a detail: Merlin is a wizard who takes care of the baby Arthur's future.
2. Ask: What does that show about him?
3. Write a sentence that names the trait and the detail.

Model answer: Merlin is wise and powerful. He uses his magic and knowledge to protect the baby Arthur and plan for his future.

KEY IDEA

Describe characters and settings with details from the text, then explain what the details show.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two characters in Chapter 1.
2. Describe the setting of the legend.
3. Which part of the chapter seems like a legend rather than real history? Why?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Legends are old hero stories. Describe characters and settings with text details.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · L.4.4b, RF.4.3a

Lesson 1.2: Prefixes

I can use prefixes to figure out the meaning of new words.

WORDS TO KNOW

prefix	A word part added to the beginning of a word that changes its meaning.
base word	A word that can stand alone, to which prefixes and suffixes are added.

GET READY

What do the words unhappy, unlock, and unfair have in common? What does un- do to each word?

A prefix is added to the beginning of a base word. If you know what the prefix means, you can often figure out the whole word.

Prefix	Meaning	Example
un-	not; opposite of	unhappy = not happy
re-	again; back	rebuild = build again
dis-	not; opposite of	disappear = opposite of appear
mis-	wrongly; badly	misjudge = judge wrongly
pre-	before	pretest = test before
non-	not	nonstop = without stopping

REALISTIC FICTION

The Unlucky Kite

An original story

1 Mia was unhappy. Her new kite had disappeared over the tall fence behind the library. She had misjudged the wind, and the string had slipped right out of her fingers.

2 "We can rebuild it," said her brother Theo. "I'll reread the directions, and you can retie the tail."

3 Mia shook her head. "It's not the same. That kite was a gift from Grandma. I disliked the old one, but I loved this one."

4 Just then, a woman leaned over the fence. She held up a bright red kite with a crooked tail. "Is this yours?" she asked with a smile. "It landed in my tomato plants. Next time, I suggest you pretest the wind before you let out all that string!"

5 Mia's frown disappeared. This was not such an unlucky day after all.

MODEL · USE THE PREFIX

In paragraph 1, what does misjudged mean?

1 Find the base word: judged.

2 Find the prefix: mis- means "wrongly."

3 Put them together and check the sentence: she judged the wind wrongly, so the string slipped.

Model answer: Misjudged means "judged wrongly."

WATCH OUT

Not every word that starts with these letters has a prefix. In uncle and real, un and re are not prefixes, because -cle and -al are not base words.

KEY IDEA

Prefix meaning + base word meaning = new word meaning. Check that the meaning makes sense in the sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does retie mean in paragraph 2?
2. What does disliked mean in paragraph 3?
3. What does pretest mean in paragraph 4?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Prefixes come at the beginning of words: un-, dis-, non- (not), re- (again), mis- (wrongly), pre- (before).

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · L.4.4b

Lesson 1.3: Suffixes

I can use suffixes to figure out the meaning and part of speech of new words.

WORDS TO KNOW

suffix	A word part added to the end of a word that changes its meaning or how it is used.

GET READY

How are help, helpful, helpless, and helper different?

A suffix is added to the end of a base word. Suffixes change the meaning and often change the part of speech (for example, from a verb to an adjective).

Suffix	Meaning	Example
-ful	full of	careful = full of care
-less	without	hopeless = without hope
-ly	in a certain way	slowly = in a slow way
-ness	state of being	darkness = state of being dark
-able	able to be	breakable = able to be broken
-er, -or	a person who	gardener = a person who gardens

REALISTIC FICTION

Mr. Hollis and the Hopeless Garden

An original story

1 Everyone on Pine Street agreed that the empty lot was hopeless. It was full of broken bottles, rusty cans, and weeds taller than a fourth grader.

2 Then Mr. Hollis, a retired gardener, moved in next door. Every morning he worked slowly and carefully, pulling weeds and filling bags with trash. His neighbors thought his effort was pointless.

3 By June, though, the darkness of the old lot had given way to bright sunflowers and rows of beans. Children who had once been fearless about climbing the fence now walked gently between the rows. Mr. Hollis let anyone pick vegetables, as long as they were thankful and left the plants unharmed.

4 "Nothing is hopeless," Mr. Hollis told a reporter, "if you are willing to get your hands dirty."

MODEL · USE THE SUFFIX

What does pointless mean in paragraph 2?

1 Base word: point (a purpose).

2 Suffix: -less means "without."

3 Check: the neighbors thought his work had no purpose.

Model answer: Pointless means "without a point or purpose."

WATCH OUT

Sometimes the base word changes spelling: happy + -ness = happiness (y changes to i).

KEY IDEA

Base word + suffix meaning = new word meaning. Suffixes like -ful and -less are opposites.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does carefully mean?
2. What does fearless mean?
3. What is a gardener?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Suffixes come at the end: -ful (full of), -less (without), -ly (how), -ness (state of), -able (can be), -er/-or (person who).

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · L.4.4b

Lesson 1.4: Greek and Latin Roots

I can use Greek and Latin roots to figure out the meaning of words.

WORDS TO KNOW

root	The main part of a word that carries its meaning; many English roots come from Greek or Latin.

GET READY

The word telephone has two parts: tele and phone. What do you think each part means?

Root	Origin	Meaning	Examples
tele	Greek	far	telephone, telescope
phon	Greek	sound	telephone, phonics
graph	Greek	write, draw	autograph, paragraph
port	Latin	carry	transport, portable
aud	Latin	hear	audience, audio
vis / vid	Latin	see	visible, video

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Messages Across the Miles

An original informational text

1 Long ago, sending a message far away was slow. A rider might transport a letter on horseback for weeks. Some kingdoms used tall towers with fires on top, so that a guard could see a visible signal from one hill to the next.

2 In the 1800s, the telegraph changed everything. Electric signals traveled along wires, and an operator wrote down the message in dots and dashes. A few years later, the telephone let people hear each other's voices across many miles.

3 Today, a video call lets a grandmother in Texas see and hear her grandson in Japan at the same moment. The audience for a single online video can include millions of people. The roots of these words come from Greek and Latin, but the inventions are as modern as the phone in your pocket.

MODEL · PUT ROOTS TOGETHER

What does telegraph mean?

1 tele = far.

2 graph = write.

3 The telegraph sent written messages over long distances.

Model answer: a machine that sends writing far away

KEY IDEA

Roots carry the main meaning. Combine the root with prefixes and suffixes, then check the sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Portable means...

2. An audience is...

3. Visible means...

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Roots carry meaning: tele (far), phon (sound), graph (write), port (carry), aud (hear), vis (see).

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · L.4.4a

Lesson 1.5: Context Clues: Definitions and Restatements

I can use definition and restatement clues to figure out new words.

WORDS TO KNOW

context	The words and sentences around a word.
context clue	A hint in the text that helps you figure out a word's meaning.

GET READY

Read this: “The knight wore a gauntlet, an armored glove, on each hand.” What is a gauntlet? How did you know?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 2: The Sword in the Stone

As you read: Watch for unfamiliar words. Which ones can you figure out from the sentences around them?

Authors often help you with hard words. A definition clue tells the meaning right in the sentence, often after a comma or the words is, means, or which is. A restatement clue says the same thing in easier words, often after or, a dash, or parentheses.

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Blacksmith's Apprentice

An original story

1 When Tom turned ten, his father sent him to be an apprentice, a young worker who learns a trade by helping a master. His master was Old Rowan, the village blacksmith.

2 The smithy was always hot. In the middle of the room stood the forge, a fireplace where metal is heated until it glows. Tom's first job was to pump the bellows. Each time he squeezed the leather bag, it pushed a gust of air into the fire, and the coals blazed orange.

3 Rowan held glowing iron on the anvil and pounded it with his hammer. Sparks flew like tiny stars. Unlike the soft, bendable iron that came out of the fire, the finished horseshoe was rigid after it cooled in a bucket of water.

4 At the end of the first week, Tom's arms ached and his face was smudged with soot. But when a knight's horse trotted away on shoes Tom had helped make, he felt as proud as a king.

MODEL · DEFINITION CLUE

What is a forge? (paragraph 2)

1 Look right after the word.

2 The comma introduces “a fireplace where metal is heated until it glows.”

Model answer: A forge is a fireplace where metal is heated until it glows.

KEY IDEA

Look for commas, dashes, parentheses, and the words is, means, and or. They often signal a definition or restatement.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is an apprentice?
2. What do bellows do?
3. What clue word or punctuation helped you with apprentice?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Definition and restatement clues explain the word right in the sentence. Watch for commas, dashes, parentheses, is, means, or.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · L.4.4a, L.4.5c

Lesson 1.6: Context Clues: Synonyms and Antonyms

I can use synonym and antonym clues to figure out new words.

WORDS TO KNOW

synonym	A word that means the same or almost the same as another word.
antonym	A word that means the opposite of another word.

GET READY

"Gareth was boisterous, but his brother was quiet." What does boisterous probably mean?

A synonym clue uses a word with a similar meaning nearby. An antonym clue uses a word with the opposite meaning. Antonym clues are often signaled by but, unlike, however, on the other hand, or instead.

HISTORICAL FICTION

Two Brothers, Two Knights

An original story

1 Sir Gareth and Sir Gaheris were brothers, but they were as different as night and day. Gareth was boisterous. He laughed loudly, sang at dinner, and told jokes that echoed through the great hall. Gaheris, on the other hand, was quiet and thoughtful.

2 Gareth was also impulsive. He jumped into adventures without thinking. Gaheris was cautious; he studied every map and asked every question before he rode out.

3 Yet the brothers agreed on one thing: a knight must be gallant, or brave and polite, to everyone, from the queen to the poorest farmer.

MODEL · ANTONYM CLUE

What does impulsive mean? (paragraph 2)

1 Gareth jumps into adventures without thinking.

2 Gaheris is the opposite: cautious, studying every map.

3 So impulsive means acting quickly without thinking.

Model answer: Impulsive means acting without thinking first.

KEY IDEA

Synonym clues show the same meaning nearby. Antonym clues show the opposite, often after but, unlike, or on the other hand.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does boisterous mean?
2. Which word is an antonym clue for impulsive?
3. What does gallant mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Synonym clues show the same meaning; antonym clues (but, unlike, on the other hand) show the opposite.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · L.4.4a

Lesson 1.7: Context Clues: Examples and Inference

I can use example clues and the whole passage to infer word meanings.

WORDS TO KNOW

infer	Figure out something the author does not say directly, using clues and what you know.

GET READY

"The cook chopped root vegetables such as onions, turnips, and carrots." What are root vegetables?

An example clue gives examples of the word, often after such as, for example, like, or including. Sometimes there is no single clue, and you must infer from the whole sentence or paragraph.

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Castle Kitchen

An original informational story

1 Before sunrise, the castle kitchen was already busy. Cooks chopped onions, turnips, and other root vegetables. A boy turned a huge spit so the meat roasting over the fire would cook evenly.

2 The head cook was stern. She never smiled, and when a kitchen maid dropped a basket of eggs, the cook's voice was so sharp that everyone froze.

3 By noon the long tables in the hall were covered with platters of bread, stews, and pies. The feast lasted until the candles burned low, and the guests could not eat another bite.

MODEL · INFER FROM THE PARAGRAPH

What does stern mean? (paragraph 2)

1 The cook never smiled.

2 Her voice was sharp; everyone froze.

3 Those clues describe someone strict and serious.

Model answer: Stern means strict and serious.

KEY IDEA

Look for examples after such as, like, or including. If there's no clear clue, use all the details to infer.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What are root vegetables? What clue helped?

2. What is a feast?

3. Which details helped you infer the meaning of feast?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Example clues follow such as, like, including. Without a clear clue, infer from all the details.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · L.4.4a, L.4.4c

Lesson 1.8: Multiple-Meaning Words and the Dictionary

I can use context to choose the right meaning of a multiple-meaning word and check it in a dictionary.

WORDS TO KNOW

multiple-meaning word	A word with more than one meaning, like bat or spring.
dictionary entry	A word in a dictionary with its pronunciation, part of speech, and meanings.
guide words	The two words at the top of a dictionary page that show the first and last entries on the page.

GET READY

What does bat mean in “The bat flew out of the cave”? In “Leo swung the bat”?

Many English words have more than one meaning. Use context to decide which meaning fits, then check in a dictionary or glossary.

REALISTIC FICTION

A Day at the Fair

An original story

1 On Saturday, Leo and his sister Nia went to the county fair. First they watched a juggler toss knives into the air. “Watch your step!” called a man as they passed a muddy puddle near the pig pens.

2 Nia wanted to ride the Ferris wheel, but the line was long. “Let's wait,” said Leo. “It will move faster after the band starts to play.”

3 Later, Leo paid two dollars to throw rings at a row of bottles. He tossed the last ring, and it landed right around a bottle neck. He won a stuffed bear as big as a pillow.

step (verb)	1. to move by lifting your foot and putting it down	2. —
step (noun)	1. one movement of the foot	2. a stair
line (noun)	1. a long thin mark	2. a row of people waiting

MODEL · CHOOSE THE MEANING

"The line was long." (paragraph 2)

1 Possible meanings: a long thin mark, or a row of people waiting.

2 Context: Nia wanted to ride but had to wait.

Model answer: a row of people waiting

KEY IDEA

Try each meaning in the sentence. The one that makes sense is the right one. Use guide words to find entries quickly.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. In paragraph 1, which meaning of step is used?
2. What does play mean in paragraph 2?
3. Would fair come between the guide words face and fall?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use context to pick the right meaning; check it in a dictionary using guide words.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.9 · L.4.5a, RL.4.4

Lesson 1.9: Similes and Metaphors

I can explain the meaning of similes and metaphors in a text.

WORDS TO KNOW

figurative language	Words used in an unusual way to create a picture or feeling, not to be taken literally.
simile	A comparison of two unlike things using like or as.
metaphor	A comparison of two unlike things that says one thing is another, without like or as.

GET READY

What does it mean if someone says, “My little brother is a tornado”?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 3: The Sword in the Lake

As you read: Notice descriptive language. How does the author help you picture the lake and the magic sword?

Writers use similes and metaphors to help readers picture things. To understand one, ask: What two things are compared? How are they alike?

HISTORICAL FICTION

Storm over the Moor

An original story

1 The sky over the moor turned as dark as an iron pot. Wind howled like a hungry wolf, and the tall grass bent low to the ground.

2 Sir Bedivere pulled his cloak tighter. His horse was a statue, refusing to take another step. Rain fell in silver sheets, stinging his face like a hundred tiny needles.

3 At last, a light appeared in the distance. The little cottage was a lighthouse in a sea of storm. Bedivere's heart, cold as a stone a moment before, warmed with hope.

MODEL · EXPLAIN A SIMILE

“Wind howled like a hungry wolf.”

1 Compared: wind and a hungry wolf.

2 Alike: both make a loud, wild, scary howling sound.

Model answer: The wind was loud, wild, and frightening.

MODEL · EXPLAIN A METAPHOR

"His horse was a statue."

1 Compared: the horse and a statue.

2 Alike: a statue does not move.

Model answer: The horse stood completely still and would not move.

KEY IDEA

Simile: like or as. Metaphor: says one thing is another. Explain what the two things have in common.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Simile or metaphor: "The cottage was a lighthouse in a sea of storm."
2. What does that comparison mean?
3. Find one more simile in the passage.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Similes compare with like or as; metaphors say one thing is another. Explain how the things are alike.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.10 · L.4.5b

Lesson 1.10: Idioms, Adages, and Proverbs

I can explain the meaning of common idioms, adages, and proverbs.

WORDS TO KNOW

idiom	A phrase whose meaning is different from the meanings of its words, like "break a leg."
adage / proverb	A short, well-known saying that gives advice or states a truth.

GET READY

If your coach says, "Keep your eye on the ball," does she mean to put your eye on it?

An idiom can't be understood word by word. It's raining cats and dogs means it is raining very hard. An adage or proverb is a wise saying, like Look before you leap.

PERSONAL NARRATIVE

Grandpa's Sayings

An original personal narrative

1 My grandpa has a saying for everything. When I complained about cleaning my room, he said, "Many hands make light work," and then he helped me fold my clothes.

2 When my sister was nervous about her piano recital, he told her to "break a leg." She looked worried until Mom explained that it means "good luck."

3 Last week, I wanted to quit soccer after we lost three games in a row. Grandpa put his hand on my shoulder. "Rome wasn't built in a day," he said. "Keep practicing."

4 I used to think his sayings were silly. Now, whenever I'm about to give up, I can almost hear him say, "Hang in there, kiddo."

MODEL · EXPLAIN A PROVERB

"Rome wasn't built in a day."

1 Literal: a huge city took a long time to build.

2 Situation: the narrator wants to quit after losing.

3 Lesson: great things take time and effort.

Model answer: Big goals take time; keep working.

KEY IDEA

Use context to figure out the real meaning. Ask: What is the speaker trying to tell someone?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “break a leg” mean?
2. What does “Many hands make light work” mean?
3. What does “Hang in there” mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Idioms and proverbs mean something different from their words. Use context to find the real meaning.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.11 · L.4.5c, L.4.3a

Lesson 1.11: Shades of Meaning

I can choose among words with similar meanings to say exactly what I mean.

WORDS TO KNOW

shades of meaning	Small differences between words that mean almost the same thing.
thesaurus	A reference book that lists synonyms and antonyms.

GET READY

Is there a difference between saying a knight walked, marched, or tiptoed into the hall?

Synonyms are not all exactly the same. Cold, chilly, and freezing all describe low temperature, but freezing is much stronger. Choosing the right shade of meaning makes writing precise.

weaker			stronger
warm	hot	boiling	scorching
glad	happy	joyful	ecstatic
whisper	say	shout	roar
walk	hurry	run	sprint

MODEL · CHOOSE THE BEST WORD

The baby was asleep, so the knight ___ past the cradle. (walked, stomped, tiptoed)

1 Stomped is loud: wrong.

2 Walked is okay but plain.

3 Tiptoed shows moving quietly so the baby won't wake.

Model answer: tiptoed

KEY IDEA

Use a thesaurus to find synonyms, then pick the one whose exact meaning fits the sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Order from weakest to strongest: furious, annoyed, angry

2. Best word: The lion ___ (said, roared) loudly.

3. A stronger word for big

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Synonyms differ in strength and feeling. Choose the most precise word.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.12 · L.4.6

Lesson 1.12: Academic and Content Words

I can learn and use words about a topic (content words) and words used in school (academic words).

WORDS TO KNOW

academic word	A word used in many school subjects, like compare, describe, or explain.
content word	A word that belongs to one topic, like moat for castles.
glossary	A list of important words and their meanings at the back of a book.

GET READY

What does a question mean when it asks you to compare? To explain?

Some words appear in every subject: academic words such as compare (tell how things are alike and different), describe (tell details about), and explain (tell how or why). Other words belong to a topic: content words such as moat or keep for castles.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

How a Castle Kept People Safe

An original informational text

1 During the Middle Ages, lords built castles to protect their land and people. Many castles were surrounded by a moat, a deep ditch often filled with water.

2 To enter, visitors crossed a drawbridge, a bridge that could be raised to block the gate. The tops of the thick walls had battlements, which were walls with gaps that let archers shoot while staying protected.

3 The strongest part of the castle was the keep, a tall tower where the lord's family lived. If enemies broke through the outer walls, everyone could retreat to the keep.

MODEL · USE A CONTENT WORD

Explain how a drawbridge kept people safe.

1 Find the definition: a bridge that could be raised to block the gate.

2 Explain how: when raised, enemies could not cross the moat.

Model answer: When the drawbridge was raised, enemies couldn't cross the moat to reach the gate.

KEY IDEA

Learn what academic question words ask you to do. Use content words correctly when you write about a topic.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does compare ask you to do?
2. What was the keep?
3. What were battlements for?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Academic words tell you what to do; content words name things in a topic.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.13 · L.4.3a, W.4.3d

Lesson 1.13: Strong Verbs and Vivid Adjectives

I can choose strong verbs and vivid adjectives to make my writing come alive.

WORDS TO KNOW

verb	A word that shows action or being.
adjective	A word that describes a noun.
vivid	Bright and clear, so the reader can picture it.

GET READY

Which sentence do you picture better: “The knight went down the hill” or “The knight thundered down the rocky hill”?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 4: Sir Balin and the Hallows

As you read: Collect three strong verbs or vivid adjectives the author uses.

Plain words like went, said, good, and nice don't give readers much to picture. Strong verbs show exactly how an action happens. Vivid adjectives add sensory detail.

MODEL · REVISE A SENTENCE

The dog went across the yard.

1 Replace went with a verb that shows how: dashed.

2 Add an adjective: muddy.

Model answer: The dog dashed across the muddy yard.

KEY IDEA

Replace tired words with precise verbs and adjectives that help the reader see, hear, and feel.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Stronger verb for said (loudly)
2. Stronger verb for ate (quickly)
3. Vivid adjective for a sword

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Strong verbs and vivid adjectives help readers picture your writing.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.14 · W.4.3a, W.4.3c

Lesson 1.14: Planning a Narrative: Sequence and Transitions

I can plan a story with a clear beginning, middle, and end, using transition words.

WORDS TO KNOW

narrative	A story that tells about events, real or imagined.
sequence	The order in which events happen.
transition word	A word or phrase that connects ideas and shows order, like first, then, suddenly.

GET READY

Think of a legend you know. What happens at the beginning, in the middle, and at the end?

A good narrative introduces a character and setting (beginning), builds a problem (middle), and solves it (end). Transition words guide the reader through time.

Beginning	Middle	End
at first, one day, long ago, once	then, next, after that, suddenly, meanwhile, later	finally, at last, in the end

MODEL · PLAN A STORY

A squire must find a lost horse before the tournament.

1 Beginning: Will, a squire, wakes up; Sir Owen's horse is gone.

2 Middle: He searches the stables and the forest; he finds hoofprints; suddenly he hears a neigh in the woods.

3 End: He finds the horse caught in brambles and frees it just in time.

Model answer: A three-part plan with characters, a problem, events in order, and a solution.

KEY IDEA

Plan beginning, middle, and end before you write. Use transitions to show the order of events.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two transition words for the middle of a story.
2. What belongs in the beginning?
3. What belongs in the end?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plan beginning, middle, and end; connect events with transition words.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.15 · W.4.3b, W.4.3d

Lesson 1.15: Drafting a Narrative Scene

I can draft a narrative that uses dialogue, description, and precise words.

WORDS TO KNOW

dialogue	The words characters say to each other, shown in quotation marks.
draft	A first version of a piece of writing.

GET READY

How can a writer show that a character is nervous without writing “he was nervous”?

Good narratives show instead of just tell. Use dialogue, actions, and sensory details. Instead of “Will was nervous,” write: Will's hands shook as he tightened the strap. “Please hold,” he whispered.

MODEL · SHOW, DON'T TELL

Tell: The forest was scary.

1 What would you see? Twisted branches, dark shadows.

2 Hear? An owl hooting, twigs cracking.

3 Feel? Cold air, heart pounding.

Model answer: Twisted branches clawed at the sky. Somewhere an owl hooted, and a twig cracked behind me. My heart pounded.

- Put a character's exact words inside quotation marks.
- Start a new paragraph each time a new person speaks.
- Put the comma or end mark inside the closing quotation mark: “Wait,” said Will.

KEY IDEA

Show feelings with actions, dialogue, and details. Use this week's precise words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Show “The king was angry” with an action.
2. Punctuate: Hurry said the squire
3. Show “It was cold” with a sensory detail.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Show, don't tell: use dialogue, actions, and sensory details.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.16 · W.4.5, L.4.2

Lesson 1.16: Revising, Editing, and Publishing

I can revise my writing for word choice and edit for capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

WORDS TO KNOW

revise	Improve the ideas, order, and word choice of writing.
edit	Fix mistakes in capitalization, punctuation, grammar, and spelling.
publish	Share a final, clean copy with readers.

GET READY

What's the difference between making your writing better and making it correct?

Revising makes writing better: clearer order, stronger words, more details. Editing makes writing correct: capitals, punctuation, spelling. Do both before you publish.

Revising checklist	Editing checklist
Does my story have a clear beginning, middle, and end?	Do sentences begin with capital letters?
Did I use transition words?	Do sentences end with . ? or !
Did I replace tired words with precise ones?	Is dialogue in quotation marks?
Did I show feelings with actions and dialogue?	Are words spelled correctly?

MODEL · REVISE AND EDIT

the knight went to the castle he was tired

1 Revise: “went” → “trudged”; add a detail.

2 Edit: capitalize The; split the run-on with a period.

Model answer: The knight trudged up the hill to the castle. He was so tired that his armor felt like a mountain on his shoulders.

KEY IDEA

Revise for ideas and words; edit for correctness. Then publish a clean copy.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Edit: sir kay lost his sword

2. Revise: The dragon was big.

3. Is fixing spelling revising or editing?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise for ideas and words, edit for correctness, then publish.

UNIT 1 REVIEW

Unit 1 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
1.1	Legends are old hero stories. Describe characters and settings with text details.
1.2	Prefixes come at the beginning of words: un-, dis-, non- (not), re- (again), mis- (wrongly), pre- (before).
1.3	Suffixes come at the end: -ful (full of), -less (without), -ly (how), -ness (state of), -able (can be), -er/-or (person who).
1.4	Roots carry meaning: tele (far), phon (sound), graph (write), port (carry), aud (hear), vis (see).
1.5	Definition and restatement clues explain the word right in the sentence. Watch for commas, dashes, parentheses, is, means, or.
1.6	Synonym clues show the same meaning; antonym clues (but, unlike, on the other hand) show the opposite.
1.7	Example clues follow such as, like, including. Without a clear clue, infer from all the details.
1.8	Use context to pick the right meaning; check it in a dictionary using guide words.
1.9	Similes compare with like or as; metaphors say one thing is another. Explain how the things are alike.
1.10	Idioms and proverbs mean something different from their words. Use context to find the real meaning.
1.11	Synonyms differ in strength and feeling. Choose the most precise word.
1.12	Academic words tell you what to do; content words name things in a topic.
1.13	Strong verbs and vivid adjectives help readers picture your writing.
1.14	Plan beginning, middle, and end; connect events with transition words.
1.15	Show, don't tell: use dialogue, actions, and sensory details.
1.16	Revise for ideas and words, edit for correctness, then publish.

UNIT 2

Reading Closely

Text evidence, inference, theme and main idea, and summary, with King Arthur and the Round Table, Chapters 5–8.

Good readers don't just read the words; they find evidence, read between the lines, discover the lessons stories teach, and retell what matters most. In this unit you will practice all four skills with the legends of the Round Table, fables, and informational articles.

In this unit you will…

- Quote and paraphrase text evidence; choose the strongest evidence.
- Make and support inferences about characters and facts.
- Determine themes in stories and main ideas in informational texts.
- Summarize stories and articles and explain how events connect.

WHY IT MATTERS

Evidence and inference help you everywhere: deciding whether an ad is telling the truth, figuring out how a friend feels, or explaining your ideas to others.

UNIT VOCABULARY

text evidence	Details from a text that support an answer.
inference	Clues + what I know.
theme	A story's life lesson.
main idea	The most important point of an informational text.
summary	A short retelling of the most important parts.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
2.1	Text Evidence: Quoting and Paraphrasing
2.2	Text Evidence in Informational Text

Lesson	Title
2.3	Choosing the Best Evidence
2.4	Writing with Evidence: The ACE Paragraph
2.5	Making Inferences
2.6	Inferring Characters' Feelings and Motives
2.7	Inferences in Informational Text
2.8	Writing to Support an Inference
2.9	Theme in Stories
2.10	How Characters Reveal Theme
2.11	Main Idea and Key Details
2.12	Comparing Themes Across Stories
2.13	Summarizing a Story
2.14	Summarizing Informational Text
2.15	How Events Develop: Cause and Effect in a Plot
2.16	Writing a Summary Paragraph

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.1 · RL.4.1

Lesson 2.1: Text Evidence: Quoting and Paraphrasing

I can support my answers by quoting or paraphrasing the text.

WORDS TO KNOW

text evidence	Words or details from a text that support an answer.
quote	Copy the author's exact words inside quotation marks.
paraphrase	Retell the author's idea in your own words.

GET READY

Your friend says the Round Table was special. How could you prove it using the book?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 5: The Marriage of Arthur and the Founding of the Round Table

As you read: Look for details that explain why the Round Table was important.

When you answer a question about a text, you need text evidence. You can quote (use the exact words in quotation marks) or paraphrase (put the idea in your own words). Either way, the evidence must come from the text.

Quote	Paraphrase
Copies the exact words	Uses your own words
Needs quotation marks	No quotation marks
Best for a word or line that matters	Best for a longer idea or event

MODEL · QUOTE AND PARAPHRASE

Why was the table round?

1. Find the part of Chapter 5 that explains the shape.
2. Paraphrase: A round table has no head, so no knight sat in a more important seat than another.
3. Add the source: “In Chapter 5…”

Model answer: In Chapter 5, the table is round so that no knight is more important than another; everyone sits as an equal.

KEY IDEA

Every answer needs proof. Quote exact words with quotation marks, or paraphrase in your own words, and tell where the evidence came from.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is the difference between a quote and a paraphrase?
2. Paraphrase: “The knights vowed to protect the weak and to be true to the king.”
3. Name one event from Chapter 5.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Support answers with evidence: quote exact words or paraphrase in your own words.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.2 · RI.4.1

Lesson 2.2: Text Evidence in Informational Text

I can find details in an informational text that answer a question.

WORDS TO KNOW

informational text	Writing that gives facts about a real topic.
detail	A fact or example that supports a bigger idea.

GET READY

If someone asked, “What were knights supposed to be like?”, where would you look for the answer?

In informational text, the answer to a question is often spread across several paragraphs. Look for key words from the question, then read the sentences around them.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Code of Chivalry

An original informational text

1 In the Middle Ages, knights were expected to follow a set of rules called the code of chivalry. The code told knights how to behave in battle and in everyday life.

2 First, a knight was supposed to be loyal. He promised to serve his lord and protect the people who lived on his lord's land. Breaking that promise was one of the worst things a knight could do.

3 Second, a knight was expected to be brave. He had to face danger instead of running away, even when he was afraid.

4 Third, a knight was supposed to show courtesy, or good manners. He was to be polite to everyone and to protect people who could not protect themselves, such as children and the poor.

5 Not every knight followed the code. Some were greedy or cruel. Still, the code of chivalry gave people an idea of what a good knight should be, and that idea lives on in stories such as the legends of King Arthur.

MODEL · FIND THE EVIDENCE

What did the code say about people who could not protect themselves?

1 Key words: protect themselves.

2 Find them in paragraph 4.

3 Paraphrase the detail.

Model answer: Knights were supposed to protect people who could not protect themselves, such as children and the poor (paragraph 4).

KEY IDEA

Find key words from the question in the text. Use the paragraph number to show where your evidence is.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What three things did the code expect of knights?
2. Did every knight follow the code? Give evidence.
3. What does courtesy mean? Which paragraph?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use key words to find evidence; cite the paragraph.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.3 · RL.4.1, RI.4.1

Lesson 2.3: Choosing the Best Evidence

I can choose the evidence that best supports an answer.

WORDS TO KNOW

relevant	Connected to the question.
strongest evidence	The detail that most clearly proves the answer.

GET READY

Two details are both true. How do you decide which one proves your point better?

Not all evidence is equally strong. The best evidence is relevant (it is about the question) and specific (it clearly proves the answer). Weak evidence is true but doesn't really prove the point.

MODEL · COMPARE EVIDENCE

Claim: The ants in a fable are hardworking. Which evidence is strongest?

1 A. The ants lived in a nest. (true, but not about working)

2 B. The ants marched back and forth all summer carrying seeds. (shows hard work)

3 C. The ants shared food. (shows kindness, not hard work)

Model answer: B is the strongest evidence.

KEY IDEA

Ask: Does this detail prove my answer, or is it just true? Choose the most specific, relevant detail.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Claim: Merlin is wise. Strong or weak? “Merlin had a long beard.”
2. Claim: Merlin is wise. Strong or weak? “Merlin knew what would happen before it happened.”
3. Why is the first detail weak?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

The best evidence is relevant and specific: it clearly proves the answer.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.4 · W.4.9, W.4.1b

Lesson 2.4: Writing with Evidence: The ACE Paragraph

I can write a paragraph that answers a question and supports it with evidence.

WORDS TO KNOW

ACE	Answer the question, Cite evidence, Explain how the evidence supports your answer.

GET READY

What makes an answer in writing convincing?

A strong written response follows ACE: Answer the question in a complete sentence, Cite evidence from the text, and Explain how the evidence proves your answer.

Step	Sentence starters
Answer	I think... / The answer is... / In Chapter 5, ...
Cite	The text says, "..." / In paragraph 3, the author explains... / For example, ...
Explain	This shows that... / This proves... / This means...

MODEL · AN ACE PARAGRAPH

Question: Why did knights follow the code of chivalry?

1 Answer: Knights followed the code because it told them how a good knight should act.

2 Cite: The passage says the code "told knights how to behave in battle and in everyday life."

3 Explain: This shows that the code was a guide that helped knights know what was right.

Model answer: Knights followed the code because it told them how a good knight should act. The passage says the code "told knights how to behave in battle and in everyday life." This shows the code was a guide for doing what was right.

KEY IDEA

Answer, Cite, Explain. The Explain sentence connects the evidence to your answer.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does the C in ACE stand for?
2. Write an Explain starter.
3. Why do you need the Explain step?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

ACE: Answer, Cite evidence, Explain.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.5 · RL.4.1

Lesson 2.5: Making Inferences

I can make an inference by combining text clues with what I already know.

WORDS TO KNOW

inference	A smart guess based on clues in the text and what you already know.
clue	A detail that hints at something the author doesn't say directly.

GET READY

Your friend walks in with a wet umbrella and muddy boots. What can you figure out without asking?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 6: Sir Lancelot

As you read: What does the author show about Lancelot without saying it directly?

Authors don't tell readers everything. Readers make inferences: Text clues + What I know = Inference.

REALISTIC FICTION

The Missing Bread

An original story

1 When Grandma came into the kitchen, the loaf of bread she had left cooling on the counter was gone. Only a few crumbs were left on the plate.

2 She looked around. The back door was open a crack. On the floor, a trail of tiny crumbs led toward it. Next to the door was a muddy paw print, about the size of a coin.

3 Grandma followed the trail outside. Under the porch, she heard a soft crunching sound. She knelt down and peeked. Two shiny eyes blinked back at her, and a fluffy striped tail swished.

4 Grandma laughed. “Well,” she said, “I guess I'll be baking another loaf.”

MODEL · MAKE AN INFERENCE

Who took the bread?

1 Clues: crumbs lead to the door; a small paw print; a fluffy striped tail under the porch.

2 What I know: raccoons have striped tails and steal food.

3 Inference: an animal, probably a raccoon, took the bread.

Model answer: A raccoon took the bread. The striped tail, the small paw print, and the crumb trail are the clues.

KEY IDEA

Text clues + what I know = inference. An inference must be supported by clues.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How does Grandma feel at the end? What clue tells you?
2. What did the animal use to get in?
3. What will Grandma do next?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Inference = text clues + what I know.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.6 · RL.4.3, RL.4.1

Lesson 2.6: Inferring Characters' Feelings and Motives

I can infer how characters feel and why they act as they do, using their words and actions.

WORDS TO KNOW

motive	The reason a character does something.
trait	A word that describes what a character is like, such as brave or selfish.

GET READY

How can you tell someone is nervous even if they don't say so?

Authors show feelings and motives through what characters say, do, think, and how others react. Look closely at body language and dialogue.

REALISTIC FICTION

Mira's Recital

An original story

1 Mira sat on the edge of her chair backstage, twisting the hem of her dress. Every few seconds she peeked through the curtain at the rows of people. Her stomach felt like it was full of butterflies.

2 When her name was called, she walked slowly to the piano. Her fingers trembled above the keys. She took a deep breath, closed her eyes for a moment, and began to play.

3 The first notes were shaky, but soon the music flowed. By the last chord, Mira was smiling. When the audience clapped, she bowed so low her braid almost touched the floor.

4 Backstage, her teacher hugged her. “I knew you could do it,” he said. Mira grinned. “Can I play two songs next year?”

MODEL · INFER A FEELING

How does Mira feel before she plays?

1 Actions: twists her dress, peeks at the audience.

2 Body: butterflies in her stomach, trembling fingers.

Model answer: Mira is nervous.

MODEL · INFER A CHANGE

How does Mira feel at the end? Why does she ask to play two songs?

1 She smiles and grins.

2 Wanting more shows she enjoyed it.

Model answer: Proud and confident; she wants to perform again.

KEY IDEA

Use what characters say, do, and think to infer feelings, traits, and motives.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “closed her eyes for a moment” suggest?
2. What trait does Mira show by playing anyway?
3. How does her teacher feel? Evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Characters' words, actions, and thoughts reveal feelings, traits, and motives.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.7 · RI.4.1

Lesson 2.7: Inferences in Informational Text

I can make inferences from facts in an informational text.

WORDS TO KNOW

conclude	Decide something based on evidence.

GET READY

If a text says bees eat honey all winter, what can you infer about why they make so much honey in summer?

Informational texts give facts, but readers still make inferences by connecting facts that the author doesn't connect directly.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Honeybees in Winter

An original informational text

1 Many insects die or sleep through the winter, but honeybees stay busy. When the weather turns cold, the bees gather in a tight ball inside their hive called a winter cluster.

2 Bees in the center of the cluster shiver their wing muscles without flapping their wings. This shivering makes heat. The bees take turns moving from the cold outside of the cluster to the warm center.

3 All winter, the bees eat honey they stored during the summer. A strong hive may eat 50 pounds of honey before spring. Beekeepers who take too much honey in the fall may find an empty hive when the flowers bloom again.

MODEL · CONNECT FACTS

Why might beekeepers who take too much honey find an empty hive?

1 Fact: bees eat stored honey all winter.

2 Fact: a hive may eat 50 pounds.

3 Connect: without enough honey, the bees starve or leave.

Model answer: If the beekeeper takes too much honey, the bees won't have enough food for winter and may die.

KEY IDEA

Connect two or more facts to infer something the author does not say directly.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why do bees take turns in the center?
2. Infer: Why do bees store honey in summer?
3. What can you infer about bees' shivering?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Connect facts to infer what the author doesn't state.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.8 · W.4.9a, RL.4.1

Lesson 2.8: Writing to Support an Inference

I can write a paragraph that states an inference and supports it with clues.

GET READY

How would you convince someone your inference is right?

When you write about an inference, use ACE: Answer with your inference, Cite at least two clues, and Explain how the clues plus what you know lead to the inference.

MODEL · INFERENCE PARAGRAPH

Question: What kind of worker is Tom in “The Blacksmith's Apprentice” (Lesson 1.5)?

1 Answer: Tom is hardworking and takes pride in his work.

2 Cite: After a week, “Tom's arms ached and his face was smudged with soot,” but he “felt as proud as a king.”

3 Explain: Aching arms and soot show how hard he worked, and feeling proud shows he cared about doing the job well.

Model answer: Tom is hardworking and takes pride in his work. After his first week, his arms ached and his face was covered in soot, yet he felt as proud as a king. His aching arms show how hard he worked, and his pride shows he cared about doing a good job.

KEY IDEA

An inference paragraph needs at least two clues and an explanation of how they connect.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How many clues should an inference paragraph include?
2. What goes in the Explain part?
3. Can an inference be wrong?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

State the inference, cite two clues, and explain the connection.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.9 · RL.4.2

Lesson 2.9: Theme in Stories

I can determine the theme of a story from the characters' actions and what they learn.

WORDS TO KNOW

theme	The message or lesson about life that a story teaches.
topic	What a story is about in one or two words, like friendship.

GET READY

What lesson does a story like “The Tortoise and the Hare” teach?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 7: Sir Tristram

As you read: What lessons about love, loyalty, or choices could this chapter teach?

The theme is the big message about life. It is usually not stated. To find it, ask: What does the main character learn? What happens because of the character's choices? Write the theme as a full sentence.

FABLE

The Grasshopper and the Ants

An original retelling of an Aesop fable

1 All summer long, a grasshopper played his fiddle in the warm grass. Nearby, a line of ants marched back and forth, carrying seeds to their nest.

2 "Why work so hard?" laughed the grasshopper. "Come and sing with me! There is plenty of food everywhere."

3 "We are storing food for the winter," said one ant, never putting down her seed. "You should do the same."

4 The grasshopper only played louder. Then winter came. Snow covered the grass, and the grasshopper could find nothing to eat. Shivering and hungry, he knocked at the ants' door.

5 The ants shared a little food with him, and the grasshopper said, "Next summer, I will play and work."

MODEL · FIND THE THEME

What is the theme of "The Grasshopper and the Ants"?

1 The grasshopper plays instead of preparing.

2 In winter he is hungry; he learns to work.

3 Life lesson: preparing for the future matters.

Model answer: It is wise to prepare today for what you will need tomorrow.

WATCH OUT

A topic is one or two words (hard work). A theme is a sentence about life (Hard work today helps you tomorrow).

KEY IDEA

Theme = what the character learns, written as a lesson for everyone.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Topic of the fable
2. What does the grasshopper learn?
3. Write another way to say the theme.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Theme is the life lesson; find it in what the character learns.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.10 · RL.4.2, RL.4.3

Lesson 2.10: How Characters Reveal Theme

I can explain how a character's choices and changes reveal the theme.

WORDS TO KNOW

conflict	A problem or struggle in a story.
resolution	How the problem is solved.

GET READY

Think of a character who made a mistake and learned from it. How did the mistake teach a lesson?

Themes grow out of conflict and resolution. Notice what a character chooses, what happens because of the choice, and how the character changes.

REALISTIC FICTION

The Two Gardens

An original story

1 Ruby and her neighbor Sam each planted a garden in the spring. Sam bought the biggest plants at the store and put them in the ground all at once. Ruby planted tiny seeds and watered them every morning.

2 In May, Sam's garden looked wonderful, and Ruby's looked like a patch of dirt. Sam teased her. “Your garden is invisible!”

3 But Sam forgot to water. By July, his plants were brown and drooping. Meanwhile, Ruby's seeds had grown into tall tomato vines and bright zinnias.

4 In August, Ruby brought Sam a basket of tomatoes. “Maybe next year,” he said with an embarrassed smile, “you can teach me how to garden.”

MODEL · TRACE THE THEME

How do Sam's choices reveal the theme?

1 Choice: Sam buys big plants and forgets to water.

2 Result: his plants die.

3 Change: he asks Ruby to teach him.

Model answer: Theme: Patience and steady effort pay off more than quick, easy shortcuts.

KEY IDEA

Choices → results → changes. The lesson the character learns points to the theme.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is the conflict?

2. How is it resolved?

3. How does Sam change?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

A character's choices and changes reveal the theme.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.11 · RI.4.2

Lesson 2.11: Main Idea and Key Details

I can determine the main idea of an informational text and explain how key details support it.

WORDS TO KNOW

main idea	The most important point of an informational text.
key details	Facts and examples that support the main idea.

GET READY

If you had to tell a friend what a science article was about in one sentence, what would you say?

In informational text, the main idea is the most important point. Key details support it. The main idea might be stated in the first or last paragraph, or you may need to figure it out from the details.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Why Leaves Change Color

An original informational text

1 Every fall, trees in many parts of the country turn red, orange, and gold. The colors are not new. Many of them were inside the leaves all along.

2 During spring and summer, leaves are full of a green chemical called chlorophyll. Chlorophyll helps the tree use sunlight to make food. There is so much of it that it hides the other colors.

3 When days get shorter and cooler, the tree stops making chlorophyll. As the green fades, yellow and orange colors that were hidden begin to show. Some trees, like maples, also make new red colors in the fall.

4 Finally, the leaves dry up and fall. The tree rests through the winter and grows new green leaves in the spring.

MODEL · FIND THE MAIN IDEA

What is the main idea of “Why Leaves Change Color”?

1 Detail: chlorophyll hides other colors in summer.

2 Detail: in fall, chlorophyll fades and hidden colors show.

3 Detail: maples make new red colors.

4 These all explain why leaves change.

Model answer: Leaves change color in the fall because the green chlorophyll fades, letting other colors show.

KEY IDEA

Main idea = the point all the key details support. Check: does every important detail connect to it?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Key detail from paragraph 2
2. Key detail from paragraph 3
3. Is “Maples are trees” a key detail? Why?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

The main idea is supported by every key detail.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.12 · RL.4.9

Lesson 2.12: Comparing Themes Across Stories

I can compare how two stories share or differ in theme.

WORDS TO KNOW

compare	Tell how things are alike.
contrast	Tell how things are different.

GET READY

Can two very different stories teach the same lesson?

Stories from different times and places often share themes. When you compare, name the theme each story teaches, then show how each story's events teach it.

MODEL · COMPARE THEMES

"The Grasshopper and the Ants" and "The Two Gardens"

1. Fable: the grasshopper didn't prepare and went hungry.
2. Garden story: Sam didn't take care of his plants and they died.
3. Same theme: steady work and preparation pay off.
4. Different: one has animal characters and talking; the other is realistic.

Model answer: Both stories teach that steady effort and preparation pay off, but one uses talking animals and the other uses real-life neighbors.

	Grasshopper and the Ants	The Two Gardens
Characters	grasshopper, ants	Ruby, Sam
Genre	fable	realistic fiction
Lesson learned	work and prepare	patience and effort
Shared theme	Effort today pays off later.	Effort today pays off later.

KEY IDEA

Compare themes by naming the lesson in each story and the events that teach it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How are the two stories alike?
2. How are they different?
3. Which character in each story learns the lesson?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Different stories can share a theme; compare the lesson and how events teach it.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.13 · RL.4.2

Lesson 2.13: Summarizing a Story

I can summarize a story using the most important events.

WORDS TO KNOW

summary	A short retelling of the most important parts of a text, in your own words.

GET READY

If your friend missed a movie, how would you tell them about it in under a minute?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 8: The End of Merlin

As you read: What are the most important events? What happens to Merlin?

A summary tells only the most important events, in order, in your own words. It leaves out small details and opinions. One helpful frame is Somebody–Wanted–But–So–Then.

HISTORICAL FICTION

The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter

An original story

1 Nell lived with her father in a lighthouse on a rocky island. Every night, her father climbed the tower to light the great lamp that warned ships away from the rocks.

2 One stormy night, her father slipped on the wet stairs and hurt his ankle. He could not climb. Through the window, Nell saw the lights of a fishing boat heading straight for the rocks.

3 Nell grabbed the lantern and climbed the hundred winding stairs. The wind shook the tower, and rain lashed the glass. With trembling hands, she lit the great lamp. Its beam swept across the dark water.

4 The fishing boat turned just in time. The next morning, the fishermen rowed to the island to thank the brave girl who had saved their lives.

MODEL · SUMMARIZE WITH SWBST

"The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter"

1 Somebody: Nell

2 Wanted: to keep ships safe when her father couldn't light the lamp

3 But: there was a storm and he hurt his ankle

4 So: she climbed the tower and lit the lamp herself

5 Then: the boat turned in time and the fishermen thanked her

Model answer: When her father hurt his ankle during a storm, Nell climbed the lighthouse tower and lit the lamp herself. The fishing boat turned just in time, and the fishermen thanked her for saving their lives.

KEY IDEA

A summary is short, in order, in your own words, and includes only the most important events.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Should a summary include "rain lashed the glass"?

2. Should a summary include your opinion?

3. Who is the Somebody in Chapter 8?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Summaries are short, in order, in your own words. Use Somebody–Wanted–But–So–Then.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.14 · RI.4.2

Lesson 2.14: Summarizing Informational Text

I can summarize an informational text using the main idea and key details.

GET READY

How is summarizing an article different from summarizing a story?

An informational summary starts with the main idea, then gives the most important key details, in your own words. There are no characters or plot, so SWBST doesn't fit.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Printing Press

An original informational text

1 Before the 1450s, books in Europe were copied by hand. A single book could take a monk months to finish, so books were rare and very expensive.

2 Around 1450, a German metalworker named Johannes Gutenberg built a printing press with metal letters that could be moved and reused. Workers arranged the letters, inked them, and pressed paper on top. They could print hundreds of pages a day.

3 Books became cheaper, and more people learned to read. Ideas about science, religion, and government spread quickly from city to city.

4 Today, historians call the printing press one of the most important inventions in history.

MODEL · SUMMARIZE

"The Printing Press"

1 Main idea: Gutenberg's printing press changed the world by making books cheaper and more common.

2 Key details: before, books were copied by hand; the press used movable metal letters; more people read and ideas spread.

Model answer: Gutenberg's printing press, built around 1450, changed the world. Before it, books were copied by hand and were rare. The press used movable metal letters to print hundreds of pages a day, so books became cheaper, more people learned to read, and ideas spread quickly.

KEY IDEA

Informational summary = main idea + two or three key details, in your own words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Main idea of the passage
2. One key detail
3. Should a summary include the exact year?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Informational summary: main idea plus key details in your own words.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.15 · RL.4.3

Lesson 2.15: How Events Develop: Cause and Effect in a Plot

I can explain how one event in a story leads to another.

WORDS TO KNOW

plot	The sequence of events in a story.
cause	Why something happens.
effect	What happens as a result.

GET READY

In a chain of dominoes, how does the first one make the last one fall?

Events in a plot are connected like dominoes: one cause leads to an effect, which can cause another effect. Signal words: because, so, as a result, since, therefore.

MODEL · TRACE A CHAIN

"The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter"

1 Cause: Father hurts his ankle → Effect: he can't climb to light the lamp.

2 Cause: The lamp isn't lit → Effect: the boat heads for the rocks.

3 Cause: Nell lights the lamp → Effect: the boat turns in time.

Model answer: Each event causes the next: the injury leads Nell to climb the tower, which saves the boat.

KEY IDEA

Explain how events connect: this happened because of that. Use signal words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why did the fishermen row to the island?
2. Why did Nell climb the tower?
3. Name a cause-effect signal word.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plot events connect through cause and effect.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2.16 · W.4.2, RL.4.2

Lesson 2.16: Writing a Summary Paragraph

I can write a well-organized summary paragraph and review the unit.

WORDS TO KNOW

topic sentence	The first sentence that tells what the paragraph is about.

GET READY

What makes a summary paragraph easy to follow?

A summary paragraph begins with a topic sentence naming the text and its main idea or theme, gives the important events or details in order with transitions, and ends with a concluding sentence.

MODEL · SUMMARY PARAGRAPH

Summarize Chapters 5–8 of King Arthur.

1 Topic sentence: In Chapters 5–8, Arthur's kingdom grows strong, but trouble begins.

2 Middle: the Round Table is founded; great knights such as Lancelot and Tristram arrive; Merlin's story ends.

3 Concluding sentence: tie it together.

Model answer: A paragraph with a topic sentence, three to four key events in order with transitions, and a conclusion.

KEY IDEA

Topic sentence → events or details in order → concluding sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where does the topic sentence go?
2. Name two transitions for a summary.
3. Should a summary include every event?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 2.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Summary paragraph: topic sentence, events in order, concluding sentence.

UNIT 2 REVIEW

Unit 2 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
2.1	Support answers with evidence: quote exact words or paraphrase in your own words.
2.2	Use key words to find evidence; cite the paragraph.
2.3	The best evidence is relevant and specific: it clearly proves the answer.
2.4	ACE: Answer, Cite evidence, Explain.
2.5	Inference = text clues + what I know.
2.6	Characters' words, actions, and thoughts reveal feelings, traits, and motives.
2.7	Connect facts to infer what the author doesn't state.
2.8	State the inference, cite two clues, and explain the connection.
2.9	Theme is the life lesson; find it in what the character learns.
2.10	A character's choices and changes reveal the theme.
2.11	The main idea is supported by every key detail.
2.12	Different stories can share a theme; compare the lesson and how events teach it.
2.13	Summaries are short, in order, in your own words. Use Somebody–Wanted–But–So–Then.
2.14	Informational summary: main idea plus key details in your own words.
2.15	Plot events connect through cause and effect.
2.16	Summary paragraph: topic sentence, events in order, concluding sentence.

UNIT 3

Reading Longer Texts

Stamina, annotation, point of view, tracking evidence, inference, and organized written responses, with King Arthur Chapters 9–12.

Longer texts ask more of readers: staying focused, keeping track of characters and ideas, and pulling evidence together from many places. In this unit you will read a three-part adventure story, a history of cathedral building, and the beginning of the Grail quest, and you will write your first multi-paragraph responses.

In this unit you will…

- Read long texts in chunks and annotate them.
- Use fix-up strategies and identify point of view.
- Track characters and ideas across a text and synthesize evidence.
- Explain inferences with evidence and reasoning.
- Plan, draft, and revise an organized multi-paragraph response.

WHY IT MATTERS

Long reading assignments, research projects, and tests all require stamina, organized notes, and clear written answers.

UNIT VOCABULARY

stamina	Ability to keep going.
annotate	Mark a text while reading.
narrator	The voice telling the story.
synthesize	Combine information.
reasoning	How evidence supports an idea.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
3.1	Building Reading Stamina
3.2	Annotating a Text
3.3	Fix-Up Strategies
3.4	Narrator and Point of View
3.5	Tracking a Character Across a Text
3.6	Explaining Events and Procedures
3.7	Connecting Evidence from Several Paragraphs
3.8	Writing with Evidence from Across a Text
3.9	Inferences and Predictions
3.10	Inferring the Theme of a Longer Story
3.11	Inferring the Author's Ideas in Informational Text
3.12	Explaining an Inference in Writing
3.13	Understanding the Prompt
3.14	Planning an Organized Response
3.15	Drafting the Response
3.16	Revising for Organization

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.1 · RL.4.10, RL.4.1

Lesson 3.1: Building Reading Stamina

I can read a longer text by breaking it into chunks and checking my understanding.

WORDS TO KNOW

stamina	The ability to keep going for a long time.
chunk	A small section of a text, such as a few paragraphs.
gist	The general idea of a section.

GET READY

What helps you keep going when you read a long chapter?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 9: The Birth of Galahad

As you read: Stop after every few paragraphs and tell yourself the gist.

Long texts can feel overwhelming. Strong readers break them into chunks. After each chunk, they stop and state the gist in a few words before moving on.

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 1

An original story in three parts

1 Nobody in the village of Thornbury went near Hollow Hill. The grown-ups said the hill was dangerous, though none of them could say exactly why. Children whispered that a dragon slept beneath it, or a giant, or the ghost of a wicked king.

2 Eleven-year-old Pip didn't believe in dragons. She believed in maps. Her grandfather had been the village mapmaker, and when he died, he left Pip his drawings, his compass, and a small brass key with no lock to fit it.

3 One rainy afternoon, Pip spread Grandfather's oldest map across the kitchen table. In the corner, in faded ink, she noticed something she had never seen before: a tiny drawing of a door on the side of Hollow Hill. Beneath it, Grandfather had written three words: For Pip. Courage.

4 Pip's heart beat faster. She ran her finger over the words again and again. Grandfather had known she would find this. But why hadn't he told her?

5 That night, she could hardly sleep. Each time she closed her eyes, she saw the little door. By morning, she had made up her mind. She packed bread, a candle, the compass, and the brass key, and she slipped out of the house before anyone else was awake.

6 Fog lay over the fields like a gray blanket. As Pip walked, the village roosters began to crow behind her. Ahead, Hollow Hill rose dark and silent. Her legs felt heavy, and twice she almost turned back. Then she remembered the words on the map. Courage. She kept walking.

MODEL · CHUNK AND STATE THE GIST

Paragraphs 1–2

1 Read paragraphs 1–2.

2 Ask: What is this part mostly about?

3 Say it in a few words.

Model answer: People fear Hollow Hill; Pip loves maps and got her grandfather's things.

KEY IDEA

Read a chunk, stop, state the gist, then keep going.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Gist of paragraph 3
2. Gist of paragraphs 5–6
3. What do you predict Pip will find?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Break long texts into chunks; state the gist after each one.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.2 · RL.4.1, RI.4.1

Lesson 3.2: Annotating a Text

I can annotate a text by marking important ideas, questions, and new words.

WORDS TO KNOW

annotate	Make notes and marks on a text while reading.

GET READY

If you could write on the pages of a book, what would you mark?

Annotating means marking a text as you read. It keeps you active and helps you find evidence later. Use the same symbols every time.

Symbol	Means
underline	important idea or event
?	I have a question
!	surprising or exciting
circle	new or interesting word
*	evidence about a character

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 2

An original story in three parts

1 Thorny bushes covered the side of the hill. Pip pushed through them, scratching her arms, until she found a gray stone almost hidden in the weeds. Carved into the stone was a keyhole.

2 Her hands shook as she pulled out the brass key. It slid in perfectly. With a loud click, the stone swung inward, and cool air rushed out of a dark tunnel.

3 Pip lit her candle. The tunnel walls were smooth and dry, and someone had painted arrows on them in white paint. She followed the arrows deeper and deeper, counting her steps the way Grandfather had taught her. Two hundred steps. Three hundred.

4 At last the tunnel opened into a round room. Pip gasped. The walls were covered with maps, hundreds of them, showing rivers, forests, roads, and towns, some she knew and some she had never heard of. In the middle of the room stood a wooden desk, and on the desk lay a letter with her name on it.

5 Dear Pip, the letter began. For fifty years, I have mapped every corner of this valley. I kept this room secret because I was afraid people would laugh at an old man who spent his life drawing. But you never laughed. You asked questions. Now this room is yours. Please don't let my work stay hidden in the dark.

6 Pip read the letter three times. Then she sat down at Grandfather's desk and cried, but they were not entirely sad tears.

MODEL · ANNOTATE A PARAGRAPH

Paragraph 4

1 Underline: the room is covered with hundreds of maps.

2 ! Pip gasped.

3 ? Who wrote the letter?

Model answer: Marks show the key event, a surprise, and a question to answer later.

KEY IDEA

Annotate to stay focused and to find evidence quickly later. In a library book, use sticky notes instead of writing.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What symbol shows a question?
2. Which detail in paragraph 3 would you mark with *?
3. Which word might you circle?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Annotate with symbols to stay focused and find evidence.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.3 · RL.4.10

Lesson 3.3: Fix-Up Strategies

I can notice when I'm confused and use a strategy to fix it.

WORDS TO KNOW

monitor	Keep track of whether you understand.
visualize	Make a picture in your mind.

GET READY

What do you do when you realize you've read a whole page and don't remember any of it?

Strong readers monitor their understanding. When the meaning breaks down, they use a fix-up strategy.

- Reread the confusing part slowly.
- Read ahead a little to see if it becomes clear.
- Visualize what is happening.
- Ask a question and look for the answer.
- Use context clues for a hard word.
- Retell what you just read in your own words.

ADVENTURE STORY

The Secret of Hollow Hill · Part 3

An original story in three parts

1 When Pip returned to Thornbury, the whole village was searching for her. Her mother hugged her so hard she could barely breathe. Then, of course, came the scolding.

2 “Hollow Hill?” the mayor sputtered. “That hill is dangerous!”

3 “It isn't,” Pip said quietly. “There's nothing dangerous inside. Only maps.” And she told them everything.

4 At first, people didn't believe her. So the next day, Pip led a group of villagers through the thorny bushes and into the tunnel. When they saw the round room, no one said a word. Old Mrs. Barrow touched a map of her family's farm, drawn more carefully than any she had ever seen, and her eyes filled with tears.

5 That spring, the villagers carried Grandfather's maps down from Hollow Hill and hung them in the town hall. Travelers came from far away to see them. The mayor named the room the Mapmaker's Library and asked Pip to be its keeper.

6 Children in Thornbury still whisper about Hollow Hill. But now, instead of dragons, they talk about a girl who was brave enough to follow a map, and a grandfather who was brave enough, in the end, to share his work.

MODEL · FIX CONFUSION

Paragraph 6: “a grandfather who was brave enough, in the end, to share his work.” How was sharing brave?

1 Reread Part 2: Grandfather hid his maps because he feared people would laugh.

2 Connect: sharing meant facing that fear.

Model answer: Sharing was brave because he had been afraid of being laughed at.

KEY IDEA

Notice confusion, then choose a fix-up strategy instead of skipping ahead.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which strategy would you use for a hard word?
2. Which strategy helps with a confusing event?
3. Why does Mrs. Barrow cry?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Monitor your reading; when confused, reread, read ahead, visualize, ask, use context, or retell.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.4 · RL.4.6

Lesson 3.4: Narrator and Point of View

I can tell whether a story is told in first person or third person and explain how it affects what we learn.

WORDS TO KNOW

narrator	The voice telling the story.
first-person point of view	The narrator is a character who uses I, me, and my.
third-person point of view	The narrator is outside the story and uses he, she, and they.

GET READY

Would a story sound different if the main character told it herself?

A first-person narrator is a character in the story (I, me, my). We only learn what that character knows and feels. A third-person narrator is outside the story (he, she, they) and may tell what several characters think.

FIRST-PERSON NARRATOR

The Storm (Version A)

An original example

I pressed my face to the window as thunder shook the house. My little brother crawled under the table, but I wasn't scared. Well, maybe a little.

THIRD-PERSON NARRATOR

The Storm (Version B)

An original example

Marcus pressed his face to the window as thunder shook the house. His little brother crawled under the table. Marcus told himself he wasn't scared, but his heart was pounding.

MODEL · COMPARE NARRATORS

How are Version A and Version B different?

1 A uses I; the narrator admits he's “a little” scared.

2 B uses Marcus and his; the narrator tells us his heart was pounding.

Model answer: A is first person; we hear the boy's own voice. B is third person; the narrator describes Marcus from outside.

KEY IDEA

Look for pronouns: I/me/my = first person; he/she/they = third person. Ask what the narrator can and can't know.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Point of view of “The Secret of Hollow Hill”
2. Point of view of “Grandpa's Sayings” (Lesson 1.10)
3. Point of view of the King Arthur Reader

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

First person: I/me (a character tells). Third person: he/she (an outside narrator tells).

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.5 · RL.4.3, RL.4.1

Lesson 3.5: Tracking a Character Across a Text

I can track how a character changes across a long text using evidence from several places.

WORDS TO KNOW

character change	How a character's feelings, beliefs, or actions are different at the end than at the beginning.

GET READY

Think of a character who changes over a whole book. How did you notice the change?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 10: The Coming of Galahad to Court

As you read: Track Galahad: what he does, what others say about him.

In a long text, evidence about a character is spread out. Use a tracking chart to collect evidence from the beginning, middle, and end.

Part	Evidence about Pip	What it shows
Part 1	Her legs felt heavy; twice she almost turned back.	nervous but determined
Part 2	She followed the arrows and counted her steps.	careful, brave
Part 3	She led villagers into the tunnel and became the keeper.	confident leader

MODEL · EXPLAIN THE CHANGE

How does Pip change?

1 Beginning: unsure, almost turns back.

2 End: confident; leads the village; becomes keeper.

Model answer: Pip grows from a nervous girl into a confident leader.

KEY IDEA

Collect evidence from the beginning, middle, and end to explain how a character changes.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How does the mayor change?
2. How do the village children change?
3. How does Grandfather change (from his letter)?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Track evidence from beginning, middle, and end to explain character change.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.6 · RI.4.3

Lesson 3.6: Explaining Events and Procedures

I can explain what happened and why in an informational text, using specific details.

WORDS TO KNOW

procedure	A series of steps for doing something.
sequence	The order in which things happen.

GET READY

How would you explain to a younger child how a sandwich is made, step by step?

Informational texts often explain a procedure (how something is done) or events (what happened and why). Follow the sequence with signal words like first, next, then, as, finally, and explain why each step matters.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

How a Medieval Cathedral Was Built

An original informational text

1 Cathedrals were the largest buildings in medieval Europe. Some took more than a hundred years to finish, which meant that the workers who began a cathedral often did not live to see it completed.

2 First, a master builder drew the plans. He decided how tall the walls would be, where the windows would go, and how the roof would be supported. There were no computers, so he used simple tools like string, compasses, and rulers.

3 Next, workers dug deep trenches for the foundation. The foundation had to be strong enough to hold up thousands of tons of stone, so it was sometimes dug as deep as the walls were tall.

4 Then the stonecutters went to work. In the quarry, they cut huge blocks of stone and shaped them with hammers and chisels. Each block was marked with the stonecutter's own symbol so he could be paid for his work.

5 As the walls rose, carpenters built wooden scaffolds, frames that workers stood on to reach high places. Large wheels called treadwheels, powered by men walking inside them like hamsters, lifted the heavy stones into place.

6 Finally, glassmakers created stained-glass windows. They colored glass with metals, cut it into pieces, and joined the pieces with strips of lead to make pictures. When sunlight shone through, the inside of the cathedral glowed with color.

7 Today, many medieval cathedrals are still standing. They remind us what people could build with patience, teamwork, and simple tools.

MODEL · EXPLAIN A STEP AND WHY

Why did the foundation have to be so deep?

1 Find the step: paragraph 3.

2 Reason: it had to hold up thousands of tons of stone.

Model answer: The foundation was very deep because it had to support the huge weight of the stone walls.

KEY IDEA

Explain each step in order and tell why it was needed.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What was the first step?

2. Why did stonecutters mark their blocks?

3. What powered the treadwheels?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Explain each step in order and why it mattered.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.7 · RI.4.1, RL.4.1

Lesson 3.7: Connecting Evidence from Several Paragraphs

I can combine evidence from different parts of a text to answer a big question.

WORDS TO KNOW

synthesize	Put information from different places together to form one idea.

GET READY

Can one paragraph always answer a big question?

Big questions need evidence from more than one place. Synthesize by finding a detail in each part, then explaining what they show together.

MODEL · SYNTHESIZE

What qualities did cathedral builders need? (Lesson 3.6 passage)

1 Paragraph 2: master builder planned with simple tools → skill and planning.

2 Paragraph 4: stonecutters shaped huge blocks → strength and skill.

3 Paragraph 1 and 7: took over 100 years; patience and teamwork.

Model answer: Builders needed skill, strength, and above all patience and teamwork, because the work took generations.

KEY IDEA

For big questions: gather evidence from several paragraphs, then explain what it shows together.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Evidence that Grandfather loved Pip (two parts of Hollow Hill)

2. Evidence that the village valued the maps (Part 3)

3. What does synthesize mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Combine evidence from several parts to answer big questions.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.8 · W.4.9, W.4.2b

Lesson 3.8: Writing with Evidence from Across a Text

I can write a paragraph that uses evidence from at least two parts of a text.

GET READY

How can you show a reader that your answer is backed up throughout the whole text?

Use ACE with two citations from different parts of the text, joined by transitions such as at the beginning, later, in addition, by the end.

MODEL · TWO-CITATION ACE

How does Pip show courage?

1 A: Pip shows courage again and again.

2 C1: At the beginning, she keeps walking even though she almost turns back.

3 C2: Later, she unlocks the door and follows the tunnel alone.

4 E: Each time she is afraid, she chooses to keep going.

Model answer: Pip shows courage again and again. At the beginning, her legs feel heavy and she almost turns back, but she keeps walking. Later, she unlocks the stone door and follows the dark tunnel alone. Each time she is afraid, she chooses to keep going, which is what courage means.

KEY IDEA

Use two pieces of evidence from different parts and connect them with transitions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two transitions for linking evidence.
2. Why use two pieces of evidence?
3. Where should the explanation go?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Two citations from different parts + transitions + explanation.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.9 · RL.4.1

Lesson 3.9: Inferences and Predictions

I can make predictions and inferences and revise them as I read.

WORDS TO KNOW

prediction	An inference about what will happen next.

GET READY

Have you ever predicted the ending of a movie and been wrong? What made you change your mind?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 11: How the Quest Began

As you read: What is the quest? Predict what will happen to the knights.

A prediction is an inference about what will happen. Good readers base predictions on clues and revise them when new information appears.

MODEL · REVISE A PREDICTION

Hollow Hill

1 Part 1 clue: children whisper of dragons; Pip has a key. Prediction: she'll find something dangerous or a treasure.

2 Part 2 new information: the room holds maps and a letter.

3 Revise: the treasure is Grandfather's work, not gold.

Model answer: Predictions change as new clues appear; that's what good readers do.

KEY IDEA

Predict from clues; confirm or revise as you read.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What clue in Part 1 suggested Pip would find a door?
2. Was the prediction "a dragon lives there" supported?
3. Predict one thing that happens next in Chapter 12.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Predictions are inferences; confirm or revise them as you read.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.10 · RL.4.2

Lesson 3.10: Inferring the Theme of a Longer Story

I can infer the theme of a longer story using evidence from the whole text.

GET READY

How is finding the theme of a long story different from finding it in a fable?

In fables, the lesson is often stated. In longer stories, the theme builds slowly. Look at what changes, what the characters learn, and what the title and ending suggest.

MODEL · INFER A THEME

"The Secret of Hollow Hill"

1 What Pip learns: courage leads to discovery.

2 What Grandfather learns: sharing your work matters.

3 What the village learns: fear came from not knowing.

Model answer: Possible themes: Courage helps us discover the truth. / Fear of the unknown can be overcome by facing it. / Sharing your gifts is better than hiding them.

KEY IDEA

A long story can have more than one theme. Support your theme with evidence from several parts.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What theme does the mayor's change support?

2. What does the final paragraph suggest about courage?

3. Give one theme in your own words.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Long stories build themes slowly; support them with evidence from across the text.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.11 · RI.4.8, RI.4.1

Lesson 3.11: Inferring the Author's Ideas in Informational Text

I can infer what an author thinks about a topic from the details and words chosen.

WORDS TO KNOW

author's point	The idea the author wants readers to believe or understand.

GET READY

If an author calls a building "breathtaking," what does the author think of it?

Informational authors show their ideas through the details they include and the words they choose. Look for opinion words and the conclusion.

MODEL · INFER THE AUTHOR'S POINT

"How a Medieval Cathedral Was Built"

1 Word choice: "glowed with color."

2 Conclusion: they remind us what people could build "with patience, teamwork, and simple tools."

Model answer: The author admires the cathedral builders and thinks their work is impressive.

KEY IDEA

Word choice and the conclusion reveal what the author thinks.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which words show the author admires stained glass?

2. What does the author want us to remember?

3. Does the author say “I think”?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Details and word choice reveal the author's point.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.12 · W.4.9, RL.4.1

Lesson 3.12: Explaining an Inference in Writing

I can explain an inference in a paragraph with two pieces of evidence and clear reasoning.

WORDS TO KNOW

reasoning	The explanation of how evidence supports an idea.

GET READY

What's the difference between saying “Pip is brave” and proving it?

Reasoning is the bridge between evidence and your inference. Strong reasoning uses because, this shows, or this means, and explains how the evidence proves the idea.

MODEL · WEAK VS STRONG REASONING

Inference: Grandfather trusted Pip.

1. Evidence: He wrote “For Pip. Courage.” on the map.
2. Weak: This shows he trusted her.
3. Strong: Leaving a secret message only she would find shows he believed she would understand it and be brave enough to follow it.

Model answer: Strong reasoning explains how the evidence proves the inference.

KEY IDEA

Evidence + reasoning = proof. Explain HOW, not just THAT.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Reasoning word or phrase
2. Is “This proves it” strong reasoning?

3. What does reasoning connect?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Reasoning explains how evidence proves your inference.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.13 · W.4.9, W.4.4

Lesson 3.13: Understanding the Prompt

I can break down a writing prompt to understand exactly what it asks.

WORDS TO KNOW

prompt	A question or direction that tells you what to write.
task	What the prompt asks you to do.

GET READY

Have you ever answered a question and then realized you answered the wrong thing?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 12: Sir Gawaine on the Quest

As you read: How does Gawaine's quest go? What choices does he make?

Before writing, break down the prompt: circle the task words (explain, describe, compare), underline the topic, and box any requirements (number of examples, texts to use).

MODEL · BREAK DOWN A PROMPT

"Explain how Pip changes from the beginning to the end of the story. Use at least two details from the text."

1 Task word: Explain (tell how or why).

2 Topic: how Pip changes, beginning to end.

3 Requirement: at least two details.

Model answer: I need to explain Pip's change using at least two details: one from the beginning and one from the end.

KEY IDEA

Circle the task, underline the topic, box the requirements, then restate the prompt in your own words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Task word in “Compare the two stories”
2. Requirement in “Use two details”
3. Restate: “Describe the setting of Chapter 12.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Circle the task, underline the topic, box the requirements.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.14 · W.4.2a, W.4.4

Lesson 3.14: Planning an Organized Response

I can plan a multi-paragraph response with an introduction, body, and conclusion.

WORDS TO KNOW

introduction	The first paragraph; states the main idea or answer.
body paragraph	A paragraph with a reason and evidence.
conclusion	The last paragraph; sums up the answer.

GET READY

How is a long response like a sandwich?

An organized response has an introduction (restate the prompt and give your answer), body paragraphs (each with one point and evidence), and a conclusion (sum up).

Part	What goes in it
Introduction	Restate the prompt; state your answer (claim).
Body 1	Point 1 + evidence + explanation
Body 2	Point 2 + evidence + explanation
Conclusion	Restate the answer in new words; final thought.

MODEL · PLAN

Prompt: Explain how Pip changes. Use two details.

1 Intro: Pip changes from nervous to confident.

2 Body 1: Beginning: she almost turns back.

3 Body 2: End: she leads the village and becomes keeper.

4 Conclusion: Courage helped her grow.

Model answer: A four-part outline ready to draft.

KEY IDEA

Plan before you write: intro (answer), body (points + evidence), conclusion.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What goes in the introduction?
2. How many points per body paragraph?
3. What does a conclusion do?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Introduction → body paragraphs with evidence → conclusion.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.15 · W.4.2, W.4.9

Lesson 3.15: Drafting the Response

I can draft a multi-paragraph response from my plan.

GET READY

Why is it easier to write after you have a plan?

Turn each part of your plan into a paragraph. Indent each new paragraph. Use transitions between paragraphs: First, Another reason, In addition, In conclusion.

MODEL · MODEL INTRODUCTION

Prompt: Explain how Pip changes.

1 Restate: In “The Secret of Hollow Hill,” Pip changes a great deal.

2 Answer: She grows from a nervous girl into a confident leader.

Model answer: In “The Secret of Hollow Hill,” Pip changes a great deal. She grows from a nervous girl who almost turns back into a confident leader who shares her grandfather's gift with the whole village.

KEY IDEA

One paragraph per part of the plan. Indent and use transitions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Transition for the second body paragraph
2. Transition for the conclusion
3. How do you show a new paragraph?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Turn each plan part into a paragraph with transitions.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3.16 · W.4.5, W.4.2c

Lesson 3.16: Revising for Organization

I can revise my response for clear organization, evidence, and transitions.

GET READY

If you moved one paragraph of your response, would it still make sense?

When revising a response, check the order of paragraphs, make sure every body paragraph has evidence and explanation, and add transitions where ideas jump.

Revision checklist	Yes / Not yet
My introduction restates the prompt and answers it.	
Each body paragraph has one point, evidence, and explanation.	
I used transitions between paragraphs.	
My conclusion restates the answer in new words.	
I indented each paragraph and edited capitals, punctuation, and spelling.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for organization first, then edit for conventions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should every body paragraph have?
2. Revise first or edit first?
3. Name a paragraph transition.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 3.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise for organization, evidence, and transitions; then edit.

UNIT 3 REVIEW

Unit 3 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember...
3.1	Break long texts into chunks; state the gist after each one.
3.2	Annotate with symbols to stay focused and find evidence.
3.3	Monitor your reading; when confused, reread, read ahead, visualize, ask, use context, or retell.
3.4	First person: I/me (a character tells). Third person: he/she (an outside narrator tells).
3.5	Track evidence from beginning, middle, and end to explain character change.
3.6	Explain each step in order and why it mattered.
3.7	Combine evidence from several parts to answer big questions.
3.8	Two citations from different parts + transitions + explanation.
3.9	Predictions are inferences; confirm or revise them as you read.
3.10	Long stories build themes slowly; support them with evidence from across the text.
3.11	Details and word choice reveal the author's point.
3.12	Reasoning explains how evidence proves your inference.
3.13	Circle the task, underline the topic, box the requirements.
3.14	Introduction → body paragraphs with evidence → conclusion.
3.15	Turn each plan part into a paragraph with transitions.
3.16	Revise for organization, evidence, and transitions; then edit.

UNIT 4

The Writer's Craft

Words and phrases, structure, purpose and point of view, and comparing texts, with Treasure Island Chapters 1–4.

Every author makes choices: which words to use, how to organize ideas, whose eyes to tell the story through, and how to keep readers turning pages. In this unit you'll board the Hispaniola with Jim Hawkins and study the craft that makes Treasure Island one of the most famous adventure stories ever written.

In this unit you will…

- Interpret old-fashioned language, allusions to mythology, and sensory language.
- Compare poems, drama, and prose; identify informational text structures.
- Identify author's purpose; compare firsthand and secondhand accounts and character perspectives.
- Analyze suspense and compare texts, illustrations, fiction, and nonfiction.

WHY IT MATTERS

Recognizing persuasion protects you from misleading ads, and understanding structure helps you study any textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

allusion	A reference to a well-known story.
mood	The feeling a text creates.
stage directions	Notes telling actors what to do.
text structure	How information is organized.
firsthand account	Told by someone who was there.
suspense	Worry about what happens next.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
4.1	Reading Old-Fashioned Language
4.2	Words from Mythology
4.3	Sensory Language and Mood
4.4	Content Words in Informational Text
4.5	Poems, Drama, and Prose
4.6	Writing a Scene: From Story to Drama
4.7	Informational Text Structures
4.8	Text Structures and Graphic Organizers
4.9	Author's Purpose
4.10	Firsthand and Secondhand Accounts
4.11	Characters' Points of View
4.12	Facts, Opinions, and Persuasive Language
4.13	How Authors Build Suspense
4.14	Comparing Text and Illustration
4.15	Comparing Fiction and Nonfiction on the Same Topic
4.16	Writing a Comparison Paragraph

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.1 · RL.4.4, L.4.4a

Lesson 4.1: Reading Old-Fashioned Language

I can figure out the meaning of words and phrases in an older text.

WORDS TO KNOW

classic	A book that has been read and admired for a long time.
archaic	Old-fashioned; no longer commonly used.

GET READY

Have you ever read something that sounded old-fashioned? What made it sound that way?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 1: The Old Seadog and the Black Spot

As you read: Who is the old seaman? Why is everyone afraid of him?

Treasure Island was written by Robert Louis Stevenson in 1883. Your Reader retells it in modern words, but the original uses long sentences and archaic words. Use context clues, word parts, and the whole sentence to figure them out.

CLASSIC NOVEL EXCERPT

From Treasure Island, Chapter 1 (original 1883 text)

Robert Louis Stevenson, Treasure Island (1883). Public domain.

1 Squire Trelawney, Dr. Livesey, and the rest of these gentlemen having asked me to write down the whole particulars about Treasure Island, from the beginning to the end, keeping nothing back but the bearings of the island, and that only because there is still treasure not yet lifted, I take up my pen in the year of grace 17—, and go back to the time when my father kept the Admiral Benbow inn, and the brown old seaman, with the sabre cut, first took up his lodging under our roof.

2 I remember him as if it were yesterday, as he came plodding to the inn door, his sea-chest following behind him in a hand-barrow—a tall, strong, heavy, nut-brown man, his tarry pigtail falling over the shoulder of his soiled blue coat, his hands ragged and scarred, with black, broken nails, and the sabre cut across one cheek, a dirty, livid white.

MODEL · UNDERSTAND AN OLD PHRASE

"keeping nothing back but the bearings of the island"

1 Keeping nothing back = telling everything.

2 Bearings = directions or location (a sailing word).

3 Why keep them back? "there is still treasure not yet lifted."

Model answer: Jim will tell everything except the island's exact location, because treasure is still there.

KEY IDEA

Read old-fashioned sentences in chunks. Use context, word parts, and what you know about the story.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Who is telling the story?
2. What is a "sabre cut"?
3. What does "took up his lodging under our roof" mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Chunk old-fashioned sentences and use context to understand archaic words.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.2 · RL.4.4, L.4.5

Lesson 4.2: Words from Mythology

I can explain words and phrases that come from mythology.

WORDS TO KNOW

allusion	A reference to a well-known story, person, or event.
mythology	Ancient stories about gods and heroes.

GET READY

If someone says a job is "Herculean," what do you think it means?

Many English expressions come from Greek myths. Knowing the myth helps you understand the word.

Word or phrase	The myth	Meaning today
Herculean	Hercules completed twelve nearly impossible labors.	needing huge strength or effort
Pandora's box	Pandora opened a box that released troubles into the world.	something that causes many problems once started
Achilles' heel	Achilles could be hurt only on his heel.	a weak spot
Midas touch	Everything King Midas touched turned to gold.	the ability to make money or succeed easily
echo	Echo was a nymph who could only repeat others' words.	a repeated sound

REALISTIC FICTION

A Herculean Task

An original story

1 Cleaning the garage was a Herculean task. Boxes were stacked to the ceiling, and Dad said nobody had swept the floor since before I was born.

2 My sister Zoe opened a dusty trunk in the corner. "Don't!" I warned. "That could be a Pandora's box." Sure enough, a cloud of moths flew out, and Zoe screamed.

3 Dad is great at fixing things, but organizing is his Achilles' heel. He kept every broken lamp and bent bicycle wheel, "just in case."

4 By evening, the garage was spotless. Mom walked in and said we must have the Midas touch, because we had found forty dollars in old coins in a coffee can.

MODEL · EXPLAIN AN ALLUSION

"Organizing is his Achilles' heel."

1 Myth: Achilles' only weak spot was his heel.

2 Context: Dad is great at fixing but keeps everything.

Model answer: Organizing is Dad's weakness.

KEY IDEA

Learn the myth behind the phrase, then apply its meaning to the sentence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why was cleaning the garage Herculean?
2. Why call the trunk a Pandora's box?
3. Why did they have the Midas touch?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Allusions to myths: Herculean, Pandora's box, Achilles' heel, Midas touch.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.3 · RL.4.4, RL.4.3

Lesson 4.3: Sensory Language and Mood

I can explain how sensory words create a mood.

WORDS TO KNOW

sensory language	Words that appeal to sight, sound, smell, taste, or touch.
mood	The feeling a reader gets from a text, such as spooky, peaceful, or tense.

GET READY

Close your eyes. What sounds, smells, and sights would you notice in an old inn by the sea at night?

Writers use sensory language to make readers feel something. The feeling is the mood. Find the sensory words, then ask: How do they make me feel?

POEM

The Sea Chest

An original poem

The old sea chest sat by the door,
Its lid all cracked and worn;
It smelled of salt and tar and rope
And stormy seas at morn.

What secrets did the sailor keep
Beneath that rusty lock?
A compass, coins, a faded map,
A single, tangled sock?

I'll never know, for on the night
The sailor sailed away,
He took his chest and all his tales
To some far-distant bay.

MODEL · FIND THE MOOD

"It smelled of salt and tar and rope / And stormy seas at morn."

1 Smell words: salt, tar, rope.

2 Sight/feeling: stormy seas.

3 They make the chest seem old, adventurous, and a bit mysterious.

Model answer: The mood is mysterious and adventurous.

KEY IDEA

Sensory words → pictures and feelings → mood. Name the mood with an exact word.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which sense does “cracked and worn” appeal to?
2. What mood does the second stanza create?
3. How does the last stanza feel?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sensory words create mood; name the mood precisely.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.4 · RI.4.4

Lesson 4.4: Content Words in Informational Text

I can figure out content words in an informational text.

WORDS TO KNOW

bow	The front of a ship.
stern	The back of a ship.
port	The left side of a ship (facing forward).
starboard	The right side of a ship (facing forward).
galley	A ship's kitchen.
rigging	The ropes that hold up a ship's masts and sails.

GET READY

Why do sailors have special words for the front, back, left, and right?

Informational texts use content words about the topic. Authors often define them in the text, show them in diagrams, or give clues. Use these words when you write about the topic.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Life Aboard a Sailing Ship

An original informational text

1 In the 1700s, sailing ships carried goods, passengers, and sometimes treasure across the oceans. A ship's crew had to know many special words.

2 The front of the ship was the bow, and the back was the stern. Facing the bow, the left side was called port and the right side was starboard. Tall poles called masts held up the sails.

3 Sailors slept below the deck in hammocks, cloth beds that swung from the ceiling. Food was cooked in the galley, the ship's kitchen. It was usually hard biscuits and salted meat, because fresh food spoiled on long voyages.

4 Each sailor had a job. Some climbed the rigging, the ropes that held up the masts and sails. Others steered, cooked, or mended sails. The captain was in charge of everyone, and disobeying an order could mean harsh punishment.

MODEL · USE THE TEXT'S DEFINITION

What are hammocks?

1 Paragraph 3 defines them right after a comma.

Model answer: cloth beds that swing from the ceiling

KEY IDEA

Look for definitions, diagrams, and context for content words, then use the words yourself.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why might sailors say port instead of left?
2. Where was food cooked?
3. What did sailors eat? Why?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Content words like bow, stern, port, and starboard are defined by context and diagrams.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.5 · RL.4.5

Lesson 4.5: Poems, Drama, and Prose

I can explain how poems, drama, and prose are structured differently.

WORDS TO KNOW

prose	Ordinary writing in sentences and paragraphs.
verse	Lines of poetry.
stanza	A group of lines in a poem.
rhyme	Words that end with the same sound.
stage directions	Notes in a play, usually in italics or parentheses, that tell actors what to do.
cast of characters	The list of characters at the start of a play.

GET READY

How would the same story look as a poem, a play, and a chapter?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 2: The Sea Chest and the Blind Man

As you read: What do Jim and his mother find in the chest? What happens when the pirates arrive?

Stories can be written as prose (sentences and paragraphs), poems (lines and stanzas, often with rhythm and rhyme), or drama (a cast list, dialogue after characters' names, and stage directions).

DRAMA

The Captain's Warning: A Scene

An original scene inspired by Treasure Island

CHARACTERS: JIM, a boy who works at the inn · THE CAPTAIN, an old sailor · MOTHER, Jim's mother

(The Admiral Benbow inn. Night. Wind howls outside. THE CAPTAIN sits by the fire, gripping his mug.)

CAPTAIN: *(in a low voice)* Jim, come here, lad. You keep your weather-eye open, you hear?

JIM: For what, Captain?

CAPTAIN: For a seafaring man with one leg. If you see him, you tell me first. I'll pay you a silver fourpenny every month.

MOTHER: *(entering with a tray)* Jim! Stop bothering the guest and fetch more wood.

JIM: *(to the audience)* But I couldn't stop thinking about that one-legged man. That night, I dreamed of him chasing me across the moor.

	Prose	Poem	Drama
Organized in	paragraphs	lines and stanzas	scenes and lines of dialogue
Special features	narrator	rhythm, rhyme	cast list, stage directions
Example	Treasure Island Reader	“The Sea Chest”	“The Captain's Warning”

MODEL · FIND DRAMA FEATURES

“The Captain's Warning”

1 Cast of characters at the top.

2 Stage directions in italics and parentheses: (in a low voice).

3 Dialogue follows names in capitals; no quotation marks.

Model answer: It is drama.

KEY IDEA

Prose = paragraphs. Poems = lines and stanzas. Drama = cast, dialogue, stage directions.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How many stanzas does “The Sea Chest” have?
2. Find a stage direction in the scene.
3. Do plays use quotation marks for dialogue?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Prose: paragraphs. Poems: lines, stanzas, rhyme. Drama: cast, dialogue, stage directions.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.6 · RL.4.5, W.4.3

Lesson 4.6: Writing a Scene: From Story to Drama

I can turn a scene from a story into drama.

GET READY

What changes when you turn a chapter into a play?

To turn prose into drama: list the cast, set the scene in stage directions, turn the narration into dialogue and actions, and remove the narrator's explanations.

MODEL · PROSE TO DRAMA

Prose: Jim's mother was frightened, but she insisted on taking only the money they were owed.

1 Cast: JIM, MOTHER.

2 Stage direction: (Mother's hands shake as she counts coins.)

3 Dialogue: MOTHER: I'm an honest woman. I'll take what's owed and not a penny more.

Model answer: MOTHER: (hands shaking as she counts coins) I'm an honest woman, Jim. I'll take what we're owed and not a penny more.

KEY IDEA

In drama, show feelings through dialogue and stage directions instead of a narrator.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What replaces the narrator in a play?
2. Where do you list characters?
3. How do you show a character is scared in a play?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

In drama, dialogue and stage directions do the narrator's job.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.7 · RI.4.5

Lesson 4.7: Informational Text Structures

I can identify how an informational text is organized.

WORDS TO KNOW

text structure	How an author organizes information.
chronological	In time order.
cause and effect	Shows why something happened and its results.
compare and contrast	Shows how things are alike and different.
problem and solution	Shows a problem and how it was solved.

GET READY

Why might an author organize information in time order instead of by problem and solution?

Authors choose a structure that fits their purpose. Signal words help you identify it.

Structure	Signal words
Chronological	first, then, in 1716, later, finally
Compare and contrast	both, however, on the other hand, unlike, similarly
Cause and effect	because, so, as a result, therefore
Problem and solution	problem, to solve, solution, fixed

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Four Paragraphs About Life at Sea

Original informational paragraphs

1 The pirate Blackbeard began sailing around 1716. By 1717, he had captured a large French ship and renamed it Queen Anne's Revenge. In 1718, he blockaded the port of Charleston. Later that year, he was defeated in a battle off the coast of North Carolina.

2 Pirates and navy sailors both lived on ships and faced storms and disease. However, navy sailors worked for a government and were paid regular wages. Pirates, on the other hand, often voted for their captain and shared the treasure they stole.

3 Because sailors ate few fruits and vegetables on long voyages, many developed a disease called scurvy. As a result, their gums bled and they grew weak. When sailors began carrying limes and lemons, scurvy became much less common.

4 Ships often wrecked on rocky coasts at night. To solve this problem, people built lighthouses with bright lamps on high towers. The light warned sailors to steer away from danger.

MODEL · IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE

Paragraph 3

1 Signal words: Because, As a result, When...

2 It explains why scurvy happened and what fixed it.

Model answer: Cause and effect

KEY IDEA

Find signal words, then ask: Is the author telling order, comparing, explaining causes, or solving a problem?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Structure of paragraph 1
2. Structure of paragraph 2
3. Structure of paragraph 4

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Chronological, compare and contrast, cause and effect, problem and solution.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.8 · RI.4.5

Lesson 4.8: Text Structures and Graphic Organizers

I can use a graphic organizer that matches a text's structure to take notes.

WORDS TO KNOW

graphic organizer — A chart or diagram that organizes information.

GET READY

What kind of chart would help you take notes on a timeline? On a comparison?

Each structure has a graphic organizer that fits: timeline (chronological), Venn diagram or T-chart (compare and contrast), cause → effect arrows, and problem/solution boxes.

Pirates	Both	Navy sailors
voted for captain; shared treasure	lived on ships; faced storms and disease	worked for a government; paid wages

MODEL · CHOOSE AN ORGANIZER

Notes on paragraph 1 (Blackbeard)

1 Structure: chronological.

2 Organizer: timeline: 1716 → 1717 → 1718 → later 1718.

Model answer: A timeline

KEY IDEA

Match the organizer to the structure. It makes notes clear and easy to study.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Organizer for cause and effect
2. Organizer for compare and contrast
3. Organizer for chronological

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Timeline, Venn diagram, cause → effect, problem → solution.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.9 · RI.4.8, RL.4.6

Lesson 4.9: Author's Purpose

I can identify an author's purpose and explain how I know.

WORDS TO KNOW

author's purpose	The reason an author writes: to persuade, inform, or entertain.
persuade	Try to convince readers to think or do something.

GET READY

Why would an author write an advertisement? A science article? A ghost story?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 3: The Real Adventure Begins

As you read: What do the doctor and squire find in the packet? What do they decide to do?

Authors write to persuade, inform, or entertain (P-I-E). Some texts have more than one purpose. Look at the type of text, word choice, and what the author wants you to do or know.

PERSUASIVE TEXT

WANTED: Brave Sailors!

An original advertisement

1 Are you tired of boring work on land? Join the crew of the finest ship in Bristol, the Hispaniola!

2 Our ship is fast, our captain is fair, and our cook makes the best stew on the seven seas. Every sailor will be paid well, and the voyage will be the adventure of a lifetime.

3 Don't miss this chance. Only the bravest need apply. Sign up at the docks today!

MODEL · IDENTIFY THE PURPOSE

"WANTED: Brave Sailors!"

1 Commands: Join! Sign up today!

2 Positive opinion words: finest, fair, best, adventure of a lifetime.

3 Goal: get readers to join.

Model answer: to persuade

KEY IDEA

Persuade → wants you to act or believe. Inform → teaches facts. Entertain → tells a story for enjoyment.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Purpose of "Life Aboard a Sailing Ship"
2. Purpose of "The Footsteps"
3. Which words in the ad are opinions?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Authors write to persuade, inform, or entertain.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.10 · RI.4.6

Lesson 4.10: Firsthand and Secondhand Accounts

I can compare a firsthand and a secondhand account of the same event.

WORDS TO KNOW

firsthand account	Told by someone who was there (I, we).
secondhand account	Told by someone who learned about it from others or research.

GET READY

Would you learn something different about a storm from a kid who lived through it than from a news report?

A firsthand account gives feelings and personal details. A secondhand account gives facts, numbers, and a bigger picture. Comparing both gives the fullest understanding.

FIRSTHAND ACCOUNT

Account A: "The Storm Hit Our Town"

An original firsthand account

1 I was nine years old when the hurricane hit our town. I remember the wind screaming like a train all night long. My brother and I huddled in the bathtub with a mattress over our heads while Mom held a flashlight.

2 In the morning, I stepped outside and couldn't believe my eyes. Our big oak tree was lying across the street, and the Johnsons' roof was in our yard. I felt lucky and scared at the same time.

SECONDHAND ACCOUNT

Account B: "Hurricane Strikes Coastal Town"

An original secondhand account (news article)

1 On September 12, a powerful hurricane struck the coastal town of Bayview. Winds reached 120 miles per hour, according to the National Weather Service.

2 More than 200 homes were damaged, and thousands of trees fell. Officials reported that no one was seriously injured, largely because most residents followed instructions to take shelter. Repairs are expected to take several months.

	Account A (firsthand)	Account B (secondhand)
Point of view	first person (I)	third person
Focus	feelings, personal experience	facts, numbers, the whole town
Example detail	wind "screaming like a train"	winds of 120 mph

KEY IDEA

Firsthand: feelings and personal view. Secondhand: facts and the bigger picture.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which account tells how the writer felt?
2. Which gives the wind speed?
3. Is a diary firsthand or secondhand?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Firsthand accounts give feelings; secondhand accounts give facts and the big picture.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.11 · RL.4.6, RL.4.3

Lesson 4.11: Characters' Points of View

I can explain how different characters see the same events differently.

WORDS TO KNOW

perspective	How a character sees and feels about events.

GET READY

If you and your sibling both describe the same argument, will your stories match?

Characters have different perspectives because of who they are, what they want, and what they know. Compare what each character says and does about the same event.

MODEL · COMPARE PERSPECTIVES

Chapter 3: the treasure map

1. Squire Trelawney: excited, wants to buy a ship and sail right away; talks openly about the treasure.
2. Dr. Livesey: interested but cautious; warns the squire to keep quiet.
3. Jim: thrilled to be going on an adventure.

Model answer: Each character reacts to the map differently because of his personality.

KEY IDEA

Different characters see the same event in different ways. Use their words and actions as evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How does Squire Trelawney feel about the map?
2. Why is Dr. Livesey worried about the squire?
3. Whose perspective do readers mainly see in Treasure Island?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Characters' perspectives differ; use their words and actions as evidence.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.12 · RI.4.8

Lesson 4.12: Facts, Opinions, and Persuasive Language

I can tell facts from opinions and recognize persuasive techniques.

WORDS TO KNOW

fact	A statement that can be proved true.
opinion	A statement of what someone thinks or feels.
loaded words	Words with strong positive or negative feelings, used to persuade.

GET READY

Is “Pizza is the best food” a fact or an opinion? How could you check?

A fact can be checked. An opinion tells a belief. Persuasive writers mix them and use loaded words (finest, terrible), exaggeration, and calls to action (Sign up now!).

MODEL · SORT STATEMENTS

From the sailor ad

1 “Join the crew of the Hispaniola.”: a command (call to action).

2 “Our cook makes the best stew on the seven seas.”: opinion with exaggeration.

3 “The ship sails from Bristol.”: a fact (could be checked).

Model answer: Most of the ad is opinion and persuasion, not fact.

KEY IDEA

Ask: Can this be proved? Watch for loaded words, exaggeration, and calls to action.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fact or opinion: Winds reached 120 mph.
2. Fact or opinion: The Hispaniola is the finest ship.
3. Name a loaded word from the ad.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Facts can be proved; opinions can't. Persuasion uses loaded words and calls to action.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.13 · RL.4.5, RL.4.4

Lesson 4.13: How Authors Build Suspense

I can explain how an author builds suspense with word choice and structure.

WORDS TO KNOW

suspense	A feeling of worry or excitement about what will happen next.
cliffhanger	An ending that leaves the reader in suspense.

GET READY

What makes you want to keep turning pages?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 4: What I Heard in the Apple Barrel

As you read: What does Jim overhear? How does the author make this chapter tense?

Authors build suspense with short sentences, sensory details, slow pacing at tense moments, characters hiding or waiting, and cliffhangers at the ends of chapters.

REALISTIC FICTION

The Footsteps

An original story

1 Ana was alone in the library after closing. The lights buzzed. Rain tapped the tall windows.

2 Then she heard it: a footstep. Then another. Slow. Heavy. Coming closer.

3 She held her breath and crouched behind the shelf of atlases. The footsteps stopped right beside her. A shadow stretched across the floor.

4 “Ana?” said a familiar voice. It was Mr. Diaz, the custodian, holding an umbrella. “Your mom is waiting outside.” Ana let out her breath in a laugh so loud it echoed off the ceiling.

MODEL · FIND SUSPENSE TECHNIQUES

“Then she heard it: a footstep. Then another. Slow. Heavy. Coming closer.”

1 Short sentences and fragments slow the reader.

2 Sound details (footsteps) build tension.

3 “Coming closer” makes us worry.

Model answer: Short sentences and sound details build suspense.

KEY IDEA

Short sentences, sensory details, hiding, waiting, and cliffhangers build suspense.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why is the setting spooky?
2. How is the suspense released?
3. Why is Jim's hiding place in Chapter 4 suspenseful?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Authors build suspense with short sentences, sensory details, hiding, and cliffhangers.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.14 · RL.4.7

Lesson 4.14: Comparing Text and Illustration

I can compare a text with an illustration or performance of it.

WORDS TO KNOW

illustration	A picture that goes with a text.
interpretation	An artist's or performer's own way of showing a text.

GET READY

Have you ever seen a movie of a book and thought, “That's not how I pictured it”?

Illustrators, actors, and filmmakers make choices about how characters look and sound. Compare what the text says with what the picture or performance shows. What did the artist add, change, or leave out?

MODEL · COMPARE

Text: the captain has “a tarry pigtail,” a “soiled blue coat,” and a “sabre cut across one cheek.” Look at the illustration of the captain in your Reader.

1 Check each detail: pigtail? blue coat? scar?

2 What did the illustrator add (a hat? a parrot?)

3 Does the picture match the mood?

Model answer: Answers depend on the Reader's illustration; list matches and differences.

KEY IDEA

Compare the text's details with the illustration or performance: what matches, what was added, what was left out?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two details from the text to look for in the illustration.
2. What is an interpretation?
3. Why might an illustrator add details?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Compare a text with an illustration or performance: matches, additions, omissions.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.15 · RL.4.9, RI.4.9

Lesson 4.15: Comparing Fiction and Nonfiction on the Same Topic

I can compare how a story and an informational text treat the same topic.

GET READY

Are the pirates in Treasure Island like real pirates?

A story and an informational text can teach different things about the same topic. Fiction may exaggerate or invent details for excitement. Informational texts give facts.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Real Pirates of the Golden Age

An original informational text

1 From about 1690 to 1730, so many pirates sailed the oceans that historians call it the Golden Age of Piracy. Pirates attacked ships carrying gold, silver, sugar, and cloth.

2 Real pirates were very different from the pirates in stories. Most did not bury their treasure; they spent it quickly. There is little evidence that pirates made prisoners walk the plank. And treasure maps marked with an X were mostly invented by writers.

3 Pirate ships often had written rules. Crews voted on important decisions, and treasure was divided by shares. A captain who was unfair could be voted out.

4 Life as a pirate was dangerous and usually short. Many pirates were captured and punished. By 1730, navies had driven most pirates from the seas.

MODEL · COMPARE

Treasure maps

1 Treasure Island: the story centers on a treasure map with an X.

2 Informational text: treasure maps “were mostly invented by writers.”

3 Real pirates usually spent treasure quickly.

Model answer: Stevenson's story made treasure maps famous, but real pirates rarely buried treasure or drew maps.

KEY IDEA

Compare fiction and nonfiction: What's the same? What did the story invent or exaggerate?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Did real pirates usually bury treasure?
2. How did pirate crews make decisions?
3. What did the story invent that real pirates rarely had?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Stories may invent or exaggerate; informational texts give facts.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4.16 · W.4.9, W.4.2

Lesson 4.16: Writing a Comparison Paragraph

I can write a paragraph comparing two texts.

GET READY

What words help readers follow a comparison?

A comparison paragraph has a topic sentence naming both texts and the point of comparison, details from each text, comparison transitions (both, similarly, however, unlike, on the other hand), and a conclusion.

MODEL · COMPARISON PARAGRAPH

Compare pirates in Treasure Island and "Real Pirates of the Golden Age."

1 Topic sentence: Both texts are about pirates, but they show them differently.
2 Similar: both describe pirates who want treasure.
3 Different: Treasure Island has a buried treasure map; real pirates rarely buried treasure.
4 Conclusion.

Model answer: Both Treasure Island and “Real Pirates of the Golden Age” show pirates hunting for treasure. However, Treasure Island centers on a buried treasure and a map, while the informational text explains that real pirates usually spent their treasure quickly. The story makes pirates exciting, but the article shows they were real people with rules and dangerous lives.

KEY IDEA

Name both texts, use comparison transitions, and give evidence from each.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two comparison transitions.
2. What must the topic sentence include?
3. How many texts need evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 4.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comparison paragraphs name both texts, use transitions, and give evidence from each.

UNIT 4 REVIEW

Unit 4 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
4.1	Chunk old-fashioned sentences and use context to understand archaic words.
4.2	Allusions to myths: Herculean, Pandora's box, Achilles' heel, Midas touch.
4.3	Sensory words create mood; name the mood precisely.
4.4	Content words like bow, stern, port, and starboard are defined by context and diagrams.
4.5	Prose: paragraphs. Poems: lines, stanzas, rhyme. Drama: cast, dialogue, stage directions.
4.6	In drama, dialogue and stage directions do the narrator's job.
4.7	Chronological, compare and contrast, cause and effect, problem and solution.
4.8	Timeline, Venn diagram, cause → effect, problem → solution.
4.9	Authors write to persuade, inform, or entertain.
4.10	Firsthand accounts give feelings; secondhand accounts give facts and the big picture.
4.11	Characters' perspectives differ; use their words and actions as evidence.
4.12	Facts can be proved; opinions can't. Persuasion uses loaded words and calls to action.
4.13	Authors build suspense with short sentences, sensory details, hiding, and cliffhangers.
4.14	Compare a text with an illustration or performance: matches, additions, omissions.
4.15	Stories may invent or exaggerate; informational texts give facts.
4.16	Comparison paragraphs name both texts, use transitions, and give evidence from each.

UNIT 5

Reading Deeply

Long stories and articles, text features, comparing structure and viewpoint, and the comparison essay, with Treasure Island Chapters 5–7.

As Jim Hawkins explores Treasure Island, you'll explore longer, richer texts: a survival story, an article about how sailors navigated, letters, lighthouse histories, and the Blackbeard selection. You'll analyze plot and character in depth, use text features and visuals, compare texts, and write your first full comparison essay.

In this unit you will…

- Identify plot structure and analyze characters and settings in depth.
- Use text features, charts, and timelines to understand informational texts.
- Compare the structures and narrators of stories and the focus of informational texts.
- Plan, draft, and revise a compare-and-contrast essay.

WHY IT MATTERS

Comparing sources is how you decide what to believe: two news stories, two product reviews, or two history books.

UNIT VOCABULARY

climax	The turning point of a plot.
characterization	How an author shows what a character is like.
text features	Headings, captions, bold words, and visuals.
epistolary	Told through letters or journals.
thesis	The main claim of an essay.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
5.1	Plot Structure

Lesson	Title
5.2	Analyzing a Character in Depth
5.3	How Setting Shapes a Story
5.4	Summarizing a Long Story
5.5	Text Features
5.6	Reading Charts, Diagrams, and Timelines
5.7	Main Ideas of Sections and the Whole Text
5.8	Integrating Information to Explain a Topic
5.9	Comparing Story Structures
5.10	Comparing Narrators
5.11	Comparing Two Informational Texts
5.12	Speaking Knowledgeably from Two Texts
5.13	Comparison Essay Structure
5.14	Planning the Comparison Essay
5.15	Drafting the Comparison Essay
5.16	Revising and Editing the Comparison Essay

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.1 · RL.4.3, RL.4.5

Lesson 5.1: Plot Structure

I can identify the parts of a plot in a longer story.

WORDS TO KNOW

exposition	The beginning: characters, setting, and the situation.
rising action	Events that build the problem.
climax	The turning point; the most exciting moment.
falling action	Events after the climax.
resolution	How the problem is solved and the story ends.

GET READY

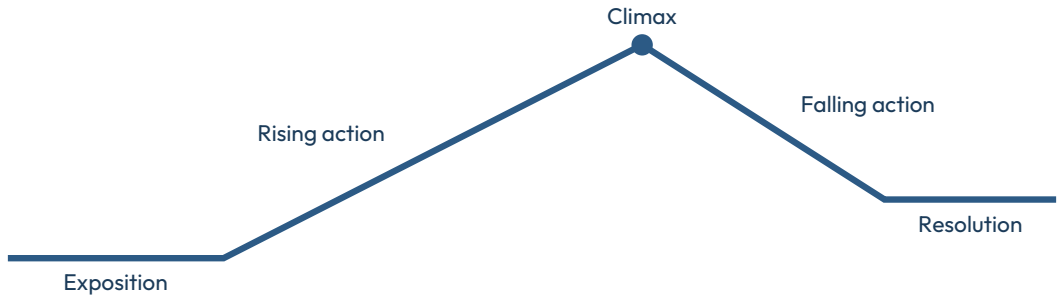
Think of your favorite movie. When was the most exciting moment?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 5: The Man on the Island

As you read: Who does Jim meet? How long has this man been on the island?

Most stories follow a plot structure that rises to a climax and falls to a resolution, like a mountain.



ADVENTURE STORY

The Castaway of Pelican Key

An original story

1 The storm had wrecked the little supply boat, and when Eli woke, he was lying on warm sand with seaweed tangled in his hair. The boat was gone. The crew was gone. All he could see was a curve of white beach, a cluster of palm trees, and the endless blue ocean.

2 “Hello?” he called. Only the pelicans answered, squawking from the rocks.

3 For the first few days, Eli was too frightened to do anything but sit and stare at the horizon, hoping to see a sail. But his stomach growled, and his lips cracked from thirst. He knew that if he waited much longer, he would not survive.

4 So he made a plan. He followed the pelicans to a freshwater pool behind the rocks. He cracked coconuts with a heavy stone. He wove palm fronds into a roof and built a shelter against the cliff. Every morning, he scratched a line on a flat rock to count the days.

5 By the thirtieth line, Eli had become a different boy. His arms were brown and strong. He could catch fish with a sharpened stick and build a fire with dry grass and two stones. He even talked to the pelicans, naming the biggest one Captain.

6 Still, every evening, he climbed the cliff to watch the sea. And on the forty-second evening, he saw it: a white sail, tiny as a gull's feather, far out on the water.

7 Eli piled every branch he could find on the cliff top and lit the biggest fire he had ever made. Smoke climbed into the orange sky. The sail grew larger. It turned toward the island.

8 When the sailors rowed ashore, they found a tall, sunburned boy waiting on the beach with a pelican at his side. “We thought you were lost,” said the captain. Eli smiled. “I was,” he said. “But I found my way.”

MODEL · FIND THE CLIMAX

“The Castaway of Pelican Key”

1 Rising action: Eli finds water, builds shelter, survives 42 days.

2 Turning point: he sees the sail and lights the fire; will they see it?

3 After: the boat turns and rows ashore.

Model answer: The climax is when Eli lights the signal fire and the sail turns toward the island.

KEY IDEA

Exposition → rising action → climax → falling action → resolution.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Exposition of the story

2. One rising-action event

3. Resolution

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plot: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.2 · RL.4.3

Lesson 5.2: Analyzing a Character in Depth

I can describe a character in depth using what the character says, does, thinks, and how others react.

WORDS TO KNOW

characterization How an author shows what a character is like.

GET READY

How do you get to know a new friend? What do you notice?

Authors reveal characters through STEAL: Speech, Thoughts, Effect on others, Actions, and Looks.

STEAL	Eli (The Castaway)	What it shows
Speech	“I was. But I found my way.”	confident, thoughtful
Thoughts	He knew if he waited longer, he wouldn't survive.	realistic
Effect on others	Sailors expected a lost boy; they find him waiting.	independent
Actions	builds shelter, fishes, makes fire	resourceful, hardworking
Looks	tall, sunburned, strong arms	changed by the island

KEY IDEA

Use STEAL to find evidence about a character from many parts of the story.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which STEAL letter is “He talked to the pelicans”?

2. What trait does naming a pelican Captain show?

3. How does Eli change?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

STEAL: Speech, Thoughts, Effect on others, Actions, Looks.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.3 · RL.4.3

Lesson 5.3: How Setting Shapes a Story

I can explain how the setting affects the characters and events.

GET READY

Would “The Castaway of Pelican Key” work if it happened in a city?

Setting is more than a backdrop. It can create problems (a storm, an island), shape what characters can do, and affect the mood.

MODEL · SETTING AND PLOT

How does the island setting shape the story?

1 Problem: Eli is alone with no food or shelter.

2 Actions: he must use what the island has: coconuts, palm fronds, fish.

3 Change: surviving there makes him stronger.

Model answer: The island creates Eli's problem, determines how he survives, and causes him to grow.

KEY IDEA

Ask: What problems does the setting cause? How do characters respond? How does it affect the mood?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What problem does the setting create in Treasure Island?

2. How did the setting help Eli?

3. What mood does a deserted island create?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Settings create problems, shape actions, and set the mood.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.4 · RL.4.2

Lesson 5.4: Summarizing a Long Story

I can summarize a long story using its plot structure.

GET READY

How can you summarize a story that took you a whole week to read?

Use the plot arc as a summary plan: one sentence for the exposition, one or two for the rising action, one for the climax, and one for the resolution. Leave out minor details.

MODEL · PLOT-ARC SUMMARY

"The Castaway of Pelican Key"

1 Exposition: After a storm, Eli washes up alone on an island.

2 Rising action: Scared at first, he learns to find water, build a shelter, and fish.

3 Climax: On the 42nd evening, he sees a sail and lights a signal fire.

4 Resolution: Sailors rescue him, and he realizes he has grown.

Model answer: After a storm, Eli washes up alone on an island. Scared at first, he learns to find water, build a shelter, and fish. On the forty-second evening, he spots a sail and lights a huge signal fire. Sailors rescue him, and Eli realizes he has grown strong and brave.

KEY IDEA

Plot-arc summary: exposition, rising action, climax, resolution, in four or five sentences.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How many sentences for a plot-arc summary?
2. Include that Eli named a pelican?
3. What part of the plot is the most important to include?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use the plot arc to summarize long stories.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.5 · RI.4.7, RI.4.5

Lesson 5.5: Text Features

I can use text features to find and understand information.

WORDS TO KNOW

text features	Parts of a text that help readers find and understand information, such as headings, captions, and bold words.
heading	A title for a section.
caption	Words that explain a picture.
sidebar	A box of extra information beside the main text.

GET READY

When you open a science book, what do you look at before reading?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Informational selection: Blackbeard

As you read: Use the headings, pictures, and captions to preview before reading.

Informational texts use text features. Preview them before reading: they show what the text is about and help you find information fast.

Feature	How it helps
Title and headings	tell the topic of the text and each section
Bold words	show important vocabulary
Photos and captions	show and explain
Maps, diagrams, charts	show information visually
Timeline	shows events in order
Sidebar	adds extra related facts
Glossary and index	define words; locate topics

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Finding the Way: How Sailors Navigated

An original informational text

Lost at Sea

Today, ships use satellites to know exactly where they are. But for most of history, sailors crossed oceans with no land in sight and no GPS. How did they find their way? They used the sky, simple tools, and a great deal of skill.

Reading the Stars

In the Northern Hemisphere, sailors relied on the North Star, also called Polaris. Unlike other stars, it barely moves across the night sky. By measuring how high Polaris was above the horizon, a navigator could tell how far north the ship was. This measurement is called latitude.

The Compass

A compass has a magnetized needle that always points north. Chinese inventors were using compasses by around 1100, and the tool soon spread to sailors in Europe. With a compass, sailors could keep a steady direction even on cloudy nights when the stars were hidden.

Measuring Speed

To figure out how fast a ship was moving, sailors tossed a piece of wood tied to a long rope over the side. The rope had knots tied at equal distances. A sailor counted how many knots slipped through his hands while a small sand timer ran out. That is why a ship's speed is still measured in knots today.

Putting It Together

By combining direction, speed, and time, a navigator could estimate the ship's position on a map. This method, called dead reckoning, was not perfect. A strong current or a storm could push a ship far off course. That is why sailors on long voyages always watched for birds, floating plants, and changes in the color of the water, all signs that land might be near.

MODEL · USE HEADINGS

Where would you look to learn why speed is measured in knots?

1 Scan the headings.

2 “Measuring Speed” fits.

Model answer: the section “Measuring Speed”

KEY IDEA

Preview text features first. Use headings to find information; use bold words for key vocabulary.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which section explains the compass?
2. Name a bold word and its meaning.
3. What is the purpose of headings?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Headings, bold words, captions, diagrams, timelines, and sidebars help readers.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.6 · RI.4.7

Lesson 5.6: Reading Charts, Diagrams, and Timelines

I can explain how information in a chart, diagram, or timeline adds to a text.

WORDS TO KNOW

chart	Information organized in rows and columns.
timeline	A line showing events in time order.

GET READY

Why might an author add a timeline instead of just writing the dates in a paragraph?

Visual information lets readers see patterns quickly. Read the title, labels, and every row or point. Then ask: What does this show that the words don't?

Navigation tool	Invented or first used	What it measured
Compass	China, about 1100	direction
Astrolabe	used at sea by the 1400s	height of stars or sun (latitude)
Log and line (knots)	1500s	speed
Chronometer (sea clock)	1700s	time, which helped find longitude

Chart: Tools Sailors Used



Timeline: How Navigation Changed

MODEL · USE THE CHART

Which tool helped sailors find longitude?

1 Find the column “What it measured.”

2 Row: chronometer: time, which helped find longitude.

Model answer: the chronometer (sea clock)

KEY IDEA

Read titles and labels first. Explain what the visual adds to the text.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What did an astrolabe measure?

2. Which came first: knots or the chronometer?

3. What does the timeline show that the article doesn't?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Charts and timelines show information visually; explain what they add.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.7 · RI.4.2

Lesson 5.7: Main Ideas of Sections and the Whole Text

I can find the main idea of each section and of the whole text.

GET READY

How is the main idea of one section different from the main idea of the whole article?

In a long text with headings, each section has its own main idea. The main idea of the whole text connects them all.

Section	Main idea
Reading the Stars	Sailors measured the North Star to find latitude.
The Compass	A compass helped sailors keep direction.
Measuring Speed	Knotted ropes measured speed.
Putting It Together	Sailors combined these to estimate position, though it wasn't perfect.
Whole text	Before GPS, sailors used the sky, simple tools, and skill to navigate.

KEY IDEA

Section main ideas are the building blocks; the whole-text main idea connects them.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Main idea of “Lost at Sea”
2. Which section's main idea is about direction?
3. Main idea of the whole text

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Each section has a main idea; the whole-text main idea connects them.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.8 · RI.4.7, RI.4.9, W.4.2

Lesson 5.8: Integrating Information to Explain a Topic

I can combine information from a text and its visuals to explain a topic.

WORDS TO KNOW

integrate	Combine information from different sources.

GET READY

If you had to teach a younger child about navigation, what would you include?

Integrate means using the words, the chart, and the timeline together. Good explanations use details from each source and name where they came from.

MODEL · INTEGRATE

How did navigation tools improve over time?

1 Article: compass for direction; knots for speed; dead reckoning not perfect.

2 Chart: astrolabe and chronometer added latitude and longitude.

3 Timeline: radio and GPS made it exact.

Model answer: Navigation improved from the compass and star measurements, to tools like the chronometer for longitude, to radio and finally GPS, which shows exact location.

KEY IDEA

Combine words and visuals; name your sources.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which source tells about GPS?
2. Which source explains dead reckoning?
3. What does integrate mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Integrate words and visuals; name your sources.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.9 · RL.4.5, RL.4.9

Lesson 5.9: Comparing Story Structures

I can compare how two stories are structured and how the structure affects the reader.

WORDS TO KNOW

epistolary	Told through letters, journals, or messages.

GET READY

How would a story feel different if it were told in letters instead of by a narrator?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 6: The Plan

As you read: What is the plan? Who makes it?

Stories can be structured as a continuous narrative, as letters or journal entries (epistolary), or as a play. The structure affects what readers know and how they feel.

EPISTOLARY STORY

Letters from Camp

An original story told in letters

July 2. Dear Mom and Dad, Camp is okay, I guess. The food is weird and my bunk is squeaky. A boy named Theo snores like a bear. I miss home. Love, Sam

July 5. Dear Mom and Dad, Today we went canoeing! Theo and I tipped over in the middle of the lake, and we laughed so hard we couldn't swim for a minute. The counselor said we were the soggiest team she'd ever seen. Love, Sam

July 9. Dear Mom and Dad, Can I stay for a second session? Theo is staying, and we're building a raft. Also, I don't even notice the squeaky bunk anymore. Love, Sam

MODEL · COMPARE STRUCTURES

"Letters from Camp" vs "The Castaway of Pelican Key"

1 Letters: dated entries; we see only what Sam writes; time skips between letters.

2 Castaway: a narrator describes everything; scenes flow continuously.

3 Effect: letters feel personal; the narrative gives a fuller picture.

Model answer: Letters make the story personal and let readers infer what happened between them; the narrative tells a fuller, continuous story.

KEY IDEA

Structure affects what readers know and how they feel. Compare how each story is put together.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How do we learn time passes in “Letters from Camp”?
2. How does Sam change?
3. What must readers infer between letters?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Structure (narrative, letters, drama) shapes what readers know and feel.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.10 · RL.4.6

Lesson 5.10: Comparing Narrators

I can compare how two narrators tell the same event.

GET READY

When two people tell the same story, why can both versions sound true?

Two first-person narrators may tell the same event very differently. Each narrator includes what matters to them and leaves out what doesn't.

FIRST-PERSON NARRATOR

The Broken Vase · Told by Leo

An original example

I swear I didn't mean to. I was just practicing my soccer kick in the hallway, the ball bounced off the wall, and the vase wobbled and fell. When Mom came in, I froze. My sister pointed at me before I could say a word. Thanks a lot, Mia.

FIRST-PERSON NARRATOR

The Broken Vase · Told by Mia

An original example

I told Leo a hundred times not to kick the ball inside. Then I heard a crash. When Mom walked in, Leo looked like a statue, so I pointed. Somebody had to tell the truth. Later, I helped him glue the pieces back together, because that's what sisters do.

MODEL · COMPARE NARRATORS

Leo vs Mia

1 Leo: focuses on not meaning to; feels betrayed ("Thanks a lot, Mia").

2 Mia: focuses on warning him; telling the truth; helping glue the vase.

Model answer: Each narrator makes themselves sound reasonable. Mia includes that she helped; Leo doesn't know or mention it.

KEY IDEA

Ask: What does each narrator include, leave out, and feel? Why?

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does Leo leave out?
2. Why did Mia point?
3. Who is the more reliable narrator? Explain.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Different narrators include, leave out, and feel different things.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.11 · RI.4.9, RI.4.6

Lesson 5.11: Comparing Two Informational Texts

I can compare the focus and structure of two informational texts on the same topic.

WORDS TO KNOW

focus	The part of a topic a text pays most attention to.

GET READY

Two books about volcanoes: why might they still teach you different things?

Two texts on the same topic can have different focus (people vs how something works) and different structures. Reading both gives a fuller picture.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Text A: The Keepers of the Light

An original informational text

1 In the 1800s, lighthouse keepers lived lonely lives on rocky islands and windy points. Every evening, the keeper climbed the tower to light the lamp, and every few hours through the night, he or she climbed again to trim the wick and refill the oil.

2 Some keepers became heroes. In 1838, Grace Darling, the daughter of an English keeper, rowed through a storm with her father to rescue survivors of a shipwreck. Her bravery made her famous.

3 Many keepers were women. When a keeper died, his wife or daughter often took over the job, and some served for decades.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Text B: How a Lighthouse Works

An original informational text

1 A lighthouse has three main parts: a tall tower, a lamp, and a lens. The tower raises the light so it can be seen far out at sea, because the earth curves and a low light would be hidden below the horizon.

2 The lens is the most important part. In 1822, a French scientist named Augustin Fresnel designed a lens made of many glass rings. It bent and focused the light into a strong beam that could be seen more than 20 miles away.

3 Each lighthouse flashes in its own pattern, such as two flashes every ten seconds. Sailors use these patterns to tell which lighthouse they are seeing, and therefore where they are.

	Text A	Text B
Focus	the people who kept lighthouses	how lighthouses work
Structure	description with examples	parts explained in order
Key detail	Grace Darling's rescue (1838)	Fresnel lens (1822)

KEY IDEA

Compare focus, structure, and details. Together, two texts give a fuller understanding.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Focus of Text A
2. Focus of Text B
3. Why was the tower tall?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Compare focus, structure, and details of texts on the same topic.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.12 · RI.4.9, SL.4.4

Lesson 5.12: Speaking Knowledgeably from Two Texts

I can present what I learned from two texts in a short talk.

WORDS TO KNOW

presentation	A talk that shares information with an audience.

GET READY

What makes a speaker sound like an expert?

Use details from both texts, organize your talk (introduction, two or three facts, conclusion), speak clearly at a good pace, and look at your audience.

- Start with a hook: a question or surprising fact.
- Give two or three facts from each text.
- End with a conclusion or something to think about.
- Practice aloud twice before presenting.

KEY IDEA

Organize, use evidence from both texts, and speak clearly.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Good hook for a lighthouse talk
2. How many texts should facts come from?
3. Name a speaking skill.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Organized talks use evidence from both texts and clear speaking.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.13 · W.4.2a, W.4.9

Lesson 5.13: Comparison Essay Structure

I can choose a structure for a compare-and-contrast essay.

WORDS TO KNOW

block structure	Write all about Subject A, then all about Subject B.
point-by-point structure	Compare A and B on one point at a time.

GET READY

How would you organize an essay comparing cats and dogs?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 7: "Shiver Me Timbers"

As you read: What happens to Jim in this chapter? How is he like or unlike the castaways you've read about?

A comparison essay can use block or point-by-point structure. Both need an introduction with a thesis, body paragraphs with evidence, and a conclusion.

Block structure	Point-by-point structure
Intro	Intro
Body 1: Eli (survival, change)	Body 1: How they survived (Eli and Ben Gunn)
Body 2: Ben Gunn (survival, change)	Body 2: How loneliness changed them (Eli and Ben Gunn)
Conclusion	Conclusion

MODEL · THESIS

Compare Eli and Ben Gunn.

1 Name both subjects.

2 Say how they are alike and different.

Model answer: Eli and Ben Gunn were both castaways, but while Eli grew stronger and calmer, Ben Gunn's years alone left him wild and strange.

KEY IDEA

Choose block or point-by-point; start with a thesis that names both subjects.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Which structure compares one point at a time?
2. What must a thesis name?
3. How many body paragraphs at least?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Block or point-by-point; thesis names both subjects.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.14 · W.4.9, W.4.2

Lesson 5.14: Planning the Comparison Essay

I can gather evidence and outline a comparison essay.

GET READY

Why gather evidence before writing?

Use a Venn diagram to collect similarities and differences with evidence, then turn it into an outline.

MODEL · VENN TO OUTLINE

Eli and Jim

1 Both: face danger alone, show courage, use their wits.

2 Eli only: alone 42 days on an island.

3 Jim only: involved with pirates, the treasure, and adults.

Model answer: Outline: Intro (thesis) → Body 1: how both show courage → Body 2: how their situations differ → Conclusion.

KEY IDEA

Venn diagram → outline → essay. Every point needs evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where do similarities go in a Venn diagram?
2. What should each outline point have?
3. Name one way Eli and Jim are alike.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Venn diagram → outline with evidence.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.15 · W.4.2b, W.4.2c

Lesson 5.15: Drafting the Comparison Essay

I can draft a comparison essay with transitions and evidence.

GET READY

What words show a reader you're comparing or contrasting?

Use comparison transitions: Both, Similarly, Likewise, In the same way. Use contrast transitions: However, Unlike, On the other hand, While.

MODEL · BODY PARAGRAPH

Point: Both boys show courage.

1 Topic sentence with a comparison transition.
2 Evidence for Eli.
3 Evidence for Jim.
4 Explanation.

Model answer: Both Eli and Jim show courage when they are alone. Eli climbs the cliff every night and finally lights a signal fire. Similarly, Jim takes risks on his own. These choices show that both boys act bravely instead of waiting for help.

KEY IDEA

Each body paragraph: topic sentence, evidence about both subjects, transitions, explanation.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Comparison transition
2. Contrast transition
3. What follows the evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use comparison and contrast transitions with evidence about both subjects.

UNIT 5 · LESSON 5.16 · W.4.5, L.4.2

Lesson 5.16: Revising and Editing the Comparison Essay

I can revise and edit my comparison essay.

GET READY

What is one thing a reader should feel after reading your essay?

Checklist	✓
Thesis names both subjects and the comparison.	
Each body paragraph has evidence about BOTH subjects.	
I used comparison and contrast transitions.	
Conclusion restates the thesis in new words.	
Capitals, commas, end marks, and spelling are correct.	
Titles of stories are in quotation marks; book titles are underlined or italicized.	

KEY IDEA

Revise for ideas and organization; edit for conventions, including how to write titles.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How do you write a book title by hand?
2. How do you write a short story title?
3. What does a conclusion restate?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 5.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise for ideas and evidence; edit for conventions and title formatting.

UNIT 5 REVIEW

Unit 5 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
5.1	Plot: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution.
5.2	STEAL: Speech, Thoughts, Effect on others, Actions, Looks.
5.3	Settings create problems, shape actions, and set the mood.
5.4	Use the plot arc to summarize long stories.
5.5	Headings, bold words, captions, diagrams, timelines, and sidebars help readers.
5.6	Charts and timelines show information visually; explain what they add.
5.7	Each section has a main idea; the whole-text main idea connects them.
5.8	Integrate words and visuals; name your sources.
5.9	Structure (narrative, letters, drama) shapes what readers know and feel.
5.10	Different narrators include, leave out, and feel different things.
5.11	Compare focus, structure, and details of texts on the same topic.
5.12	Organized talks use evidence from both texts and clear speaking.
5.13	Block or point-by-point; thesis names both subjects.
5.14	Venn diagram → outline with evidence.
5.15	Use comparison and contrast transitions with evidence about both subjects.
5.16	Revise for ideas and evidence; edit for conventions and title formatting.

UNIT 6

Sources and Evidence

Primary and secondary sources, reasons and evidence, opinion writing, diagrams, maps, graphs, and a short research report, with Treasure Island Chapters 8–9.

Jim Hawkins's adventure ends, but yours as a researcher begins. You'll compare sources, judge which ones to trust, weigh reasons and evidence, read diagrams, maps, and graphs, and write both an opinion piece and your own short research report.

In this unit you will…

- Compare primary and secondary sources and judge reliability.
- Identify and evaluate claims, reasons, and evidence.
- Write an opinion piece with reasons, evidence, linking words, and a conclusion.
- Use and create diagrams, maps, and graphs.
- Research a focused question, organize notes, and write a report with sources.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every day you see claims online and in ads. Knowing how to check sources and evidence helps you decide what to believe.

UNIT VOCABULARY

primary source	Created at the time by someone who was there.
secondary source	Written later to explain.
claim	The main opinion.
evidence	Facts that support a reason.
bibliography	A list of sources.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
6.1	Primary and Secondary Sources

Lesson	Title
6.2	Comparing Sources on the Same Topic
6.3	Is This Source Reliable?
6.4	Taking Notes from Sources
6.5	Claims, Reasons, and Evidence
6.6	Evaluating Evidence
6.7	Opinion Writing: Claims and Reasons
6.8	Opinion Writing: Linking Words and Conclusions
6.9	Reading Labeled Diagrams
6.10	Reading Maps
6.11	Reading Graphs in Informational Text
6.12	Adding Visuals to Your Writing
6.13	Starting a Research Project
6.14	Organizing Research Notes
6.15	Drafting a Research Report
6.16	Revising and Presenting Research

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.1 · RI.4.6, RI.4.9

Lesson 6.1: Primary and Secondary Sources

I can tell the difference between primary and secondary sources and explain what each offers.

WORDS TO KNOW

primary source	A source created by someone who was there at the time, such as a diary, letter, photo, or ship's log.
secondary source	A source created later by someone who studied primary sources, such as a textbook or article.

GET READY

If you wanted to know what it was really like on a sailing ship in 1789, what would be the best thing to read?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 8: My Life Hangs in the Balance

As you read: What danger is Jim in? How does he get out of it?

A primary source comes from the time and place being studied. A secondary source explains or summarizes events later. Primary sources give details and feelings from the moment; secondary sources give background and the big picture.

PRIMARY SOURCE

Source 1: A Ship's Log, 1789 (adapted)

A primary source, adapted for young readers (invented for this lesson)

May 3. Wind from the northeast. Sighted a large whale off the starboard bow at noon. Crew in good health. Our water barrels are half full.

May 4. Heavy rain. Two sailors sick with fever. Caught fresh rainwater in the sails and filled three barrels.

May 5. Clear skies. Land sighted at dawn. All hands cheered.

SECONDARY SOURCE

Source 2: Life on Long Voyages

A secondary source (original informational text)

1 Sailors on long voyages in the 1700s faced many dangers. Fresh water often ran low, so crews collected rainwater whenever they could. Illness spread quickly in the crowded spaces below deck.

2 Historians learn about these voyages by studying ships' logs, letters, and maps written by the sailors themselves.

MODEL · COMPARE

What do Source 1 and Source 2 both show?

1 Source 1: “Caught fresh rainwater in the sails”; “Two sailors sick with fever.”

2 Source 2: crews collected rainwater; illness spread quickly.

Model answer: Both show that water ran low and illness was a danger. The log gives specific day-by-day details; the article explains the big picture.

KEY IDEA

Primary = from the time (firsthand). Secondary = written later (explains). Use both.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Is a ship's log primary or secondary?
2. Is a textbook chapter about pirates primary or secondary?
3. What does Source 2 say historians study?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Primary sources come from the time; secondary sources explain later.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.2 · RI.4.9

Lesson 6.2: Comparing Sources on the Same Topic

I can compare what two sources say about the same topic and notice agreements and differences.

WORDS TO KNOW

corroborate	Confirm a fact with another source.

GET READY

If two websites disagree about a fact, what should you do?

When sources agree, you can feel more confident. When they disagree, check who wrote them, when, and why, and look for a third source.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Schooner

An original informational text

1 The Hispaniola in Treasure Island is a schooner, a sailing ship with two or more masts. Schooners were popular in the 1700s and 1800s because they were fast and needed a smaller crew than larger ships.

2 Unlike square-rigged ships, whose sails hung across the ship, a schooner's main sails ran along its length, from front to back. This let schooners sail closer to the direction the wind was coming from.

3 A triangular sail called a jib stretched forward from the front mast toward the bow. Sailors adjusted the sails using the rigging, and a rudder at the stern steered the ship.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

From Sail to Steam

An original informational text

1 For thousands of years, ships depended on wind. In the 1800s, inventors began building ships powered by steam engines. Steamships could travel even when the wind died, and they kept to schedules.

2 At first, many ships used both sails and steam. By 1900, steamships carried most passengers and cargo across the oceans, and the great age of sail was ending.

MODEL · FIND AGREEMENT

Do both texts agree that sailing ships depended on wind?

1 Schooner text: sails let the ship move with the wind.

2 Steam text: “ships depended on wind.”

Model answer: Yes; they corroborate each other.

KEY IDEA

Facts confirmed by two reliable sources are stronger. When sources disagree, investigate.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What advantage did schooners have?
2. What advantage did steamships have?
3. What does corroborate mean?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Compare sources; corroborate facts; investigate disagreements.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.3 · W.4.8, RI.4.8

Lesson 6.3: Is This Source Reliable?

I can judge whether a source is reliable.

WORDS TO KNOW

reliable	Trustworthy and accurate.
credentials	Training or experience that makes someone an expert.

GET READY

Would you trust a website about sharks written by a marine biologist or by an anonymous fan site?

Ask these questions about any source:

Question	Why it matters
Who wrote it? Are they an expert?	Experts are more likely to be accurate.
When was it written?	Science and news change; newer may be better.
Why was it written?	Ads and opinion pieces may leave out facts.
Does it give evidence and sources?	Facts should be backed up.
Do other reliable sources agree?	Corroboration builds trust.

MODEL · JUDGE A SOURCE

A site called “Bees R Awesome” with no author says bees “never sting.”

1 No author or credentials.

2 Claim is not backed by evidence.

3 Other sources say bees can sting.

Model answer: Not reliable.

KEY IDEA

Check the author, date, purpose, evidence, and whether other sources agree.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. More reliable: a museum website or an anonymous blog?

2. Why check the date?

3. Why be careful with an ad?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Check author, date, purpose, evidence, and agreement.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.4 · W.4.8

Lesson 6.4: Taking Notes from Sources

I can take notes in my own words and record where each fact came from.

WORDS TO KNOW

note card	A card or box with one fact or idea and its source.
plagiarism	Using someone else's words or ideas as your own.

GET READY

Why shouldn't you copy sentences straight from a book into your report?

Good notes are short, in your own words, and labeled with the source. Copying whole sentences is plagiarism. Write key words, not full sentences, then turn them into your own sentences later.

MODEL · FROM TEXT TO NOTES

Text: “Schooners were popular in the 1700s and 1800s because they were fast and needed a smaller crew than larger ships.”

1 Key words: schooners, 1700s–1800s, fast, small crew.

2 Note: Schooners: popular 1700s–1800s; fast; small crew.

3 Source: “The Schooner.”

Model answer: Schooners: popular 1700s–1800s, fast, small crew. (Source: “The Schooner”)

KEY IDEA

Key words in your own words + the source = a good note.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is plagiarism?

2. Should notes be full sentences?

3. What must every note include?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Key words, own words, source labeled.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.5 · RI.4.8

Lesson 6.5: Claims, Reasons, and Evidence

I can identify an author's claim, reasons, and evidence.

WORDS TO KNOW

claim	The author's main opinion or argument.
reason	Why the author believes the claim.
evidence	Facts, examples, or expert ideas that support a reason.

GET READY

If you want your parents to agree to something, how do you convince them?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Chapter 9: The Adventure Comes to an End

As you read: How does the story end? Who gets the treasure?

Persuasive authors state a claim, give reasons, and support each reason with evidence. A reason answers why?; evidence answers how do you know?

OPINION WRITING

Should Fourth Graders Have Homework?

An original opinion piece

1 Many people argue about homework. I believe fourth graders should have a small amount of homework, about twenty minutes a night.

2 First, homework helps students practice. When students practice math facts or reading at home, they remember them better. A teacher at my school said her students' test scores rose after she assigned ten minutes of nightly reading.

3 Second, homework teaches responsibility. Students learn to plan their time and finish work without someone reminding them.

4 However, too much homework can be harmful. Children need time to play, rest, and be with their families. That is why twenty minutes is the right amount: enough to practice, but not so much that it takes over the evening.

Claim	Fourth graders should have about twenty minutes of homework a night.
Reason 1	Homework helps students practice.
Evidence	A teacher's students' scores rose with ten minutes of nightly reading.
Reason 2	Homework teaches responsibility.
Evidence	(none given; only explanation)

KEY IDEA

Claim → reasons (why) → evidence (how do you know).

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is the author's claim?
2. Which reason has evidence?
3. What counterargument does the author address?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Claim, reasons (why), evidence (how do you know).

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.6 · RI.4.8

Lesson 6.6: Evaluating Evidence

I can decide whether evidence is relevant and strong enough to support a reason.

WORDS TO KNOW

relevant	Connected to the reason.
sufficient	Enough to convince a reader.

GET READY

Is “Everyone loves dogs” good evidence for building a dog park?

Strong evidence is relevant (it connects to the reason) and sufficient (there's enough of it). Weak evidence includes opinions disguised as facts, exaggerations (everyone, always), and unrelated details.

MODEL · EVALUATE

Claim: Our school needs a garden. Evidence: “Gardens are pretty.”

1 Relevant? Somewhat, but it's an opinion.

2 Stronger: “Students who garden eat more vegetables, according to a university study.”

Model answer: The first is weak (opinion); the second is strong (a fact from a study).

KEY IDEA

Strong evidence: relevant facts, examples, or expert information. Weak: opinions, exaggerations, unrelated details.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Strong or weak: “All kids hate broccoli.”
2. Strong or weak: “A survey of 200 students found 80% wanted longer recess.”
3. Why is “everyone” a warning word?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Strong evidence is relevant, factual, and sufficient.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.7 · W.4.1a, W.4.1b

Lesson 6.7: Opinion Writing: Claims and Reasons

I can state an opinion and support it with reasons and evidence.

WORDS TO KNOW

opinion piece	Writing that states and supports an opinion.

GET READY

Was Jim Hawkins brave or reckless? How would you prove your opinion?

An opinion piece begins with an introduction that states your opinion clearly. Each body paragraph gives a reason with evidence from the text.

Part	What to include
Introduction	Hook + clear opinion
Reason 1	Reason + evidence from the text + explanation
Reason 2	Reason + evidence + explanation
Conclusion	Restate opinion + final thought

MODEL · PLAN

Opinion: Jim was brave, not reckless.

1. Reason 1: He faced danger to protect others.
2. Evidence: a moment from the Reader where Jim takes a risk to help his friends.
3. Reason 2: His choices helped the good side win.
4. Evidence: an event from Chapters 8–9.

Model answer: A plan with an opinion, two reasons, and evidence for each.

KEY IDEA

Opinion → reasons → evidence from the text.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where is the opinion stated?

2. What should each reason have?

3. Write an opinion statement about Long John Silver.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

State an opinion; support it with reasons and text evidence.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.8 · W.4.1c, W.4.1d

Lesson 6.8: Opinion Writing: Linking Words and Conclusions

I can link my opinion and reasons with transitions and write a strong conclusion.

WORDS TO KNOW

linking words	Words that connect opinions and reasons, such as because, for instance, in addition.

GET READY

How do linking words make an argument easier to follow?

Use linking words: because, therefore, since, for example, for instance, in addition, another reason, most importantly. End with a conclusion that restates your opinion in new words and leaves the reader thinking.

MODEL · CONCLUSION

Opinion: Jim was brave.

1 Restate in new words.

2 Final thought.

Model answer: In the end, Jim's courage made the difference. He was young and often afraid, but he never let fear stop him from doing what was right.

KEY IDEA

Linking words connect reasons; conclusions restate and leave a final thought.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Linking word for an example

2. Linking word for a second reason
3. What does a conclusion restate?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Link reasons with transitions; conclude with a restated opinion and final thought.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.9 · RI.4.7

Lesson 6.9: Reading Labeled Diagrams

I can use a labeled diagram to understand a text.

WORDS TO KNOW

diagram	A drawing that shows the parts of something or how it works.
label	A word naming a part of a diagram.

GET READY

How would you explain the parts of a ship without a picture?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Text and diagrams: The Schooner

As you read: Match each part named in the text to the diagram.

A diagram shows what words describe. Read the text and the diagram together: find each labeled part and connect it to the sentence that explains it.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

The Schooner

An original informational text

1 The Hispaniola in Treasure Island is a schooner, a sailing ship with two or more masts. Schooners were popular in the 1700s and 1800s because they were fast and needed a smaller crew than larger ships.

2 Unlike square-rigged ships, whose sails hung across the ship, a schooner's main sails ran along its length, from front to back. This let schooners sail closer to the direction the wind was coming from.

3 A triangular sail called a jib stretched forward from the front mast toward the bow. Sailors adjusted the sails using the rigging, and a rudder at the stern steered the ship.

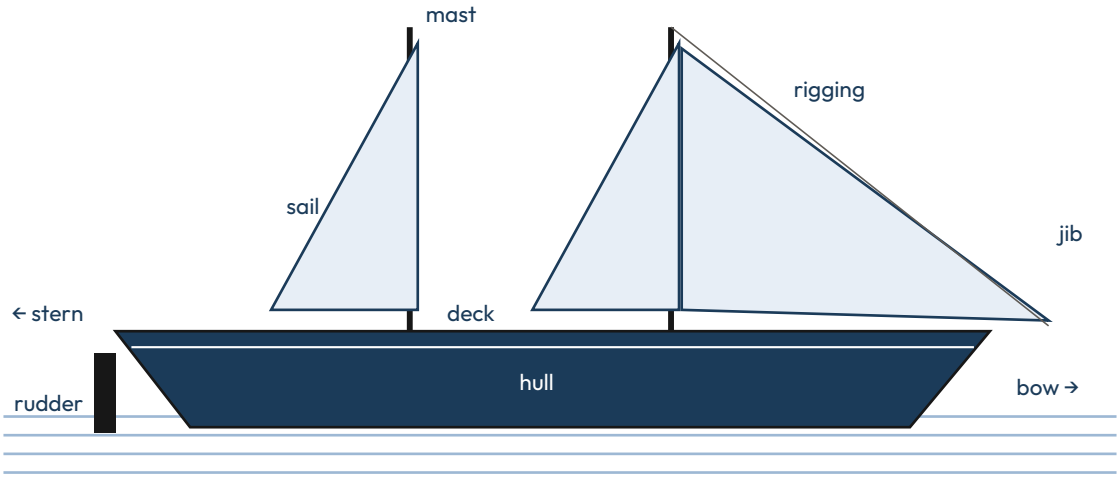


Diagram: Parts of a Schooner

MODEL · CONNECT TEXT AND DIAGRAM

Where is the jib?

1 Text: a triangular sail that stretched forward toward the bow.

2 Diagram: the triangle sail at the front.

Model answer: The jib is the triangular sail at the front, reaching toward the bow.

KEY IDEA

Match words in the text to labels in the diagram. The diagram helps you picture what the words explain.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How many masts does the schooner have?
2. Where is the rudder?
3. What does the rigging do?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Match text to labels; diagrams help you picture explanations.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.10 · RI.4.7

Lesson 6.10: Reading Maps

I can use a map's key, compass rose, and scale to answer questions.

WORDS TO KNOW

key / legend	Explains what map symbols mean.
compass rose	Shows north, south, east, and west.
scale	Shows how map distance compares to real distance.

GET READY

How did Jim and his friends know where to find the treasure?

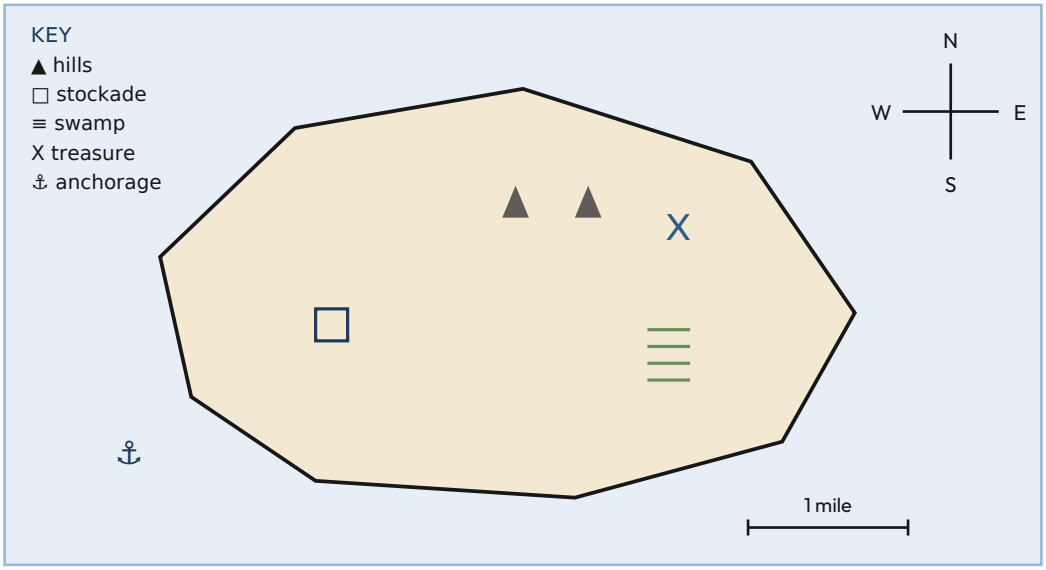
INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Reading the Map of Skeleton Island

An original informational text

1 Maps use symbols to stand for real features. A key (or legend) explains what each symbol means. A compass rose shows directions, and a scale shows how distances on the map compare to real distances.

2 On the map below, the stockade is in the western part of the island. The hills rise near the center, and a swamp lies to the east. The X marks the spot where the treasure was buried, and the anchor symbol shows where ships could anchor safely.



Map: Skeleton Island (an invented map in the style of Treasure Island)

MODEL · USE THE MAP

In which direction would you walk from the stockade to the treasure?

1 Stockade: west side. Treasure X: east of the hills.

2 Compass rose: east is to the right.

Model answer: east (toward the right side of the map)

KEY IDEA

Use the key for symbols, the compass rose for direction, and the scale for distance.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does the □ symbol stand for?
2. Is the swamp north or south of the X?
3. About how wide is the island, using the scale?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Key, compass rose, and scale unlock a map.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.11 · RI.4.7

Lesson 6.11: Reading Graphs in Informational Text

I can explain what a graph shows and how it supports the text.

WORDS TO KNOW

bar graph	A graph that compares amounts using bars.

GET READY

Why might an author show numbers in a graph instead of a sentence?

A graph shows patterns at a glance. Read the title, the labels on each axis, and the scale. Then ask what pattern the graph shows and how it supports the text.

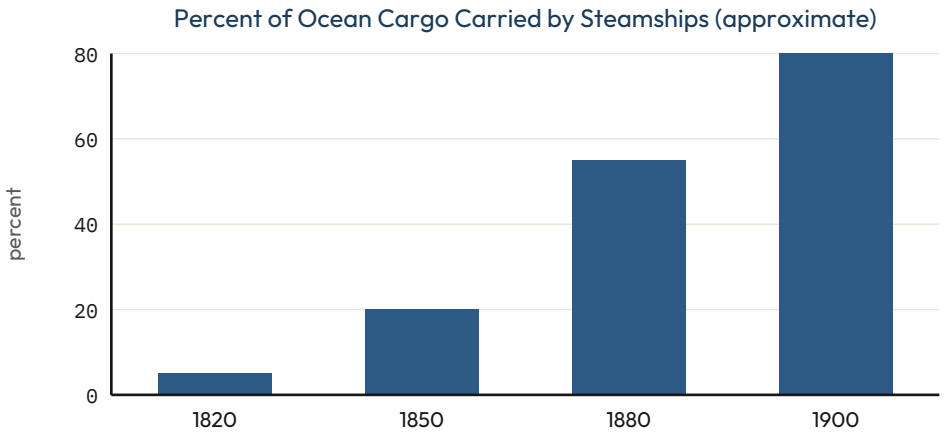
INFORMATIONAL TEXT

From Sail to Steam

An original informational text

1 For thousands of years, ships depended on wind. In the 1800s, inventors began building ships powered by steam engines. Steamships could travel even when the wind died, and they kept to schedules.

2 At first, many ships used both sails and steam. By 1900, steamships carried most passengers and cargo across the oceans, and the great age of sail was ending.



Graph: an illustrative graph for this lesson; values are rounded estimates.

MODEL · READ THE GRAPH

What pattern does the graph show?

1 Read the title and axes.

2 Compare bars: 5, 20, 55, 80.

Model answer: Steamships carried more and more cargo over time, supporting the text's point that steam replaced sail.

KEY IDEA

Title → labels → scale → pattern → connection to the text.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. About what percent did steamships carry in 1880?
2. Between which years was the biggest increase?
3. How does the graph support the text?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Read the title, labels, and scale; connect the pattern to the text.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.12 · W.4.2a

Lesson 6.12: Adding Visuals to Your Writing

I can add a diagram, map, chart, or graph to my own informational writing.

WORDS TO KNOW

caption A sentence that explains a visual.

GET READY

What visual would help a reader understand your favorite hobby?

Writers add visuals to make information clearer. Choose the right type, give it a title and labels, write a caption, and refer to it in your writing (see the diagram).

If you want to show...	use a...
parts of something	labeled diagram
where things are	map
events over time	timeline
amounts or comparisons	bar graph or chart
steps	numbered flowchart

KEY IDEA

Choose the visual that fits, label it, caption it, and mention it in your writing.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Best visual for the steps of making bread
2. Best visual for the parts of a bicycle
3. What does a caption do?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Pick the right visual; title, label, caption, and refer to it.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.13 · W.4.7

Lesson 6.13: Starting a Research Project

I can choose a research question and find sources to answer it.

WORDS TO KNOW

research question A question you investigate by gathering information.

GET READY

What is something about ships, the sea, or the 1700s that you've wondered about?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Informational selection: The Voyage

As you read: Take notes on facts about long ocean voyages.

Good research questions are specific and can't be answered with yes or no. What were ships like? is too broad. How did sailors stay healthy on long voyages? is focused.

Too broad	Focused
Tell about the ocean.	How do whales communicate?
Pirates	How did pirate crews make decisions?
Ships	How did sailors navigate without GPS?

KEY IDEA

Ask a focused question, then find two or three reliable sources.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Broad or focused: “Animals”
2. Broad or focused: “How do sea turtles find the beach where they hatched?”
3. How many sources should you use?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Focused research questions and reliable sources.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.14 · W.4.8, W.4.2a

Lesson 6.14: Organizing Research Notes

I can sort my notes into categories that will become paragraphs.

WORDS TO KNOW

category	A group of related facts.

GET READY

If you had twenty notes, how would you organize them?

Sort notes into two or three categories. Each category becomes a body paragraph. Give each category a heading.

MODEL · SORT NOTES

Question: How did sailors stay healthy on long voyages?

1 Category 1: Food and water (rainwater, limes, salted meat).

2 Category 2: Illness (scurvy, fever, crowded spaces).

3 Category 3: Solutions (citrus fruit, fresh air).

Model answer: Three categories = three body paragraphs.

KEY IDEA

Group notes into categories; each category becomes a paragraph.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does each category become?
2. How many categories?
3. Category for “limes prevented scurvy”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Sort notes into categories for paragraphs.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.15 · W.4.2, W.4.7, W.4.8

Lesson 6.15: Drafting a Research Report

I can draft a short research report from my notes and list my sources.

WORDS TO KNOW

bibliography	A list of the sources used in a report.

GET READY

How does a research report sound different from a story?

A research report has an introduction that states the topic and question, body paragraphs (one per category) with facts in your own words, a conclusion, and a source list.

MODEL · SOURCE LIST

How to list a source

1. Book: Author. Title. Year.
2. Article in this book: “Title.” Grade 4 ELA Textbook, Lesson number.
3. Website: “Page Title.” Website name. Date you used it.

Model answer: Example: “From Sail to Steam.” Grade 4 ELA Textbook, Lesson 6.2.

KEY IDEA

Introduction, body paragraphs by category, conclusion, source list. Use your own words.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What goes at the end of a report?
2. How many body paragraphs?
3. Can you copy sentences from sources?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Introduction, category paragraphs, conclusion, sources.

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6.16 · W.4.5, SL.4.4

Lesson 6.16: Revising and Presenting Research

I can revise my report and present it to an audience.

GET READY

How can you share your research so others learn from it?

Report checklist	✓
My introduction states the topic and question.	
Each paragraph has one category of facts.	
Facts are in my own words.	
I included a visual with a caption.	
My conclusion answers the research question.	
My source list is complete.	
I edited capitals, punctuation, and spelling.	

KEY IDEA

Revise with the checklist, then present clearly with your visual.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should the conclusion do?
2. Name a presentation skill.
3. What should you show during the talk?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 6.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Revise with a checklist; present clearly with a visual.

UNIT 6 REVIEW

Unit 6 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
6.1	Primary sources come from the time; secondary sources explain later.
6.2	Compare sources; corroborate facts; investigate disagreements.
6.3	Check author, date, purpose, evidence, and agreement.
6.4	Key words, own words, source labeled.
6.5	Claim, reasons (why), evidence (how do you know).
6.6	Strong evidence is relevant, factual, and sufficient.
6.7	State an opinion; support it with reasons and text evidence.
6.8	Link reasons with transitions; conclude with a restated opinion and final thought.
6.9	Match text to labels; diagrams help you picture explanations.
6.10	Key, compass rose, and scale unlock a map.
6.11	Read the title, labels, and scale; connect the pattern to the text.
6.12	Pick the right visual; title, label, caption, and refer to it.
6.13	Focused research questions and reliable sources.
6.14	Sort notes into categories for paragraphs.
6.15	Introduction, category paragraphs, conclusion, sources.
6.16	Revise with a checklist; present clearly with a visual.

UNIT 7

Reading Across Texts

Text sets, quests across cultures, myth and science explanations, integrating sources, discussion, and the synthesis essay, with King Arthur Chapters 13–16.

The Grail quest reaches its end, and you'll discover that quest stories appear all over the world. You'll read myths and folktales from Greece and Japan, compare ancient explanations of nature with scientific ones, combine information from several sources, discuss ideas with others, and write a synthesis essay answering the question: What makes a hero?

In this unit you will…

- Read text sets with a guiding question and annotate connections.
- Compare quest patterns and good vs evil across cultures.
- Compare myths and scientific explanations; evaluate explanations.
- Integrate, quote, paraphrase, and summarize sources; discuss with evidence.
- Plan, draft, revise, and publish a synthesis essay.

WHY IT MATTERS

When you research anything, from a school project to a big purchase, you read several sources and combine what they say.

UNIT VOCABULARY

text set	Texts about one topic.
quest	A journey toward an important goal.
myth	A traditional story explaining the world.
citation	Naming a source.
synthesis	Combining ideas from several texts.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
7.1	Reading a Text Set with a Guiding Question
7.2	Annotating Across Texts
7.3	The Quest Pattern Across Cultures
7.4	Good and Evil in Traditional Stories
7.5	Myths as Explanations
7.6	Scientific Explanations
7.7	Comparing a Myth and a Scientific Explanation
7.8	Which Explanation Is Better?
7.9	Integrating Details from Several Sources
7.10	Quoting and Citing Within Writing
7.11	Quote, Paraphrase, or Summarize?
7.12	Collaborative Discussion
7.13	Planning a Synthesis Essay
7.14	Drafting the Synthesis Essay
7.15	Revising with Peer Feedback
7.16	Editing and Publishing the Synthesis Essay

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.1 · RI.4.9, RL.4.9

Lesson 7.1: Reading a Text Set with a Guiding Question

I can read several texts on one topic with a guiding question in mind.

WORDS TO KNOW

text set	A group of texts about the same topic or theme.
guiding question	A big question you try to answer by reading several texts.

GET READY

If you wanted to understand what makes a hero, would one story be enough?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 13: Sir Percival

As you read: How is Percival like and unlike the other knights you've read about?

A text set is a group of texts about one topic. Reading with a guiding question keeps you focused. After each text, jot down what it adds to your answer.

Guiding question: What makes a hero?	
Text	What it adds
King Arthur (the Reader)	courage, fairness, loyalty to others
The Secret of Hollow Hill	a hero can be an ordinary kid who faces fear
The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter	acting quickly to save others
Momotaro (Lesson 7.3)	kindness and teamwork

KEY IDEA

Read each text with the guiding question in mind; record what each adds.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a text set?
2. Why use a guiding question?
3. What does Percival add to the question “What makes a hero?”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Read text sets with a guiding question; record what each text adds.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.2 · RI.4.9, RL.4.1

Lesson 7.2: Annotating Across Texts

I can annotate texts to connect ideas across them.

GET READY

How can sticky notes help you connect two books?

When annotating across texts, use codes that show connections:

Code	Means
S	Same idea as another text
D	Different from another text
+	New information
?	Question
Q	Great quote for my guiding question

MYTH

Jason and the Golden Fleece · A Greek Myth Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Greek myth

1 Long ago in Greece, a young man named Jason learned that his uncle had stolen his father's throne. When Jason demanded it back, his uncle smiled slyly. “Bring me the Golden Fleece,” he said, “and the throne is yours.” The fleece hung in a faraway land, guarded by a dragon that never slept.

2 Jason built a great ship called the Argo and gathered the bravest heroes of Greece to sail with him. On the journey, they rowed past clashing rocks that smashed ships to splinters and faced storms and strange creatures.

3 In the land of the fleece, the king gave Jason impossible tasks, such as plowing a field with fire-breathing bulls. With the help of the king's daughter, Medea, who knew magic, Jason completed the tasks, put the dragon to sleep, and took the fleece.

4 Jason sailed home a hero. His quest had tested his courage, but he could not have succeeded alone.

MODEL · ANNOTATE WITH CONNECTIONS

Paragraph 4: “he could not have succeeded alone.”

1 Code S: like Pip, who needed Grandfather's map.

2 Code Q: a great quote about heroes needing help.

Model answer: S and Q

KEY IDEA

Connection codes (S, D, +, ?, Q) help you see patterns across texts.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does code S mean?
2. Which detail in Jason could get a D compared to Arthur?
3. Why is the last sentence a good Q?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use connection codes to see patterns across texts.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.3 · RL.4.9

Lesson 7.3: The Quest Pattern Across Cultures

I can compare the quest pattern in stories from different cultures.

WORDS TO KNOW

quest	A long, difficult journey to find or achieve something important.
traditional literature	Stories passed down over generations: myths, folktales, legends, and fables.

GET READY

What do the Grail quest, Jason's voyage, and a video game adventure have in common?

Stories from many cultures follow a similar quest pattern: a hero leaves home for an important goal, faces trials, gets help, succeeds, and returns changed.

FOLKTALE

Momotaro, the Peach Boy · A Japanese Folktale Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Japanese folktale

1 An old woman washing clothes in a river saw a giant peach floating by. She carried it home, and when she and her husband cut it open, out stepped a baby boy. They named him Momotaro, which means “Peach Boy,” and raised him with love.

2 When Momotaro grew up, ogres were stealing from the villages nearby. Momotaro decided to stop them. His mother packed him millet dumplings for the journey.

3 Along the way, he shared his dumplings with a hungry dog, a monkey, and a pheasant. Each one joined him. Together they crossed the sea to the ogres' island. The pheasant flew over the walls, the monkey opened the gate, and the dog and Momotaro charged in. The ogres surrendered and returned everything they had stolen.

4 Momotaro came home with the treasure and his loyal friends, and the villages were safe again.

Quest step	Jason (Greece)	Momotaro (Japan)
Call to the quest	win back the throne	stop the ogres
Helpers	Argo heroes, Medea	dog, monkey, pheasant
Trials	clashing rocks, fire bulls, dragon	crossing the sea, ogres' fortress
Return	home a hero with the fleece	home with treasure; villages safe

KEY IDEA

Quests across cultures share a pattern: call, journey, helpers, trials, success, return.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How did Momotaro gain his helpers?
2. Name one difference between the two quests.
3. What culture does each story come from?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Quest stories across cultures share a pattern.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.4 · RL.4.9, RL.4.2

Lesson 7.4: Good and Evil in Traditional Stories

I can compare how traditional stories show good and evil.

WORDS TO KNOW

opposition	A struggle between two sides.

GET READY

Why do so many old stories have a clear villain?

Traditional stories often show the opposition of good and evil. Heroes usually show kindness, courage, or honesty, while villains show greed, cruelty, or trickery. Comparing how stories show this reveals what different cultures valued.

Story	Good shown by	Evil shown by	What the culture valued
Jason	courage, teamwork	the uncle's trickery	bravery; keeping promises
Momotaro	kindness, sharing	ogres who steal	kindness; protecting the community
King Arthur	loyalty, fairness	betrayal, greed	loyalty; justice

KEY IDEA

Good vs evil reveals what a culture values. Compare the qualities of heroes and villains.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does the villain in Jason want?
2. How does Momotaro show good?
3. What do all three stories value?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Good vs evil in traditional stories shows what cultures valued.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.5 · RL.4.2, RL.4.9

Lesson 7.5: Myths as Explanations

I can explain how a myth explains something in nature.

WORDS TO KNOW

myth	A traditional story, often about gods or heroes, that explains something about the world.

GET READY

Before science, how might people have explained why winter comes?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 14: The Death of Dindrane

As you read: What sacrifice is made in this chapter? How do the knights respond?

Long ago, people told myths to explain things they saw in nature, such as thunder, the seasons, or the stars. Myths also teach lessons about human feelings.

MYTH

Persephone and the Seasons · A Greek Myth Retold

An original retelling of a traditional Greek myth

1 Demeter was the goddess of the harvest. Wherever she walked, crops grew tall and flowers bloomed. She loved nothing more than her daughter, Persephone.

2 One day Hades, ruler of the underworld, carried Persephone away to his dark kingdom. Demeter searched everywhere. In her grief, she stopped caring for the earth. Plants withered, snow fell, and people grew hungry.

3 At last, the king of the gods made an agreement. Persephone could return to her mother, but because she had eaten six pomegranate seeds in the underworld, she must spend six months of every year there.

4 And so, the ancient Greeks said, every year when Persephone goes below, Demeter mourns, and the earth grows cold and bare: autumn and winter. When Persephone returns, Demeter rejoices, and the earth blooms again: spring and summer.

MODEL · FIND THE EXPLANATION

What does the myth explain?

1 When Persephone is in the underworld, Demeter grieves and the earth grows cold.

2 When she returns, Demeter is happy and plants grow.

Model answer: The myth explains why there are seasons.

KEY IDEA

Myths explain nature through characters' actions and feelings.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Why does Demeter stop caring for the earth?
2. Why must Persephone return to the underworld each year?
3. Which seasons happen when Persephone is away?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Myths explained nature through stories of gods and feelings.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.6 · RI.4.3

Lesson 7.6: Scientific Explanations

I can explain a scientific process using details from the text.

WORDS TO KNOW

axis	An imaginary line that something spins around.
hemisphere	Half of Earth: Northern or Southern.

GET READY

Do you think Earth is closer to the sun in summer? Why?

Scientific explanations are based on observations and evidence. They often correct misconceptions (wrong ideas) and explain causes step by step.

SCIENCE TEXT

What Causes the Seasons?

An original informational text

1 Many people think seasons happen because Earth moves closer to and farther from the sun. That's not the reason. In fact, Earth is closest to the sun in early January, during winter in the Northern Hemisphere.

2 The real cause is Earth's tilt. Earth's axis, the imaginary line it spins around, is tilted about 23.5 degrees. As Earth travels around the sun during the year, the tilt stays pointed the same direction in space.

3 For part of the year, the Northern Hemisphere is tilted toward the sun. Sunlight hits it more directly, and days are longer, so it is summer. Six months later, the Northern Hemisphere is tilted away from the sun. Sunlight hits at a low angle, days are shorter, and it is winter.

4 That's why, when it is summer in the United States, it is winter in Australia.

MODEL · EXPLAIN THE CAUSE

Why is it summer in the Northern Hemisphere in July?

1 Earth's tilt points the Northern Hemisphere toward the sun.

2 Sunlight hits more directly; days are longer.

Model answer: The Northern Hemisphere is tilted toward the sun, so it gets more direct light and longer days.

KEY IDEA

Scientific explanations give causes with evidence, step by step.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What misconception does the text correct?
2. How much is Earth tilted?
3. Why is it winter in Australia during U.S. summer?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Seasons are caused by Earth's tilt, not its distance from the sun.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.7 · RL.4.9, RI.4.9

Lesson 7.7: Comparing a Myth and a Scientific Explanation

I can compare how a myth and a scientific text explain the same thing.

GET READY

Can a myth be valuable even if it isn't scientifically true?

A myth and a science text may explain the same event very differently. Compare what each says causes it, how each explains it, and why each was written.

	Persephone myth	What Causes the Seasons?
Cause	Demeter's grief and joy	Earth's tilt
Based on	stories and beliefs	observations and evidence
Purpose	explain nature; teach about feelings; entertain	inform with facts
Genre	myth	science text

KEY IDEA

Myths explain with stories and teach values; science explains with evidence. Both show how people understand the world.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What causes the seasons in the myth?
2. What causes the seasons in science?
3. What is still valuable about the myth?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Compare cause, basis, and purpose of myth and science explanations.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.8 · RI.4.8, RI.4.9

Lesson 7.8: Which Explanation Is Better?

I can evaluate which of two explanations is clearer and better supported.

WORDS TO KNOW

gravity	The force that pulls objects toward each other.

GET READY

If one explanation is one sentence and another is three paragraphs, which is better?

A better explanation is not just longer: it is complete (explains how, not just what), accurate, clear, and supported with details.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Explanation A: Tides

An original informational text

The ocean rises and falls along the shore twice a day. These changes are called tides. Tides are caused by the moon.

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Explanation B: Why the Ocean Has Tides

An original informational text

1 Along most coasts, the ocean rises to a high tide and falls to a low tide about twice a day. The main cause is the moon's gravity, the force that pulls objects toward each other.

2 The moon pulls on the whole Earth, but it pulls hardest on the side closest to it. Ocean water on that side bulges toward the moon. A second bulge forms on the opposite side of Earth. As Earth spins, a coastline passes through both bulges each day, which is why most places have two high tides.

3 The sun's gravity affects tides too. When the sun and moon line up, at full moon and new moon, tides are extra high and extra low.

MODEL · EVALUATE

Which explains tides better?

1 A says the moon causes tides but not how.

2 B explains gravity, the two bulges, Earth's spin, and the sun's role.

Model answer: B is better: it is complete and gives supporting details.

KEY IDEA

Judge explanations by completeness, accuracy, clarity, and support.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does A leave out?
2. Why do most places have two high tides a day?
3. When are tides extra high?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Better explanations are complete, accurate, clear, and supported.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.9 · RI.4.9, W.4.2b

Lesson 7.9: Integrating Details from Several Sources

I can combine details from several sources into one clear paragraph.

GET READY

How is combining sources like making a smoothie?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 15: The Achievement of the Grail

As you read: Who achieves the Grail? Why him?

When you integrate sources, you blend details from each into one smooth explanation, using transitions and naming the sources.

SOURCE 1

Source 1: Becoming a Page

An original informational text

Boys from noble families began training for knighthood at about age seven. They became pages and lived in the castle of a lord. Pages learned manners, served meals, and practiced riding and fighting with wooden swords.

SOURCE 2

Source 2: The Squire's Training

An original informational text

At about fourteen, a page became a squire. A squire served one knight, caring for his horse, polishing his armor, and following him into battle. Squires trained hard with real weapons and learned the code of chivalry.

SOURCE 3

Source 3: The Dubbing Ceremony

An original informational text

Around age twenty-one, a squire who had proven himself could become a knight in a ceremony called dubbing. Often he spent the night before praying. In the morning, a lord tapped him on the shoulder with a sword and declared him a knight.

MODEL · INTEGRATE THREE SOURCES

How did a boy become a knight?

1 Source 1: page at seven, manners and wooden swords.

2 Source 2: squire at fourteen, served a knight, real weapons.

3 Source 3: dubbed around twenty-one.

Model answer: Becoming a knight took about fourteen years. Boys began as pages at around seven, learning manners and practicing with wooden swords. At about fourteen they became squires, serving a knight and training with real weapons. Finally, around age twenty-one, a squire could be dubbed a knight in a special ceremony.

KEY IDEA

Blend details in a logical order with transitions; don't just list source by source.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. At what age did a page become a squire?
2. What is dubbing?
3. What transition words help integrate?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Integrate: blend details from sources in logical order with transitions.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.10 · W.4.8, W.4.9

Lesson 7.10: Quoting and Citing Within Writing

I can include short quotations and name the source within my sentences.

WORDS TO KNOW

citation	Naming where information came from.

GET READY

How can readers tell which source a fact came from?

Name the source in the sentence: According to “The Squire's Training,” … or Source 3 explains that …. Put exact words in quotation marks and keep quotations short.

Citation starters
According to “___,” …
The author of “___” explains that …
In “___,” we learn that …
As Source ___ states, “…”

MODEL · QUOTE AND CITE

Combine a quote with your own words.

1 Choose a short, important phrase.

2 Introduce it with the source.

Model answer: According to “The Dubbing Ceremony,” a lord “tapped him on the shoulder with a sword and declared him a knight.”

KEY IDEA

Name the source; quote only short, powerful phrases; put exact words in quotation marks.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Citation starter

2. Should quotes be long or short?

3. What goes around exact words?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Name sources and quote short phrases within sentences.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.11 · W.4.8

Lesson 7.11: Quote, Paraphrase, or Summarize?

I can choose whether to quote, paraphrase, or summarize information from a source.

GET READY

When should you use the author's exact words?

Choice	Use it when...	Example
Quote	the exact words are powerful or important	“he could not have succeeded alone”
Paraphrase	you need one specific idea in your own words	Jason needed help to complete his quest.
Summarize	you need the main points of a whole text	Jason sailed with heroes, completed impossible tasks with Medea's help, and won the fleece.

KEY IDEA

Quote for powerful words, paraphrase for one idea, summarize for the whole text, and always cite.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Best choice to share the main points of the seasons text
2. Best choice for “the earth blooms again”
3. Best choice for one fact about tides

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Quote powerful words, paraphrase ideas, summarize whole texts.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.12 · SL.4.1

Lesson 7.12: Collaborative Discussion

I can take part in a discussion by building on others' ideas and using evidence.

WORDS TO KNOW

discussion norms Agreed rules for a respectful conversation.

GET READY

What makes a conversation about a book go well?

Good discussions follow norms: come prepared, listen, take turns, build on others' ideas, ask questions, and support opinions with evidence.

Discussion starters
I agree with ___ because ...
I'd like to add to what ___ said ...
I see it differently because ...
Can you explain what you mean by ...?
My evidence is on page ___, where ...

KEY IDEA

Prepare, listen, build on ideas, ask questions, and use evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Starter to disagree respectfully
2. Why come prepared?
3. What should you do while others speak?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Discuss with norms, evidence, and respect.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.13 · W.4.2, W.4.9

Lesson 7.13: Planning a Synthesis Essay

I can plan an essay that answers a guiding question with evidence from several texts.

WORDS TO KNOW

synthesis essay	An essay that combines ideas from several texts to answer one question.

GET READY

After reading so many hero stories, what do you now think makes a hero?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 16: Sir Lancelot and the Lily Maid of Astolat

As you read: Is Lancelot a hero in this chapter? Why or why not?

A synthesis essay answers a guiding question with a thesis, then supports it with evidence from several texts. Each body paragraph makes one point and uses at least two texts.

MODEL · PLAN

Guiding question: What makes a hero?

1. Thesis: A hero is someone who faces fear for others and accepts help along the way.
2. Body 1: facing fear for others (Nell, Ada, Pip).
3. Body 2: accepting help (Jason, Momotaro, Arthur).

Model answer: Each body paragraph uses at least two texts.

KEY IDEA

Thesis → body paragraphs that each use two or more texts → conclusion.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a synthesis essay?

2. How many texts per body paragraph?
3. What goes first?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plan a thesis and body paragraphs using several texts each.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.14 · W.4.2, W.4.8, W.4.9

Lesson 7.14: Drafting the Synthesis Essay

I can draft a synthesis essay that integrates and cites several texts.

GET READY

How do you move smoothly from one text to another in a paragraph?

Use transitions to move between texts: Similarly, Likewise, In the same way, Another example is, On the other hand. Cite each text by title.

MODEL · BODY PARAGRAPH

Point: Heroes face fear to help others.

1 Topic sentence.
2 Text 1 evidence: In “The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter,” Nell climbs the tower with trembling hands.
3 Transition + Text 2: Similarly, in “The Bridge at Millbrook,” Ada stands in the rain to stop the wagons.
4 Explanation.

Model answer: Heroes face their fears to help others. In “The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter,” Nell climbs a hundred stairs in a storm with trembling hands to light the lamp. Similarly, in “The Bridge at Millbrook,” Ada races to warn the town before the bridge collapses. Both girls are afraid, but they act anyway, which is what makes them heroes.

KEY IDEA

Move between texts with transitions; cite each; explain how the evidence supports your point.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Transition to add a second example
2. How do you cite a short story?
3. What follows the evidence?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use transitions and citations to move between texts.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.15 · W.4.5, SL.4.1

Lesson 7.15: Revising with Peer Feedback

I can give and use helpful feedback to revise my essay.

WORDS TO KNOW

feedback	Comments that help a writer improve.

GET READY

What kind of feedback actually helps you improve?

Helpful feedback is kind, specific, and helpful. Use the frame: I like… because… / I wonder… / Have you thought about…?

Feedback checklist for a partner's essay
Can I find the thesis? Underline it.
Does each body paragraph use two or more texts?
Are the texts named?
Is there an explanation after the evidence?
Does the conclusion answer the guiding question?

KEY IDEA

Kind, specific, helpful feedback; then revise using it.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Is “It's good” helpful feedback?

2. Feedback frame starter

3. What should you do with feedback?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Kind, specific, helpful feedback leads to better revisions.

UNIT 7 · LESSON 7.16 · W.4.5, W.4.6, L.4.2

Lesson 7.16: Editing and Publishing the Synthesis Essay

I can edit and publish my synthesis essay.

GET READY

How will you share your final essay?

Editing checklist	✓
Titles: books underlined/italic; stories in quotation marks.	
Quotations have quotation marks and are introduced.	
Commas after introductory words (However, Similarly, In addition,).	
Complete sentences; no run-ons.	
Spelling checked.	

Publish by typing the essay (with help, if needed) or copying it neatly. Add a title and a source list.

KEY IDEA

Edit for conventions, then publish with a title and source list.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Punctuate: However the myth is still valuable
2. Format: Treasure Island (typed)
3. Format: Momotaro, the Peach Boy (story)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 7.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Edit conventions; publish with a title and sources.

UNIT 7 REVIEW

Unit 7 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
7.1	Read text sets with a guiding question; record what each text adds.
7.2	Use connection codes to see patterns across texts.
7.3	Quest stories across cultures share a pattern.
7.4	Good vs evil in traditional stories shows what cultures valued.
7.5	Myths explained nature through stories of gods and feelings.
7.6	Seasons are caused by Earth's tilt, not its distance from the sun.
7.7	Compare cause, basis, and purpose of myth and science explanations.
7.8	Better explanations are complete, accurate, clear, and supported.
7.9	Integrate: blend details from sources in logical order with transitions.
7.10	Name sources and quote short phrases within sentences.
7.11	Quote powerful words, paraphrase ideas, summarize whole texts.
7.12	Discuss with norms, evidence, and respect.
7.13	Plan a thesis and body paragraphs using several texts each.
7.14	Use transitions and citations to move between texts.
7.15	Kind, specific, helpful feedback leads to better revisions.
7.16	Edit conventions; publish with a title and sources.

UNIT 8

Grammar and Conventions

Nouns, pronouns, verbs, complete sentences, capitalization, punctuation, confused words, and editing, with King Arthur Chapters 17–20.

Clear writing follows rules that readers expect. In this unit you'll master the grammar and conventions of fourth grade, from plurals and possessives to progressive tenses, dialogue punctuation, and tricky homophones, and you'll become a sharp-eyed editor of your own writing.

In this unit you will…

- Form plurals and possessives; use pronouns and relative pronouns; make words agree.
- Use verb tenses, progressive tenses, and modals; write complete sentences.
- Capitalize and punctuate correctly, including dialogue and compound sentences.
- Use confused words and spelling patterns correctly; edit whole passages.

WHY IT MATTERS

Letters, emails, applications, and signs all depend on correct grammar and punctuation to be understood and taken seriously.

UNIT VOCABULARY

noun	A person, place, thing, or idea.
pronoun	A word that replaces a noun.
tense	When a verb's action happens.
fragment	An incomplete sentence.
run-on	Sentences joined without correct punctuation.
homophones	Words that sound alike but differ in meaning and spelling.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
8.1	Nouns: Common, Proper, and Plural

Lesson	Title
8.2	Possessive Nouns
8.3	Pronouns and Relative Pronouns
8.4	Agreement: Subjects, Verbs, and Pronouns
8.5	Verb Tenses and Irregular Verbs
8.6	Progressive Tenses
8.7	Modal Auxiliaries
8.8	Complete Sentences, Fragments, and Run-Ons
8.9	Capitalization
8.10	Punctuating Dialogue
8.11	Commas in Compound Sentences and Lists
8.12	Order of Adjectives and Prepositional Phrases
8.13	Frequently Confused Words
8.14	Spelling Patterns and Checking Spelling
8.15	Punctuation and Words for Effect
8.16	Editing a Whole Passage

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.1 · L.4.1, L.4.2a, L.4.2d

Lesson 8.1: Nouns: Common, Proper, and Plural

I can identify common and proper nouns and spell plural nouns correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

noun	A word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.
proper noun	Names a specific person, place, or thing; begins with a capital letter.
common noun	Names a general person, place, or thing.
plural	More than one.

GET READY

How many nouns can you find in this sentence: "Arthur rode his horse to Camelot with three knights"?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 17: The Queen and the Poisoned Apple

As you read: Notice the proper nouns: names of people and places.

Rule for plurals	Examples
Most nouns: add -s	knight → knights
Ends in s, x, z, ch, sh: add -es	box → boxes, sword → swords, bench → benches
Consonant + y: change y to i, add -es	lady → ladies, story → stories
Vowel + y: add -s	day → days, key → keys
Some f/fe: change to v, add -es	knife → knives, wolf → wolves
Irregular	man → men, child → children, foot → feet, mouse → mice

MODEL · FIND AND SORT NOUNS

"Arthur rode his horse to Camelot with three knights."

1 Proper: Arthur, Camelot (specific, capitalized).

2 Common: horse, knights.

Model answer: 4 nouns: Arthur, horse, Camelot, knights

KEY IDEA

Proper nouns are capitalized. Follow the spelling rules for plurals, and learn irregular plurals.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Plural of lady
2. Plural of wolf
3. Proper noun for “a queen” in King Arthur

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Proper nouns are capitalized; follow plural spelling rules.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.2 · L.4.2, L.4.1

Lesson 8.2: Possessive Nouns

I can use apostrophes to show possession.

WORDS TO KNOW

possessive noun	A noun that shows ownership, using an apostrophe.

GET READY

What's the difference between knights, knight's, and knights'?

Possessive rule	Example
Singular noun: add 's	the knight's sword (one knight)
Plural noun ending in s: add '	the knights' swords (many knights)
Plural noun not ending in s: add 's	the children's toys, the men's horses

MODEL · CHOOSE THE FORM

The swords of all the knights

1 Plural owner: knights (ends in s).

2 Add only an apostrophe.

Model answer: the knights' swords

WATCH OUT

Don't use an apostrophe to make a word plural. Three knight's is wrong; three knights is correct.

KEY IDEA

Singular: 's. Plural ending in s: '. Plural not ending in s: 's.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. The crown of the queen
2. The horses of the soldiers
3. The games of the children

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use apostrophes for possession, not for plurals.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.3 · L.4.1a

Lesson 8.3: Pronouns and Relative Pronouns

I can use pronouns, including relative pronouns, correctly.

WORDS TO KNOW

pronoun	A word that takes the place of a noun: he, she, it, they, him, her, them.
relative pronoun	Who, whom, whose, which, or that; connects a describing part to a noun.

GET READY

How would a story sound if the author never used pronouns? “Arthur took Arthur's sword and Arthur rode away.”

Pronouns replace nouns so writing isn't repetitive. Relative pronouns begin a clause that tells more about a noun.

Relative pronoun	Use for	Example
who	people (as subject)	The knight who won was Lancelot.
whom	people (as object)	The squire, whom Owen trusted, held the reins.
whose	ownership	The girl whose kite crashed tried again.
which	things (extra information)	Excalibur, which was magic, shone brightly.
that	things or people	This is the map that Grandfather drew.

MODEL · CHOOSE THE RELATIVE PRONOUN

The lady ___ gave Arthur the sword lived in the lake.

1 Refers to a person.

2 She is the subject of “gave.”

Model answer: who

KEY IDEA

Who for people, which for things, that for either, whose for ownership.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. The sword, ___ was magic, was called Excalibur.

2. Pip, ___ grandfather made maps, found the room.

3. The boy ___ pulled the sword became king.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Pronouns replace nouns; relative pronouns connect describing clauses.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.4 · L.4.1

Lesson 8.4: Agreement: Subjects, Verbs, and Pronouns

I can make subjects and verbs agree and pronouns agree with the nouns they replace.

WORDS TO KNOW

subject-verb agreement	A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb.
antecedent	The noun a pronoun replaces.

GET READY

Which sounds right: “The knights rides” or “The knights ride”?

Rule	Example
Singular subject → verb usually ends in -s	The knight rides.
Plural subject → no -s	The knights ride.
Two subjects joined by and → plural	Arthur and Kay ride.
Pronoun matches its antecedent	The knights polished their swords. (not his)

MODEL · FIX AGREEMENT

Each of the knights have a horse.

1 Subject: Each (singular), not knights.

2 Singular verb: has.

Model answer: Each of the knights has a horse.

KEY IDEA

Find the real subject; match the verb. Match each pronoun to its antecedent.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. The queen and the king ___ (walk/walks).

2. The box of swords ___ (is/are) heavy.

3. Every squire cleaned ___ (his/their) knight's armor.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Subjects and verbs agree; pronouns match antecedents.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.5 · L.4.1

Lesson 8.5: Verb Tenses and Irregular Verbs

I can use past, present, and future tenses, including irregular verbs.

WORDS TO KNOW

tense	The time a verb shows: past, present, or future.
irregular verb	A verb that does not add -ed in the past tense.

GET READY

What's wrong with “Yesterday Arthur drawed his sword”?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 18: Sir Meliagraunce

As you read: Notice the past-tense verbs the author uses to tell the story.

Present	Past	Past with has/have
draw	drew	drawn
ride	rode	ridden
take	took	taken
swim	swam	swum
bring	brought	brought
fly	flew	flown
write	wrote	written
fall	fell	fallen

MODEL · FIX THE VERB

Yesterday Arthur drawed his sword.

1 Time: yesterday → past.

2 Draw is irregular: drew.

Model answer: Yesterday Arthur drew his sword.

KEY IDEA

Keep tenses consistent; memorize irregular past forms.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Past of ride

2. Has ___ (write)

3. Future of sail

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use consistent tenses and correct irregular forms.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.6 · L.4.1b

Lesson 8.6: Progressive Tenses

I can use progressive verb tenses to show ongoing action.

WORDS TO KNOW

progressive tense	A verb form that shows action continuing over time: am/is/are/was/were/will be + -ing.

GET READY

What's the difference between "I read" and "I was reading when the phone rang"?

Tense	Form	Example
Present progressive	am / is / are + -ing	The knights are riding now.
Past progressive	was / were + -ing	Jim was hiding when Silver spoke.
Future progressive	will be + -ing	We will be sailing at dawn.

MODEL · CHOOSE THE FORM

When the storm hit, Nell ___ (read) by the fire.

1 An ongoing action interrupted in the past.

2 Past progressive: was + -ing.

Model answer: was reading

KEY IDEA

Progressive tenses show ongoing action: am/is/are, was/were, or will be + -ing.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Present progressive of swim (they)
2. Past progressive of sleep (I)
3. Future progressive of wait (we)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Progressive tenses: helping verb + -ing for ongoing action.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.7 · L.4.1c

Lesson 8.7: Modal Auxiliaries

I can use modal verbs such as can, may, and must to show ability, permission, and necessity.

WORDS TO KNOW

modal auxiliary	A helping verb that shows ability, permission, possibility, or necessity: can, could, may, might, must, should, will, would.

GET READY

What's the difference between "You can go," "You may go," and "You must go"?

Modal	Shows	Example
can / could	ability	Arthur can pull the sword.
may / might	permission or possibility	You may enter. It might rain.
must	necessity	Knights must be loyal.
should	advice	You should rest.
will / would	future / polite request or wish	I will help. Would you hold this?

MODEL · CHOOSE THE MODAL

Sailors ___ watch the stars to know their latitude. (ability)

1 Ability → can.

Model answer: can

KEY IDEA

Choose the modal that matches the meaning: ability, permission, possibility, necessity, or advice.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Permission: "___ I borrow your pencil?"
2. Necessity: "You ___ wear a helmet."
3. Advice: "You ___ study for the test."

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Modals show ability, permission, possibility, necessity, and advice.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.8 · L.4.1f

Lesson 8.8: Complete Sentences, Fragments, and Run-Ons

I can write complete sentences and fix fragments and run-ons.

WORDS TO KNOW

complete sentence	Has a subject and a predicate and expresses a complete thought.
fragment	An incomplete sentence missing a subject, a predicate, or a complete thought.
run-on	Two or more sentences joined without correct punctuation.

GET READY

Is “Ran across the drawbridge.” a complete sentence?

Problem	Example	Fix
Fragment (no subject)	Ran across the drawbridge.	The squire ran across the drawbridge.
Fragment (incomplete thought)	When the trumpet sounded.	When the trumpet sounded, the joust began.
Run-on	The fog was thick we could not see.	The fog was thick. We could not see. / The fog was thick, so we could not see.

KEY IDEA

Every sentence needs a subject, a predicate, and a complete thought. Fix run-ons with a period, or with a comma and a conjunction.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Fragment or sentence: “Because the bridge cracked.”
2. Fix the run-on: “Ada ran she warned the farmer.”
3. Sentence or fragment: “The dragon slept.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Complete sentences have a subject, predicate, and complete thought.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.9 · L.4.2a

Lesson 8.9: Capitalization

I can capitalize words correctly.

GET READY

Find the capitalization mistakes: “on monday, jim and i visited the admiral benbow inn in england.”

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 19: The Civil War

As you read: What divides the Round Table in this chapter?

Capitalize	Examples
the first word of a sentence	The knights rode.
the pronoun I	Jim and I
names of people and pets	Arthur, Pip, Captain (a pelican)
specific places	Camelot, England, Lake Michigan
days, months, holidays	Monday, June, Thanksgiving
titles before names	King Arthur, Sir Kay, Dr. Livesey
important words in titles	Treasure Island, The Secret of Hollow Hill

MODEL · FIX CAPITALS

on monday, jim and i visited the admiral benbow inn in england.

1 First word: On.

2 Day: Monday.

3 Names: Jim, I.

4 Place names: Admiral Benbow Inn, England.

Model answer: On Monday, Jim and I visited the Admiral Benbow Inn in England.

WATCH OUT

Don't capitalize seasons (summer) or titles used without a name (the king rode out).

KEY IDEA

Capitalize sentence beginnings, I, names, specific places, days, months, holidays, titles with names, and important words in book titles.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Capitalize: queen guinevere lived in camelot.
2. Capitalize: in july we visited texas.
3. Should "summer" be capitalized?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Capitalize sentence starts, I, names, places, days, months, holidays, and titles.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.10 · L.4.2b

Lesson 8.10: Punctuating Dialogue

I can use commas and quotation marks correctly in dialogue.

WORDS TO KNOW

quotation marks	Marks (“ ”) that go around the exact words a person says.

GET READY

Where do the commas and quotation marks go? Merlin said follow me

Pattern	Example
Speaker first	Merlin said, “Follow me.”
Speaker after	“Follow me,” said Merlin.
Question or exclamation	“Where are you going?” asked Kay. / “Stop!” shouted Arthur.
Speaker in the middle	“Follow me,” said Merlin, “and do not look back.”

MODEL · PUNCTUATE

where is the sword asked arthur

1 Exact words: Where is the sword?

2 Question mark inside the closing quotation mark.

3 Speaker after: asked Arthur.

Model answer: “Where is the sword?” asked Arthur.

KEY IDEA

Quotation marks go around exact words. Commas and end marks go inside the closing quotation mark. Start a new paragraph for each new speaker.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Punctuate: Kay said I lost my sword

2. Punctuate: run shouted Jim

3. Where does the comma go in “Hurry,” said Will?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Quotation marks around exact words; punctuation inside.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.11 · L.4.2c

Lesson 8.11: Commas in Compound Sentences and Lists

I can use commas before conjunctions in compound sentences and in lists.

WORDS TO KNOW

compound sentence	Two complete sentences joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction.
coordinating conjunction	for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so (FANBOYS).

GET READY

How could you join "The fog was thick" and "We could not see the ship" into one sentence?

Rule	Example
Compound sentence: comma before FANBOYS	The fog was thick, so we could not see the ship.
Lists of three or more: commas between items	Pip packed bread, a candle, and a compass.
After introductory words	However, the map was old. / Yes, I will come.

MODEL · JOIN WITH A CONJUNCTION

Jim wanted to sail. His mother was worried.

1 Both are complete sentences.

2 Contrast → but.

3 Comma before but.

Model answer: Jim wanted to sail, but his mother was worried.

KEY IDEA

Comma + FANBOYS joins two sentences. Commas separate items in a list.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Join: I was tired. I kept walking. (contrast)

2. Add commas: We saw owls hawks and eagles.

3. What does FANBOYS stand for?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Comma + FANBOYS joins sentences; commas separate list items.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.12 · L.4.1d, L.4.1e

Lesson 8.12: Order of Adjectives and Prepositional Phrases

I can order adjectives correctly and use prepositional phrases.

WORDS TO KNOW

preposition	A word that shows how a noun relates to another word, such as in, on, under, beside, through.
prepositional phrase	A preposition and the words that follow it: under the bridge.

GET READY

Which sounds right: “a red big old ship” or “a big old red ship”?

Usual order	Example
1. number	two
2. opinion	beautiful
3. size	big
4. age	old
5. shape	round
6. color	red
7. origin	Spanish
8. material	wooden
Together	two beautiful big old wooden ships

Prepositional phrases add where, when, or how: under the bridge, after the storm, with a smile. They can make sentences more precise.

MODEL · ORDER ADJECTIVES

a (wooden, old, small) chest

1 size: small, age: old, material: wooden.

Model answer: a small old wooden chest

KEY IDEA

Adjectives go in order: number, opinion, size, age, shape, color, origin, material. Prepositional phrases add detail.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Order: a (red, silk, beautiful) banner
2. Find the prepositional phrase: The map was hidden under the floor.
3. Add a phrase: The knight rode ___.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Order adjectives conventionally; add prepositional phrases for detail.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.13 · L.4.1g

Lesson 8.13: Frequently Confused Words

I can correctly use frequently confused words.

WORDS TO KNOW

homophones Words that sound the same but have different spellings and meanings.

GET READY

Which is right: “Their going to the castle” or “They're going to the castle”?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 20: The Departure of Sir Lancelot

As you read: Watch for any of this lesson's confusing words in the chapter.

Word	Meaning	Example
to / too / two	toward / also, very / 2	Two knights went to the castle too.
there / their / they're	place / belongs to them / they are	They're polishing their swords over there.
your / you're	belongs to you / you are	You're holding your map.
its / it's	belongs to it / it is	It's a ship; its sails are torn.
new / knew	not old / did know	Pip knew the room was new to her.

MODEL · CHOOSE THE WORD

___ going to the castle.

1 Means “They are” → they're.

Model answer: They're going to the castle.

KEY IDEA

Test contractions by expanding them: you're = you are, it's = it is, they're = they are.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. ___ (Its/It's) raining.
2. The cat licked ___ (its/it's) paw.
3. I want to come ___ (to/too/two).

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Expand contractions to test; learn the meaning of each homophone.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.14 · L.4.2d

Lesson 8.14: Spelling Patterns and Checking Spelling

I can use spelling patterns and reference tools to spell words correctly.

GET READY

What do you do when you're not sure how to spell a word?

Pattern	Examples
Drop silent e before -ing or -ed	ride → riding, hope → hoped
Double final consonant (short vowel + one consonant) before -ing/-ed	stop → stopped, swim → swimming
Change y to i before -ed or -es (consonant + y)	carry → carried, try → tries
i before e, except after c	believe, field, receive
Silent letters	knight, knife, write, climb

When unsure, sound out the word, check a word wall or the glossary, or look it up in a dictionary or spell checker (and check that it picked the right word).

KEY IDEA

Learn patterns; check uncertain spellings with a reference.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Add -ing: swim
2. Add -ed: carry

3. Add -ing: hope

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use spelling patterns; check references.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.15 · L.4.3a, L.4.3b

Lesson 8.15: Punctuation and Words for Effect

I can choose punctuation and precise words for effect.

GET READY

How does “The door creaked open.” feel different from “The door creaked open…”?

Writers use punctuation to create effects: an exclamation point shows strong feeling, an ellipsis (…) shows a pause or trailing off, and a dash adds drama. Choose words that are precise and fit the mood.

Plain	For effect
The ship was coming.	The ship was coming. Closer. Closer.
She was surprised.	She gasped. “The treasure!”
He waited.	He waited… and waited… and waited.
It was a big storm.	It was a storm — the worst in a hundred years.

KEY IDEA

Use punctuation and precise words on purpose, not everywhere.

WATCH OUT

Too many exclamation points lose their power!!! Use them only for real excitement.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Punctuation to show trailing off
2. Punctuation for strong feeling
3. Revise for effect: “The dragon was scary.”

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Punctuation and precise words create effects; use them on purpose.

UNIT 8 · LESSON 8.16 · L.4.1, L.4.2, W.4.5

Lesson 8.16: Editing a Whole Passage

I can edit a passage for capitalization, punctuation, grammar, and spelling.

WORDS TO KNOW

proofread	Read carefully to find and fix mistakes.

GET READY

How many mistakes can you find in a short paragraph?

Edit in passes: first capitals, then punctuation, then grammar (agreement, tense), then spelling and confused words.

EDITING PASSAGE

Edit Me: A Feast at Camelot

A passage with mistakes for editing practice

1 last saturday sir gawain and sir kay rode to camelot for a feast. the kings hall was filled with knights ladys and musicians.

2 “where is sir lancelot” asked the queen. nobody new. their was an empty seat at the round table.

MODEL · EDIT PARAGRAPH 1

last saturday sir gawain and sir kay rode to camelot for a feast. the kings hall was filled with knights ladys and musicians.

1 Capitals: Last Saturday Sir Gawain Sir Kay Camelot The.

2 Possessive: king's.

3 List commas: knights, ladies, and musicians.

4 Spelling: ladies.

Model answer: Last Saturday Sir Gawain and Sir Kay rode to Camelot for a feast. The king's hall was filled with knights, ladies, and musicians.

KEY IDEA

Edit in passes: capitals → punctuation → grammar → spelling.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Edit paragraph 2
2. How many passes should you make?
3. Which error type is new/knew?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 8.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Edit in passes: capitals, punctuation, grammar, spelling.

UNIT 8 REVIEW

Unit 8 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
8.1	Proper nouns are capitalized; follow plural spelling rules.
8.2	Use apostrophes for possession, not for plurals.
8.3	Pronouns replace nouns; relative pronouns connect describing clauses.
8.4	Subjects and verbs agree; pronouns match antecedents.
8.5	Use consistent tenses and correct irregular forms.
8.6	Progressive tenses: helping verb + -ing for ongoing action.
8.7	Modals show ability, permission, possibility, necessity, and advice.
8.8	Complete sentences have a subject, predicate, and complete thought.
8.9	Capitalize sentence starts, I, names, places, days, months, holidays, and titles.
8.10	Quotation marks around exact words; punctuation inside.
8.11	Comma + FANBOYS joins sentences; commas separate list items.
8.12	Order adjectives conventionally; add prepositional phrases for detail.
8.13	Expand contractions to test; learn the meaning of each homophone.
8.14	Use spelling patterns; check references.
8.15	Punctuation and precise words create effects; use them on purpose.
8.16	Edit in passes: capitals, punctuation, grammar, spelling.

UNIT 9

Capstone

Year in review, a writing portfolio, a capstone piece, and a presentation, with King Arthur Chapters 21–22.

The legend of King Arthur comes to its end, and so does your fourth-grade year. You'll review the reading and language skills you've mastered, build a portfolio of your best writing, write and polish a capstone piece, and present your learning to an audience.

In this unit you will...

- Review vocabulary, literary, and informational reading skills.
- Select portfolio pieces, reflect on growth, and set goals.
- Draft, revise, edit, and publish a capstone piece.
- Plan and deliver a presentation with evidence and a visual.

WHY IT MATTERS

Portfolios, reflections, and presentations are how artists, scientists, and professionals share their best work.

UNIT VOCABULARY

portfolio	A collection showing growth.
reflection	Writing that looks back on learning.
capstone	A final project.
goal	Something you plan to achieve.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
9.1	Vocabulary Review
9.2	Comprehension Review: Literature
9.3	Comprehension Review: Informational Text

Lesson	Title
9.4	Strategies for Reading Tests
9.5	Building a Writing Portfolio
9.6	Writing a Reflection
9.7	Setting Goals
9.8	Planning a Capstone Piece
9.9	Drafting and Revising for Ideas and Organization
9.10	Revising for Word Choice and Sentence Variety
9.11	Editing with a Checklist
9.12	Publishing
9.13	Planning a Presentation with Evidence
9.14	Visuals and Speaking Skills
9.15	Practicing and Listening
9.16	Presentation Day and Celebration

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.1 · L.4.4, L.4.5

Lesson 9.1: Vocabulary Review

I can use word parts, context clues, and figurative language skills to understand words.

GET READY

Which vocabulary strategy do you use most when you meet a new word?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 21: The Last Battle and the Death of Arthur

As you read: Watch for unfamiliar words and use a strategy for each one.

Strategy (Unit)	Ask yourself
Word parts (1)	Do I know a prefix, suffix, or root?
Context clues (1)	Is there a definition, synonym, antonym, or example nearby?
Figurative language (1)	Is this a simile, metaphor, or idiom? What two things are compared?
Allusions (4)	Does this refer to a myth (Herculean, Achilles' heel)?
Reference tools (1, 8)	Can I check a glossary or dictionary?

REALISTIC FICTION

The Last Lantern

An original story

1 Every night for sixty years, Grandmother Rosa lit a lantern in her window. The village children believed it was magic. Some said it kept wolves away; others said it called home lost sailors.

2 When Rosa grew too weak to climb the stairs, her grandson Mateo found her staring at the dark window. “Who will light it now?” she whispered.

3 Mateo had always thought the lantern was silly. But that night, he climbed the stairs, struck a match, and lit the wick. The flame trembled, then glowed steady and gold.

4 The next morning, a fisherman knocked at the door. “Last night the fog was so thick I lost my way,” he said. “Then I saw your light. I steered toward it and found the harbor.”

5 Mateo looked at his grandmother. She smiled. “It was never magic,” she said. “It was just someone remembering to care.” From then on, Mateo lit the lantern every night.

MODEL · USE STRATEGIES

What does “trembled” mean in paragraph 3?

1 Context: “then glowed steady.” Steady is an antonym clue.

2 So trembled means shook or flickered.

Model answer: flickered, shook

KEY IDEA

Choose the strategy that fits: word parts, context, figurative meaning, allusion, or reference tools.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does “It was just someone remembering to care” mean?
2. Prefix and meaning in unlit
3. Figurative or literal: “glowed steady and gold”?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.1.

LESSON SUMMARY

Use word parts, context, figurative meaning, allusions, and references.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.2 · RL.4.1, RL.4.2, RL.4.3

Lesson 9.2: Comprehension Review: Literature

I can determine theme, describe characters, and make inferences in a story.

GET READY

What lesson does “The Last Lantern” teach?

Skill	Ask yourself
Theme (Unit 2)	What does the main character learn?
Character (Units 2, 5)	What do STEAL clues show? How does the character change?
Inference (Units 2–3)	What clues + what I know lead to a conclusion?
Plot (Unit 5)	What is the climax? How is it resolved?
Point of view (Units 3–5)	Who is telling the story?

MODEL · THEME

“The Last Lantern”

1 Mateo thinks the lantern is silly.

2 Lighting it saves a fisherman.

3 Rosa: it was about caring.

Model answer: Small acts of caring can make a big difference.

KEY IDEA

Theme, character, inference, plot, point of view: support each with evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How does Mateo change?
2. What is the climax?
3. Point of view

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.2.

LESSON SUMMARY

Support theme, character, and inference answers with evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.3 · RI.4.1, RI.4.2, RI.4.5, RI.4.7

Lesson 9.3: Comprehension Review: Informational Text

I can find main ideas, explain text structures, and use text features and evidence.

GET READY

What do you look at first when you read an article?

INFORMATIONAL TEXT

Coral Reefs: Cities Under the Sea

An original informational text

Tiny Builders

A coral reef may look like a colorful rock, but it is built by millions of tiny animals called coral polyps. Each polyp makes a hard shell of limestone around its soft body. Over thousands of years, these shells pile up to form reefs.

A Busy Neighborhood

Reefs cover less than one percent of the ocean floor, yet about one quarter of all ocean species live on or near them. Fish, sea turtles, octopuses, and sharks find food and shelter among the coral.

Reefs in Danger

When ocean water becomes too warm, corals push out the tiny algae that live inside them and give them color and food. The coral turns white, which is called coral bleaching. If the water stays warm too long, the coral can die.

Protecting Reefs

Scientists are growing young corals in underwater nurseries and replanting them on damaged reefs. Visitors can help by never touching or standing on coral and by using sunscreen that is safe for reefs.

MODEL · MAIN IDEA OF THE WHOLE TEXT

"Coral Reefs: Cities Under the Sea"

1 Section ideas: polyps build reefs; reefs host many species; warm water causes bleaching; people help protect them.

Model answer: Coral reefs, built by tiny polyps, are home to many sea creatures but are in danger, so people are working to protect them.

KEY IDEA

Preview features, find section and whole-text main ideas, identify the structure, and cite evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is coral bleaching?
2. Structure of "Reefs in Danger"
3. Structure of "Protecting Reefs"

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.3.

LESSON SUMMARY

Features → section ideas → whole main idea → structure → evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.4 · RL.4.1, RI.4.1

Lesson 9.4: Strategies for Reading Tests

I can use smart strategies to answer reading questions.

WORDS TO KNOW

eliminate	Cross out answers you know are wrong.

GET READY

What do you do when a test question seems hard?

- Preview the questions, then read the passage.
- Annotate as you read.
- Go back to the text; don't answer from memory.
- Eliminate wrong choices, then choose the best one.
- For written answers, use ACE: Answer, Cite, Explain.
- Check: Did I answer every part of the question?

MODEL · ELIMINATE CHOICES

Why did the fisherman knock at the door? A) to buy fish B) to thank them for the light C) to complain about the fog D) to visit Rosa

1 A: not in the text.

2 C: he mentions fog but isn't complaining.

3 D: not why he came.

4 B: he found the harbor because of the light.

Model answer: B

KEY IDEA

Preview, annotate, go back to the text, eliminate, use ACE, and check.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Should you answer from memory?
2. What does ACE stand for?
3. What do you do with obviously wrong choices?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.4.

LESSON SUMMARY

Preview, annotate, go back, eliminate, ACE, check.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.5 · W.4.10, W.4.5

Lesson 9.5: Building a Writing Portfolio

I can select pieces that show my growth as a writer.

WORDS TO KNOW

portfolio	A collection of your best work that shows growth over time.

GET READY

If you could show next year's teacher three pieces of your writing, which would you choose?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Chapter 22: The Death of Guenevere and of Sir Lancelot

As you read: How does the book end? What happens to the Round Table?

A portfolio shows your growth. Choose pieces from different kinds of writing: narrative (Unit 1), responses (Units 2–3), comparison (Units 4–5), opinion and research (Unit 6), synthesis (Unit 7).

Portfolio piece	Why I chose it
1. A narrative	
2. An opinion or comparison essay	
3. A research report or synthesis essay	
4. My capstone piece (Week 3)	

KEY IDEA

Choose pieces that show different types of writing and your growth.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name a narrative you wrote this year.
2. Why include different types of writing?
3. What is a portfolio?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.5.

LESSON SUMMARY

Choose varied pieces that show growth.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.6 · W.4.10

Lesson 9.6: Writing a Reflection

I can write a reflection about how I've grown as a reader and writer.

WORDS TO KNOW

reflection	Writing that looks back and thinks about what you learned.

GET READY

What is something that was hard for you in October that is easier now?

A reflection is honest and specific. Name what you learned, give an example from your work, and explain how you changed.

MODEL · REFLECTION PARAGRAPH

Reflect on evidence.

1 What I learned: how to support answers with evidence.
2 Example: my Unit 2 ACE paragraphs.
3 How I changed: I used to write opinions only; now I quote the text.

Model answer: At the start of the year, I answered questions with just my opinion. In Unit 2, I learned ACE, and my paragraphs about the Round Table used real quotes. Now I always go back to the text to prove my answers.

KEY IDEA

Be specific: what you learned, an example, and how you changed.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name a skill you improved.
2. What makes a reflection specific?

3. Should a reflection be honest about challenges?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.6.

LESSON SUMMARY

Reflections name learning, give examples, and explain growth.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.7 · W.4.10, SL.4.1

Lesson 9.7: Setting Goals

I can set reading and writing goals for next year.

WORDS TO KNOW

goal	Something you plan to achieve.

GET READY

What do you want to get better at in fifth grade?

Good goals are specific and have a plan. Instead of "read more," try "read two chapter books a month and keep a reading log."

Vague goal	Specific goal with a plan
Write better.	Use transitions in every paragraph; check with my revision checklist.
Read more.	Read 20 minutes every night and log my books.
Learn new words.	Add three new words a week to a word journal.

KEY IDEA

Make goals specific, with a plan to reach them.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Make specific: "Be a better speller."
2. What makes a goal specific?
3. Why have a plan?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.7.

LESSON SUMMARY

Specific goals with plans.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.8 · W.4.1, W.4.2, W.4.3, W.4.4

Lesson 9.8: Planning a Capstone Piece

I can plan a new piece of writing that shows my best skills.

WORDS TO KNOW

capstone	A final project that shows everything you've learned.

GET READY

If you could write anything about the books and topics from this year, what would it be?

Choose one capstone option. Plan it with the organizer that fits.

Option	Prompt	Organizer
Narrative	Write a new adventure about a character from King Arthur or Treasure Island.	plot arc (Unit 5)
Opinion	Who is the greatest hero from this year's reading? Convince your reader.	opinion plan (Unit 6)
Informational	Research and explain a topic from this year (knights, ships, navigation, reefs, bees).	category notes (Unit 6)

KEY IDEA

Choose the option that lets you show your best skills, and plan before drafting.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Organizer for a narrative
2. Organizer for an opinion piece
3. What is a capstone?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.8.

LESSON SUMMARY

Choose an option and plan with the right organizer.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.9 · W.4.5, W.4.4

Lesson 9.9: Drafting and Revising for Ideas and Organization

I can draft my capstone and revise it for clear ideas and organization.

GET READY

What is the difference between a first draft and a final draft?

READ IN YOUR READER

Treasure Island Reader · Reread Chapter 9: The Adventure Comes to an End

As you read: Notice how Stevenson's story wraps up. Use it as a model for your ending.

Draft quickly from your plan. Then revise: Is the main idea or opinion clear? Does each paragraph have one focus? Are events or reasons in the best order? Is the ending satisfying?

KEY IDEA

Draft from the plan; revise for focus, order, and a strong ending.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should a first draft focus on?
2. One question to ask when revising
3. What makes an ending satisfying?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.9.

LESSON SUMMARY

Draft from the plan; revise for focus, order, and ending.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.10 · L.4.3a, W.4.5

Lesson 9.10: Revising for Word Choice and Sentence Variety

I can revise for precise words and varied sentences.

WORDS TO KNOW

sentence variety — Using sentences of different lengths and beginnings.

GET READY

What happens when every sentence starts the same way?

MODEL · COMBINE AND VARY

The ship sailed. The ship was fast. The ship reached the island.

1 Combine: The fast ship sailed to the island.

2 Vary beginnings: At dawn, the fast ship reached the island.

Model answer: At dawn, the fast ship skimmed across the waves and reached the island.

- Replace tired words (went, said, good, nice) with precise words (Unit 1).
- Combine short choppy sentences with and, but, so, who, which (Unit 8).
- Start some sentences with a prepositional phrase or transition.

KEY IDEA

Precise words and varied sentences make writing flow.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Combine: Ada was brave. Ada was quick.
2. Vary the start: We sailed at dawn.
3. Precise word for said (whispered)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.10.

LESSON SUMMARY

Precise words and varied sentences.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.11 · L.4.1, L.4.2, W.4.5

Lesson 9.11: Editing with a Checklist

I can edit my capstone for conventions using a checklist.

GET READY

Which grammar rule from Unit 8 do you most need to check?

Editing checklist (four passes)	✓
Capitals: sentence starts, I, names, places, titles	
Punctuation: end marks, commas (lists, compound sentences, after introductions), dialogue	
Grammar: agreement, tense, complete sentences	
Spelling and confused words: their/there/they're, its/it's, your/you're, to/too/two	

KEY IDEA

Four passes: capitals, punctuation, grammar, spelling.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Second pass checks...
2. Fix: its time to go
3. Fix: the knights rides home

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.11.

LESSON SUMMARY

Edit in four passes.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.12 · W.4.6

Lesson 9.12: Publishing

I can publish a polished final copy of my capstone.

WORDS TO KNOW

publish	Prepare a final copy to share with readers.

GET READY

How can the way a piece looks help readers enjoy it?

- Type or neatly copy the final version.
- Add a title page with your name and date.
- Add an illustration, map, diagram, or chart if it helps.
- Include a source list for informational pieces.
- Add the piece to your portfolio.

KEY IDEA

A polished, well-designed final copy shows respect for your readers.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What goes on a title page?
2. When do you need a source list?
3. Name a visual you might add.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.12.

LESSON SUMMARY

Publish a polished final copy for the portfolio.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.13 · SL.4.4, RL.4.2

Lesson 9.13: Planning a Presentation with Evidence

I can plan a presentation that uses evidence from texts.

GET READY

How did King Arthur's story change from Chapter 1 to Chapter 22?

READ IN YOUR READER

King Arthur and the Round Table Reader · Reread Chapters 1 and 22

As you read: Compare the beginning and the end. What changed? What stayed the same?

Your presentation shares your capstone OR answers: How did Arthur's story come full circle? Use at least two pieces of text evidence.

Part	What to say
Hook	a question, quote, or surprising fact
Main point 1	with text evidence
Main point 2	with text evidence
Conclusion	what you want listeners to remember

KEY IDEA

Hook, main points with evidence, conclusion.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. How long should a presentation be?
2. How many pieces of evidence?
3. Name a hook type.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.13.

LESSON SUMMARY

Plan a hook, evidence-based points, and a conclusion.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.14 · SL.4.4, SL.4.5

Lesson 9.14: Visuals and Speaking Skills

I can use a visual and speak clearly to an audience.

GET READY

What makes a speaker easy to listen to?

- Look at your audience.
- Speak loudly and clearly at a steady pace.
- Use note cards with key words, not full sentences.
- Point to your visual when you talk about it.
- Stand still and use natural gestures.

Create a visual: a poster, a slide, a map, a timeline, or a drawing. Keep text short and pictures large.

KEY IDEA

Eye contact, clear voice, steady pace, and a simple visual.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name two speaking skills.
2. Should note cards have full sentences?
3. What makes a good visual?

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.14.

LESSON SUMMARY

Clear speaking plus a simple visual.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.15 · SL.4.3, SL.4.1

Lesson 9.15: Practicing and Listening

I can practice my presentation and listen to identify a speaker's reasons and evidence.

GET READY

What should a good listener do during a presentation?

Practice twice: once alone, once for a listener. As a listener, identify the speaker's main points and evidence, then give kind, specific feedback and ask a question.

Listener notes
Speaker's main point:
Evidence they used:
One thing they did well:
One question I have:

KEY IDEA

Practice with feedback; listen for main points and evidence.

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. What should a listener identify?
2. How many times should you practice?
3. Feedback should be...

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.15.

LESSON SUMMARY

Practice with feedback; listen for points and evidence.

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9.16 · SL.4.4, W.4.10

Lesson 9.16: Presentation Day and Celebration

I can present my learning and reflect on my year.

GET READY

What are you proudest of from fourth grade?

Present your capstone or full-circle talk to your family. Afterward, share your portfolio and celebrate a year of reading and writing!

KEY IDEA

You read legends, adventures, myths, and articles; you wrote stories, essays, reports, and reflections. Celebrate how much you've grown!

YOUR TURN

Answer in your notebook in complete sentences. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name your favorite book or story from this year.
2. Name your favorite piece of your own writing.
3. Name one skill you'll use in fifth grade.

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 9.16.

LESSON SUMMARY

Present, share the portfolio, and celebrate.

UNIT 9 REVIEW

Unit 9 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
9.1	Use word parts, context, figurative meaning, allusions, and references.
9.2	Support theme, character, and inference answers with evidence.
9.3	Features → section ideas → whole main idea → structure → evidence.
9.4	Preview, annotate, go back, eliminate, ACE, check.
9.5	Choose varied pieces that show growth.
9.6	Reflections name learning, give examples, and explain growth.
9.7	Specific goals with plans.
9.8	Choose an option and plan with the right organizer.
9.9	Draft from the plan; revise for focus, order, and ending.
9.10	Precise words and varied sentences.
9.11	Edit in four passes.
9.12	Publish a polished final copy for the portfolio.
9.13	Plan a hook, evidence-based points, and a conclusion.
9.14	Clear speaking plus a simple visual.
9.15	Practice with feedback; listen for points and evidence.
9.16	Present, share the portfolio, and celebrate.

Glossary

academic word	A word used in many school subjects, like compare, describe, or explain.
ACE	Answer the question, Cite evidence, Explain how the evidence supports your answer.
adage / proverb	A short, well-known saying that gives advice or states a truth.
adjective	A word that describes a noun.
allusion	A reference to a well-known story.
annotate	Mark a text while reading.
antecedent	The noun a pronoun replaces.
antonym	A word that means the opposite of another word.
archaic	Old-fashioned; no longer commonly used.
author's point	The idea the author wants readers to believe or understand.
author's purpose	The reason an author writes: to persuade, inform, or entertain.
axis	An imaginary line that something spins around.
bar graph	A graph that compares amounts using bars.
base word	A word that can stand alone, to which prefixes and suffixes are added.
bibliography	A list of sources.
block structure	Write all about Subject A, then all about Subject B.
body paragraph	A paragraph with a reason and evidence.
bow	The front of a ship.
capstone	A final project.
caption	Words that explain a picture.
cast of characters	The list of characters at the start of a play.
category	A group of related facts.
cause	Why something happens.
cause and effect	Shows why something happened and its results.
character	A person or animal in a story.
character change	How a character's feelings, beliefs, or actions are different at the end than at the beginning.
characterization	How an author shows what a character is like.

chart	Information organized in rows and columns.
chronological	In time order.
chunk	A small section of a text, such as a few paragraphs.
citation	Naming a source.
claim	The main opinion.
classic	A book that has been read and admired for a long time.
cliffhanger	An ending that leaves the reader in suspense.
climax	The turning point of a plot.
clue	A detail that hints at something the author doesn't say directly.
common noun	Names a general person, place, or thing.
compare	Tell how things are alike.
compare and contrast	Shows how things are alike and different.
compass rose	Shows north, south, east, and west.
complete sentence	Has a subject and a predicate and expresses a complete thought.
compound sentence	Two complete sentences joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction.
conclude	Decide something based on evidence.
conclusion	The last paragraph; sums up the answer.
conflict	A problem or struggle in a story.
content word	A word that belongs to one topic, like moat for castles.
context	The words and sentences around a word.
context clue	A hint in the text about a word's meaning.
contrast	Tell how things are different.
coordinating conjunction	for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so (FANBOYS).
corroborate	Confirm a fact with another source.
credentials	Training or experience that makes someone an expert.
detail	A small piece of information in a text.
diagram	A drawing that shows the parts of something or how it works.
dialogue	The words characters say to each other, shown in quotation marks.
dictionary entry	A word in a dictionary with its pronunciation, part of speech, and meanings.
discussion norms	Agreed rules for a respectful conversation.

draft	A first version of a piece of writing.
edit	Fix mistakes in capitalization, punctuation, grammar, and spelling.
effect	What happens as a result.
eliminate	Cross out answers you know are wrong.
epistolary	Told through letters or journals.
evidence	Facts that support a reason.
exposition	The beginning: characters, setting, and the situation.
fact	A statement that can be proved true.
falling action	Events after the climax.
feedback	Comments that help a writer improve.
figurative language	Words used in an unusual way to create a picture or feeling, not to be taken literally.
first-person point of view	The narrator is a character who uses I, me, and my.
firsthand account	Told by someone who was there.
focus	The part of a topic a text pays most attention to.
fragment	An incomplete sentence.
galley	A ship's kitchen.
gist	The general idea of a section.
glossary	A list of important words and their meanings at the back of a book.
goal	Something you plan to achieve.
graphic organizer	A chart or diagram that organizes information.
gravity	The force that pulls objects toward each other.
guide words	The two words at the top of a dictionary page that show the first and last entries on the page.
guiding question	A big question you try to answer by reading several texts.
heading	A title for a section.
hemisphere	Half of Earth: Northern or Southern.
homophones	Words that sound alike but differ in meaning and spelling.
idiom	A phrase with a meaning different from its words.
illustration	A picture that goes with a text.

infer	Figure out something the author does not say directly, using clues and what you know.
inference	Clues + what I know.
informational text	Writing that gives facts about a real topic.
integrate	Combine information from different sources.
interpretation	An artist's or performer's own way of showing a text.
introduction	The first paragraph; states the main idea or answer.
irregular verb	A verb that does not add -ed in the past tense.
key / legend	Explains what map symbols mean.
key details	Facts and examples that support the main idea.
label	A word naming a part of a diagram.
legend	A story from long ago about a hero; parts may be true, but much is made up.
linking words	Words that connect opinions and reasons, such as because, for instance, in addition.
loaded words	Words with strong positive or negative feelings, used to persuade.
main idea	The most important point of an informational text.
metaphor	A comparison saying one thing is another.
modal auxiliary	A helping verb that shows ability, permission, possibility, or necessity: can, could, may, might, must, should, will, would.
monitor	Keep track of whether you understand.
mood	The feeling a text creates.
motive	The reason a character does something.
multiple-meaning word	A word with more than one meaning, like bat or spring.
myth	A traditional story explaining the world.
mythology	Ancient stories about gods and heroes.
narrative	A story that tells about events, real or imagined.
narrator	The voice telling the story.
note card	A card or box with one fact or idea and its source.
noun	A person, place, thing, or idea.
opinion	A statement of what someone thinks or feels.
opinion piece	Writing that states and supports an opinion.

opposition	A struggle between two sides.
paraphrase	Retell the author's idea in your own words.
perspective	How a character sees and feels about events.
persuade	Try to convince readers to think or do something.
plagiarism	Using someone else's words or ideas as your own.
plot	The sequence of events in a story.
plural	More than one.
point-by-point structure	Compare A and B on one point at a time.
port	The left side of a ship (facing forward).
portfolio	A collection showing growth.
possessive noun	A noun that shows ownership, using an apostrophe.
prediction	An inference about what will happen next.
prefix	A word part at the beginning of a word.
preposition	A word that shows how a noun relates to another word, such as in, on, under, beside, through.
prepositional phrase	A preposition and the words that follow it: under the bridge.
presentation	A talk that shares information with an audience.
primary source	Created at the time by someone who was there.
problem and solution	Shows a problem and how it was solved.
procedure	A series of steps for doing something.
progressive tense	A verb form that shows action continuing over time: am/is/are/was/were/will be + -ing.
prompt	A question or direction that tells you what to write.
pronoun	A word that replaces a noun.
proofread	Read carefully to find and fix mistakes.
proper noun	Names a specific person, place, or thing; begins with a capital letter.
prose	Ordinary writing in sentences and paragraphs.
publish	Share a final, clean copy with readers.
quest	A journey toward an important goal.
quotation marks	Marks (“ ”) that go around the exact words a person says.
quote	Copy the author's exact words inside quotation marks.

reason	Why the author believes the claim.
reasoning	How evidence supports an idea.
reflection	Writing that looks back on learning.
relative pronoun	Who, whom, whose, which, or that; connects a describing part to a noun.
relevant	Connected to the question.
reliable	Trustworthy and accurate.
research question	A question you investigate by gathering information.
resolution	How the problem is solved.
revise	Improve the ideas, order, and word choice of writing.
rhyme	Words that end with the same sound.
rigging	The ropes that hold up a ship's masts and sails.
rising action	Events that build the problem.
root	The main part of a word.
run-on	Sentences joined without correct punctuation.
scale	Shows how map distance compares to real distance.
secondary source	Written later to explain.
secondhand account	Told by someone who learned about it from others or research.
sensory language	Words that appeal to sight, sound, smell, taste, or touch.
sentence variety	Using sentences of different lengths and beginnings.
sequence	The order in which events happen.
setting	When and where a story takes place.
shades of meaning	Small differences between words that mean almost the same thing.
sidebar	A box of extra information beside the main text.
simile	A comparison using like or as.
stage directions	Notes telling actors what to do.
stamina	Ability to keep going.
stanza	A group of lines in a poem.
starboard	The right side of a ship (facing forward).
stern	The back of a ship.
strongest evidence	The detail that most clearly proves the answer.

subject-verb agreement	A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb.
sufficient	Enough to convince a reader.
suffix	A word part at the end of a word.
summary	A short retelling of the most important parts.
suspense	Worry about what happens next.
synonym	A word that means the same or almost the same as another word.
synthesis	Combining ideas from several texts.
synthesis essay	An essay that combines ideas from several texts to answer one question.
synthesize	Combine information.
task	What the prompt asks you to do.
tense	When a verb's action happens.
text evidence	Details from a text that support an answer.
text features	Headings, captions, bold words, and visuals.
text set	Texts about one topic.
text structure	How information is organized.
theme	A story's life lesson.
thesaurus	A reference book that lists synonyms and antonyms.
thesis	The main claim of an essay.
third-person point of view	The narrator is outside the story and uses he, she, and they.
timeline	A line showing events in time order.
topic	What a story is about in one or two words, like friendship.
topic sentence	The first sentence that tells what the paragraph is about.
traditional literature	Stories passed down over generations: myths, folktales, legends, and fables.
trait	A word that describes what a character is like, such as brave or selfish.
transition word	A word or phrase that connects ideas and shows order, like first, then, suddenly.
verb	A word that shows action or being.
verse	Lines of poetry.
visualize	Make a picture in your mind.
vivid	Bright and clear, so the reader can picture it.

Grade 4 English Language Arts

Student Textbook · 2026–2027

A full year of Grade 4 reading, writing, and language. Lessons pair the Core Knowledge Readers with close reading, vocabulary, grammar, and writing instruction, so students learn to read carefully, think deeply, and write with purpose.

This Student Textbook teaches every lesson: the big idea, key vocabulary, models and examples, and a short set of practice problems to check understanding. It pairs with the Student Workbook and the Teacher Edition.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 Word Power
02 Reading Closely
03 Reading Longer Texts
04 The Writer's Craft
05 Reading Deeply
06 Sources and Evidence
07 Reading Across Texts
08 Grammar and Conventions
09 Capstone

IN THIS BOOK

- Clear lesson goals: "I can…" statements
- Key vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Models, examples, and Key Idea summaries
- A study guide and glossary for every unit

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook

You are holding this book



Workbook



Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, and every day of the year is mapped to its lesson in the VenvLearning planner.